

Bēowulf

and Other Old English Texts

Original Old English Prose and Verse

Anonymous, King Alfred, Ælfric of Eynsham, and others

Texts composed between the seventh and eleventh centuries

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The Passing of Scyld

Fit I

- Hwæt! wē Gār-Dena in geār-dagum
þēod-cyninga þrym gefrūnon,
hū þā æðelingas ellen fremedon.
Oft Scyld Scēfing sceaðena þrēatum,
5 monegum mægðum meodo-setla oftēah.
Egsode eorl, syððan ærest wearð
fēa-sceaft funden: hē þæs frōfre gebād,
wēox under wolcnum, weorð-myndum ðāh,
oð þæt him æghwylc þāra ymb-sittendra
10 ofer hron-rāde hýran scolde,
gomban gylðan: þæt wæs gōd cyning!
þām eafera wæs æfter cenned
geong in geardum, þone god sende
folce tō frōfre; fyren-þearfe ongeat,
15 þæt hīe ær drugon aldor-lēase
lange hwīle. Him þæs lif-frēa,
wuldres wealdend, worold-āre forgeaf;
Bēowulf wæs brēme (blæd wīde sprang),
Scyldes eafera Scede-landum in.
20 Swā seal geong guma, gōde gewyrcean,
fromum feoh-giftum on fæder wine,
þæt hine on ylde eft gewunigen
wil-gesīðas, þonne wīg cume,
lēode gelæsten: lof-dædum seal
25 in mægða gehwære man gepēon.
Him þā Scyld gewāt tō gescaep-hwīle
fela-hrōr fēran on frēan wære;

- hī hyne þā ætbæron tō brimes faroðe.
 swāse gesiðas, swā hē selfa bæd,
 30 þenden wordum wēold wine Scyldinga,
 lēof land-fruma lange āhte.
 Þær æt hȳðe stōd hringed-stefna,
 īsig and ūtfūs, æðelinges fær;
 ā-lēdon þā lēofne þēoden,
 35 bēaga bryttan on bearm scipes,
 mārne be mæste. Þær wæs mādma fela,
 of feor-wegum frætwa gelæded:
 ne hȳrde ic cȳmlīcor cēol gegyrwan
 hilde-wæpnum and heaðo-wædum,
 40 billum and byrnum; him on bearme læg
 mādma mænigo, þā him mid scoldon
 on flōdes æht feor gewītan.
 Nalas hī hine læssan lācum tēodan,
 þēod-gestrēonum, þonne þā dydon,
 45 þē hine æt frumsceaftē forð onsendon
 ænne ofer ȳðe umbor wesende:
 þā gȳt hīe him āsetton segen gyldenne
 hēah ofer hēafod, lēton holm beran,
 gēafon on gār-secg: him wæs geōmor sefa,
 50 murnende mōd. Men ne cunnon
 secgan tō soðe sele-rædende,
 hæleð under heofenum, hwā þām hlæste onfēng.

The Hall Heorot

Fit II

- Pā wæs on burgum Bēowulf Scyldinga,
lēof lēod-cyning, longe þrāge
55 folcum gefræge (fæder ellor hwearf,
aldor of earde), oð þæt him eft onwōc
hēah Healfdene; hēold þenden lifde,
gamol and gūð-rēow, glæde Scyldingas.
Þām fēower bearn forð-gerīmed
60 in worold wōcun, weoroda ræswan,
Heorogār and Hrōðgār and Hālga til;
hȳrde ic, þat Elan cwēn Ongenþēowes wæs
Heaðoscilfinges heals-gebedde.
Pā wæs Hrōðgāre here-spēd gyfen,
65 wīges weorð-mynd, þæt him his wine-māgas
georne hȳrdon, oð þæt sēo geogoð gewēox,
mago-driht micel. Him on mōd bearn,
þæt heal-reced hātan wolde,
medo-ærn micel men gewyrcean,
70 þone ylðo bearn æfre gefrūnon,
and þær on innan eall gedælan
geongum and ealdum, swylc him god sealde,
būton folc-scare and feorum gumena.
Pā ic wīde gefrægn weorc gebannan
75 manigre mægðe geond þisne middan-geard,
folc-stede frætwan. Him on fyrste gelomp
ædre mid yldum, þæt hit wearð eal gearo,
heal-ærna mæst; scōp him Heort naman,
sē þe his wordes geweald wīde hæfde.
80 Hē bēot ne ālēh, bēagas dælde,

- sinc æt symle. Sele hlífade
 hēah and horn-gēap: heaðo-wylma bād,
 lāðan līges; ne wæs hit lenge þā gēn
 þæt se ecg-hete āðum-swerian
 85 æfter wæl-nīðe wæcnan scolde.
 Þā se ellen-gæst earfoðlice
 þrāge gepolode, sē þe in þýstrum bād,
 þæt hē dōgora gehwām drēam gehýrde
 hlūdne in healle; þær wæs hearpan swēg,
 90 swutol sang scopes. Sægde sē þe cūðe
 frum-sceaft fīra feorran reccan,
 cwæð þæt se ælmihtiga eorðan worhte,
 wlite-beorhtne wang, swā wæter bebūgeð,
 gesette sige-hrēðig sunnan and mōnan
 95 lēoman tō lēohte land-būendum,
 and gefræt Wade foldan scēatas
 leomum and lēafum; lif ēac gesceop
 cynna gehwylcum, þāra þe cwice hwyrfað.
 Swā þā driht-guman drēamum lifdon
 100 ēadiglice, oð þæt ān ongan
 fyrene fremman, fēond on helle:
 wæs se grimma gæst Grendel hāten,
 mære mearc-stapa, sē þe mōras hēold,
 fen and fæsten; fifel-cynnes eard
 105 won-sælig wer weardode hwīle,
 siððan him scyppend forscrifen hæfde.
 In Caines cynne þone cwealm gewræc,
 ēce drihten, þæs þe hē Ābel slōg;
 ne gefeah hē þære fæhðe, ac hē hine feor forwræc,
 110 metod for þý māne man-cynne fram.
 Þanon untýdras ealle onwōcon,
 eotenas and ylfe and orcnēas,
 swylce gīgantas, þā wið gode wunnon
 lange þrāge; hē him þæs lēan forgeald.

Grendel's Visits

Fit III

- 115 Gewāt þā nēosian, syððan niht becōm,
hēan hūses, hū hit Hring-Dene
æfter bēor-þege gebūn hæfdon.
Fand þā þær inne æðelinga gedriht
swefan æfter symble; sorge ne cūðon,
120 won-sceaft wera. Wiht unhælo
grim and grædig gearo sōna wæs,
rēoc and rēðe, and on ræste genam
þrītig þegna: þanon eft gewāt
hūðe hrēmig tō hām faran,
125 mid þære wæl-fylle wīca nēosan.
Þā wæs on ūhtan mid ær-dæge
Grendles gūð-cræft gumum undyrne:
þā wæs æfter wiste wōp up āhafen,
micel morgen-swēg. Mære þēoden,
130 æðeling ær-gōd, unbliðe sæt,
þolode þrȳð-swȳð, þegn-sorge drēah,
syððan hīe þæs lāðan lāst scēawedon,
wergan gāstes; wæs þæt gewin tō strang,
lāð and longsum. Næs hit lengra fyrst,
135 ac ymb āne niht eft gefremede
morð-beala mære and nō mearn fore
fæhðe and fyrene; wæs tō fæst on þām.
Þā wæs ēað-fynde, þē him elles hwær
gerūmlīcor ræste sōhte,
140 bed æfter būrum, þā him gebēacnod wæs,
gesægd sōðlice sweotolan tæcne
heal-þegnes hete; hēold hine syððan

- fyr and fæstor, sē þām fēonde ætwand.
 Swā rīxode and wið rihte wan
 145 āna wið eallum, oð þæt idel stōd
 hūsa sēlest. Wæs sēo hwīl micel:
 twelf wintra tīd torn gēpolode
 wine Scyldinga, wēana gehwelcne,
 sīdra sorga; forþām syððan wearð
 150 ylða bearnum undyrne cūð,
 gyddum geōmore, þætte Grendel wan,
 hwīle wið Hrōðgār;— hete-nīðas wæg,
 fyrene and fāhðe fela missēra,
 singāle sæce, sibbe ne wolde
 155 wið manna hwone mægenes Deniga
 feorh-bealo feorran, fēo þingian,
 nē þær nænig witenas wēnan þorfte
 beorhtre bōte tō banan folmum;
 atol æglāca ēhtende wæs,
 160 deorc dēað-scūa duguðe and geogoðe
 seomade and syrede. Sin-nihte hēold
 mistige mōras; men ne cunnon,
 hwyder hel-rūnan hwyrftum scrīðað.
 Swā fela fyrena fēond man-cynnes,
 165 atol ān-geŋea, oft gefremede
 heardra hȳnða; Heorot eardode,
 sinc-fāge sel sweartum nihtum
 (nō hē þone gif-stōl grētan mōste,
 māððum for metode, nē his myne wisse);
 170 þæt wæs wrēc micel wine Scyldinga,
 mōdes brecða. Monig-oft gesæt
 rīce tō rūne; rāð eahtedon,
 hwæt swīð-ferhðum sēlest wære
 wið fār-gryrum tō gefremmanne.
 175 Hwīlum hīe gehēton æt hæg-trafum
 wīg-weorðunga, wordum bādon,
 þæt him gāst-bona gēoce gefremede
 wið þēod-þrēaum. Swylc wæs þēaw hyra,
 hāðenra hyht; helle gemundon
 180 in mōd-sefan, metod hīe ne cūðon,
 dāda dēmend, ne wiston hīe drihten god,

nē hīe hūru heofena helm herian ne cūðon,
wuldres waldend. Wā bið þāem þe sceal
þurh sliðne nīð sāwle bescūfan
185 in fýres fæðm, frōfre ne wēnan,
wihte gewendan; wēl bið þāem þe mōt
æfter dēað-dæge drihten sēcean
and tō fæder fæðmum freoðo wilnian.

Hygelac's Thane

Fit IV

- Swā þā mæl-ceare maga Healfdenes
190 singāla sēað; ne mihte snotor hāleð
wēan onwendan: wæs þæt gewin tō swyð,
lāð and longsum, þē on þā lēode becōm,
nȳd-wracu nīð-grim, niht-bealwa mæst.
Þæt fram hām gefrægn Higelāces þegn,
195 gōd mid Gēatum, Grendles dāda:
sē wæs mon-cynnes mægenes strengest
on þām dæge þysse lifes,
æðele and ēacen. Hēt him yð-lidan
gōdne gegyrwan; cwæð hē gūð-cyning
200 ofer swan-rāde sēcean wolde,
mārne þēoden, þā him wæs manna þearf.
Þone sīð-fæt him snotere ceorlas
lȳt-hwōn lōgon, þēah hē him lēof wære;
hwetton higerōfne, hæl scēawedon.
205 Hæfde se gōda Gēata lēoda
cempan gecorone, þāra þe hē cēnoste
findan mihte; fiftȳna sum
sund-wudu sōhte; secg wīsade,
lagu-cræftig mon, land-gemyrcu.
210 Fyrst forð gewāt: flota wæs on yðum,
bāt under beorge. Beornas gearwe
on stefn stigon; strēamas wundon
sund wið sande; secgas bæron
on bearm nacan beorhte frætwe,
215 gūð-searo geatolic; guman ūt scufon,

- weras on wil-sið wudu bundenne.
 Gewāt þā ofer wæg-holm winde gefýsed
 flota fāmig-heals fagle gelicost,
 oð þæt ymb ān-tīd oðres dōgores
 220 wunden-stefna gewaden hæfde,
 þæt þā liðende land gesāwon,
 brim-clifu blīcan, beorgas stēape,
 sīde sǣ-næssas: þā wæs sund liden,
 eoletes æt ende. Þanon up hraðe
 225 Wedera lēode on wang stigon,
 sǣ-wudu sǣldon (syrca hrysedon,
 gūð-gewædo); gode þancedon,
 þæs þe him yð-lāde ēaðe wurdon.
 Þā of wealle geseah weard Scildinga,
 230 sē þe holm-clifu healdan scolde,
 beran ofer bolcan beorhte randas,
 fyrd-searu fūslicu; hine fyrwyt bræc
 mōd-gehygdum, hwæt þā men wæron.
 Gewāt him þā tō waroðe wicge rīdan
 235 þegn Hrōðgāres, þrymmum cwehte
 mægen-wudu mundum, meðel-wordum frægn:
 "Hwæt syndon gē searo-hæbbendra
 "byrnum werede, þē þus brontne cēol
 "ofer lagu-stræte lādan cwōmon,
 240 "hider ofer holmas helmas bāron?
 "Ic wæs ende-sǣta, æg-wearde hēold,
 "þæt on land Dena lāðra nænig
 "mid scip-herge sceoððan ne meahte.
 "Nō hēr cūðlicor cuman ongunnon
 245 "lind-hæbbende; nē gē lēafnes-word
 "gūð-fremmendra gearwe ne wisson,
 "māga gemēdu. Næfre ic mārān geseah
 "eorla ofer eorðan, þonne is ēower sum,
 "secg on searwum; nis þæt seld-guma
 250 "wǣpnum geweorðad, næfne him his wlite lēoge,
 "ænlic an-syn. Nū ic ēower sceal
 "frum-cyn witan, ær gē fyr heonan
 "lēase scēaweras on land Dena
 "furður fēran. Nū gē feor-būend,

255 "mere-līðende, mīnne gehȳrað
"ān-fealdne gepōht: ofost is sēlest
"tō gecȳðanne, hwanan ēowre cyme syndon."

The Errand

Fit V

- Him se yldesta andswarode,
werodes wīsa, word-hord onlēac:
260 "Wē synt gum-cynnes Gēata lēode
"and Higelāces heorð-genēatas.
"Wæs mīn fæder folcum gecyðed,
"æðele ord-fruma Ecgbēow hāten;
"gebād wintra worn, ær hē on weg hwurfe,
265 "gamol of geardum; hine gearwe geman
"witena wēl-hwylc wīde geond eorðan.-
"Wē þurh holdne hige hlāford þinne,
"sunu Healfdenes, sēcean cwōmon,
"lēod-gebyrgen: wes þū ūs lārena gōd!
270 "Habbað wē tō þām mæran micel ærende
"Deniga frēan; ne sceal þær dyrne sum
"wesan, þæs ic wēne. Þū wāst, gif hit is,
"swā wē sōðlice secgan hýrdon,
"þæt mid Scyldingum sceaða ic nāt hwylc,
275 "dēogol dæd-hata, deorcum nihtum
"ēaweð þurh egsan uncūðne nīð,
"hýnðu and hrā-fyl. Ic þæs Hrōðgār mæg
"þurh rūmne sefan ræd gelæran,
"hū hē frōd and gōd fēond oferswýðeð,
280 "gyf him ed-wendan æfre scolde
"bealuwa bisigu, bōt eft cuman
"and þā cear-wylmas cōlran wurðað;
"oððe ā syððan earfoð-þrāge,
"prēa-nýd þolað, þenden þær wunað
285 "on hēah-stede hūsa sēlest."

- Weard maðelode, þær on wicge sæt
 ombeht unforht: "Æghwæðres sceal
 "scearp scyld-wiga gescād witan,
 "worda and worca, sē þe wēl þenceð.
 290 "Ic þæt gehyre, þæt þis is hold weorod
 "frēan Scyldinga. Gewītað forð beran
 "wæpen and gewædu, ic ēow wīsigē:
 "swylce ic magu-þegnas mīne hāte
 "wið fēonda gehwone flotan ēowerne,
 295 "nīw-tyrwedne nacan on sande
 "ārum healdan, oð þæt eft byrēð
 "ofer lagu-strēamas lēofne mannan
 "wudu wunden-hals tō Weder-mearce.
 "Gūð-fremmendra swylcum gifeðe bið,
 300 "þæt þone hilde-ræs hāl gedīgeð."
 Gewiton him þā fēran (flota stille bād,
 seomode on sāle sīd-fæðmed scyp,
 on ancre fæst); eofor-līc scionon
 ofer hlēor-beran gehroden golde
 305 fāh and fȳr-heard, ferh wearde hēold.
 Gūðmōde grummon, guman ōnetton,
 sigon ætsomne, oð þæt hȳ sæl timbred
 geatolic and gold-fāh ongytan mihton;
 þæt wæs fore-mārost fold-būendum
 310 receda under roderum, on þām se rīca bād;
 līxte se lēoma ofer landa fela.
 Him þā hilde-dēor hof mōdigra
 torht getāhte, þæt hīe him tō mihton
 gegnum gangan; gūð-beorna sum
 315 wicg gewende, word æfter cwæð:
 "Mæl is mē tō fēran; fæder alwalda
 "mid ār-stafum ēowic gehealde
 "sīða gesunde! ic tō sǣ wille,
 "wið wrāð werod wearde healdan."

Bēowulf's Speech

Fit VI

- 320 Stræt wæs stān-fāh, stīg wīsode
gumum ætgædere. Gūð-byrne scān
heard hond-locen, hring-īren scīr
song in searwum, þā hīe tō sele furðum
in hyra gryre-geatwum gangan cwōmon.
- 325 Setton sǣ-mēðe sīde scyldas,
rondas regn-hearde wið þæs recedes weal,
bugon þā tō bence; byrnan hringdon,
gūð-searo gumena; gāras stōdon,
sǣ-manna searo, samod ætgædere,
- 330 æsc-holt ufan græg: wæs se īren-þrēat
wǣpnnum gewurðad. Þā þær wlonc hæleð
ōret-mecgas æfter æðelum frægn:
"Hwanon ferigeað gē fætte scyldas,
"græge syrcan and grīm-helmas,
- 335 "here-sceafta hēap?— Ic eom Hrōðgāres
"ār and ombiht. Ne seah ic el-þēodige
"þus manige men mōdiglicran.
"Wēn' ic þæt gē for wlenco, nalles for wræc-siðum,
"ac for hige-þrymmum Hrōðgār sōhton."
- 340 Him þā ellen-rōf andswarode,
wlanc Wedera lēod word æfter spræc,
heard under helme: "Wē synt Higelāces
"bēod-genēatas; Bēowulf is mīn nama.
"Wille ic āsecgan suna Healfdenes,
- 345 "mārum þēodne mīn ārende,
"aldre þīnum, gif hē ūs geunnan wile,

- "þæt wē hine swā gōdne grētan mōton."
 Wulfgār maðelode (þæt wæs Wendla lēod,
 wæs his mōd-sefa manegum gecyðed,
 350 wīg and wīs-dōm): "ic þæs wine Deniga,
 "frēan Scildinga frīnan wille,
 "bēaga bryttan, swā þū bēna eart,
 "þēoden mārne ymb þinne sið ;
 "and þe þā andsware ædre gecyðan,
 355 "þe mē se gōda āgifan þenceð."
 Hwearf þā hrædlīce, þær Hrōðgār sæt,
 eald and unhār mid his eorla gedriht;
 ēode ellen-rōf, þæt hē for eaxlum gestōd
 Deniga frēan, cūðe hē duguðe þēaw.
 360 Wulfgār maðelode tō his wine-drihtne:
 "Hēr syndon geferede feorran cumene
 "ofer geofenes begang Gēata lēode:
 "þone yldestan ōret-mecgas
 "Bēowulf nemnað. Hȳ bēnan synt,
 365 "þæt hīe, þēoden mīn, wið þe mōton
 "wordum wrixlan; nō þū him wearne getēoh,
 "þīnra gegn-cwida glædnian, Hrōðgār!
 "Hȳ on wīg-geatwum wyrðe þinceað
 "eorla geæhtlan; hūru se aldor dēah,
 370 "sē þām heaðo-rincum hider wīsade."

Hrothgar's Welcome

Fit VII

- Hrōðgār maðelode, helm Scyldinga:
"Ic hine cūðe cniht-wesende.
"Wæs his eald-fæder Ecgbēo hāten,
"þāem tō hām forgeaf Hrēðel Gēata
375 "āngan dōhtor; is his eafora nū
"heard hēr cumen, sōhte holdne wine.
"þonne sægdon þæt sǣ-liðende,
"þā þe gif-sceattas Gēata fyredon
"þyder tō þance, þæt hē þrīttiges
380 "manna mægen-cræft on his mund-grīpe
"heaðo-rōf hæbbe. Hine hālig god
"for ār-stafum us onsende,
"tō West-Denum, þæs ic wēn hæbbe,
"wið Grendles gryre: ic þāem gōðan sceal
385 "for his mōd-þræce mādmas bēodan.
"Bēo þū on ofeste, hāt hig in gān,
"sēon sibbe-gedriht samod ætgædere;
"gesaga him ēac wordum, þæt hīe sint wil-cuman
"Deniga lēodum." Þā wið duru healle
390 Wulfgār ēode, word inne ābēad:
"Eow hēt secgan sige-drihten mīn,
"aldor Ēast-Dena, þæt hē ēower æðelu can
"and gē him syndon ofer sǣ-wylmas,
"heard-hicgende, hider wil-cuman.
395 "Nū gē mōton gangan in ēowrum guð-geatawum,
"under here-grīman, Hrōðgār gesēon;
"lætað hilde-bord hēr onbidian,

- "wudu wæl-sceaftas, worda geþinges."
 Ārās þā se rīca, ymb hine rinc manig,
 400 þrȳðlic þegna hēap; sume þær bidon,
 heaðo-rēaf hēoldon, swā him se hearda bebēad.
 Snyredon ætsomne, þā secg wīsoðe
 under Heorotes hrōf; hyge-rōf ēode,
 heard under helme, þæt hē on heoðe gestōd.
 405 Bēowulf maðelode (on him byrne scān,
 searo-net sēowed smiðes or-þancum):
 "Wes þū Hrōðgār hāl! ic eom Higelāces
 "māg and mago-þegn; hæbbe ic mæra fela
 "ongunnen on geogoðe. Mē wearð Grendles þing
 410 "on mīnre ēðel-tyrf undyrne cūð:
 "secgað sǣ-liðend, þæt þes sele stande,
 "reced sēlesta, rinca gehwylcum
 "īdel and unnyt, siððan æfen-lēoht
 "under heofenes hādor beholen weorðeð.
 415 "Þā mē þæt gelærdon lēode mīne,
 "þā sēlestan, snotere ceorlas,
 "þēoden Hrōðgār, þæt ic þē sōhte;
 "forþan hīe mægenes cræft mīnne cūðon:
 "selfe ofersāwon, þā ic of searwum cwōm,
 420 "fāh from fēondum, þær ic fife geband,
 "ȳðde eotena cyn, and on ȳðum slōg
 "niceras nihtes, nearo-þearfe drēah,
 "wræc Wedera nīð (wēan āhsodon)
 "forgrand gramum; and nū wið Grendel sceal,
 425 "wið þām āglæcan, āna gehegan
 "þing wið þyrse. Ic þē nū þā,
 "brego Beorht-Dena, biddan wille,
 "eodor Scyldinga, ānre bēne;
 "þæt þū mē ne forwyrne, wīgendra hlēo,
 430 "frēo-wine folca, nū ic þus feorran cōm,
 "þæt ic mōte āna and mīnra eorla gedryht,
 "þes hearda hēap, Heorot fælsian.
 "Hæbbe ic ēac geāhsod, þæt se āglæca
 "for his won-hȳdum wǣpna ne rēceð;
 435 "ic þæt þonne forhicge, swā mē Higelāc sīe,
 "mīn mon-drihten, mōdes blīðe,

- "þæt ic sweord bere oððe sīdne scyld
 "geolo-rand tō gūðe; ac ic mid grāpe sceal
 "fōn wið fēonde and ymb feorh sacan,
 440 "lāð wið lāðum; þær gelyfan sceal
 "dryhtnes dōme sē þe hine dēað nimeð.
 "Wēn' ic þæt hē wille, gif hē wealdan mōt,
 "in þāem gūð-sele Gēatena lēode
 "etan unforhte, swā hē oft dyde
 445 "mægen Hrēðmanna. Nā þū mīnne þearft
 "hafalan hýdan, ac hē mē habban wile
 "drēore fāhne, gif mec dēað nimeð;
 "byrēð blōdig wæl, byrgean þenceð,
 "eteð ān-genga unmunlice,
 450 "mearcað mōr-hopu: nō þū ymb mīnes ne þearft
 "līces feorme leng sorgian.
 "Onsend Higelāce, gif mec hild nime,
 "beadu-scrūda betst, þæt mīne brēost wereð,
 "hrægla sēlest; þæt is Hrēðlan lāf,
 455 "Wēlandes geweorc. Gæð ā Wyrð swā hīo scel!"

Hrothgar Tells of Grendel

Fit VIII

Hrōðgār maðelode, helm Scyldinga:
"for were-fyhtum þū, wine mīn Bēowulf,
"and for ār-stafum ūsic sōhtest.
"Geslōh þin fæder fæhðe mæste,
460 "wearð hē Heaðolāfe tō hand-bonan
"mid Wilfingum; þā hine Wedera cyn
"for here-brōgan habban ne mihte.
"Panon hē gesōhte Sūð-Dena folc
"ofer yða gewealc, Ār-Scyldinga;
465 "þā ic furðum wēold folce Deninga,
"and on geogoðe hēold gimme-rīce
"hord-burh hæleða: þā wæs Heregār dēad,
"mīn yldra mæg unlifigende,
"bearn Healfdenes. Sē wæs betera þonne ic!
470 "Siððan þā fæhðe fēo þingode;
"sende ic Wylfingum ofer wæteres hrycg
"ealde mādmas: hē mē āðas swōr.
"Sorh is mē tō secganne on sefan mīnum
"gumena ængum, hwæt mē Grendel hafað
475 "hȳnðo on Heorote mid his hete-pancum,
"fær-nīða gefremed. Is mīn flet-werod,
"wīg-hēap gewanod; hīe Wyrð forswēop
"on Grendles gryre. God ēaðe mæg
"þone dol-scaðan dæda getwæfan!
480 "Ful oft gebēotedon bēore druncne
"ofer ealo-wæge ōret-mecgas,
"þæt hīe in bēor-sele bīdan woldon

- "Grendles gūðe mid gryrum ecga.
 "Ponne wæs þēos medo-heal on morgen-tīd,
 485 "driht-sele drēor-fāh, þonne dæg līxte,
 "eal benc-þelu blōde bestȳmed,
 "heall heoru-drēore: āhte ic holdra þȳ lās,
 "dēorre duguðe, þē þā dēað fornam.
 "Site nū tō symle and onsæl meoto,
 490 "sige-hrēð secgum, swā þīn sefa hwette!"
 Þā wæs Gēat-mæcgum geador ætsomne
 on bēor-sele benc gerȳmed;
 þær swið-ferhðe sittan ēodon
 þrȳðum dealle. Þegn nytte behēold,
 495 sē þe on handa bær hroden ealo-wāge,
 scencte scīr wered. Scop hwīlum sang
 hādor on Heorote; þær wæs hāleða drēam,
 duguð unlȳtel Dena and Wedera.

Hunferth Objects to Bēowulf

Fit IX

Unferð maðelode, Ecglāfes bearn,
500 þē æt fōtum sæt frēan Scyldinga;
onband beadu-rūne (wæs him Bēowulfes sīð,
mōdges mere-faran, micel æf-þunca,
forþon þe hē ne ūðe, þæt ænig oðer man
æfre mærdða þon mā middan-geardes
505 gehēdde under heofenum þonne hē sylfa):
"Eart þū sē Bēowulf, sē þe wið Breca wunne,
"on sīdne sē ymb sund flite,
"þær git for wlence wada cunnedon
"and for dol-gilpe on dēop wæter
510 "aldrum nēðdon? Nē inc ænig mon,
"nē lēof nē lāð, belēan mihte
"sorh-fullne sīð; þā git on sund rēon,
"þær git ēagor-strēam earmum þehton,
"māton mere-strāta, mundum brugdon,
515 "glidon ofer gār-secg; geofon yðum wēol,
"wintres wylme. Git on wæteres āht
"seofon niht swuncon; hē þē æt sunde oferflāt,
"hæfde mære mægen. Þā hine on morgen-tīd
"on Heaðo-rēmas holm up ætbær,
520 "þonon hē gesōhte swæsne ēðel
"lēof his lēodum lond Brondinga,
"freoðo-burh fægere, þær hē folc āhte,
"burg and bēagas. Bēot eal wið þē

- "sunu Bēanstānes sōðe gelæste.
 525 "Ponne wēne ic tō þē wyrstan geþinges,
 "þeah þū heaðo-ræsa gehwær dohte,
 "grimre gūðe, gif þū Grendles dearest
 "niht-longne fyrst nēan bīdan!"
 Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgbēowes:
 530 "Hwæt! þū worn fela, wine mīn Unferð,
 "bēore druncen ymb Breca spræce,
 "sægdest from his sīðe! Sōð ic talige,
 "þæt ic mere-strengo mārān āhte,
 "earfeðo on yðum, þonne ænig oðer man.
 535 "Wit þæt gecwædon cniht-wesende
 "and gebēotedon (wæron bēgen þā gīt
 "on geogoð-feore) þæt wit on gār-secg ūt
 "aldrum nēðdon; and þæt geæfndon swā.
 "Hæfdon swurd nacod, þā wit on sund rēon,
 540 "heard on handa, wit unc wið hron-fixas
 "werian þohton. Nō hē wiht fram mē
 "flōd-yðum feor flēotan meahte,
 "hraðor on holme, nō ic fram him wolde.
 "Þā wit ætsomne on sǣ wæron
 545 "fif nihta fyrst, oð þæt unc flōd tōdrāf,
 "wado weallende, wedera cealdost,
 "nīpende niht and norðan wind
 "heaðo-grim andhwearf; hrēo wæron yða,
 "Wæs mere-fixa mōd onhrēred:
 550 "þær mē wið lāðum līc-syrce mīn,
 "heard hond-locen, helpe gefremede;
 "beado-hrægl brōden on brēostum læg,
 "golde gegyrwed. Mē tō grunde tēah
 "fāh fēond-scaða, fæste hæfde
 555 "grim on grāpe: hwæðre mē gyfeðe wearð,
 "þæt ic āglæcan orde geræhte,
 "hilde-bille; heaðo-ræs fornam
 "mihtig mere-dēor þurh mīne hand.

Bēowulf's Contest with Breca.-The Feast

Fit X

- "Swā mec gelōme lāð-getēonan
560 "prēatedon þearle. Ic him þenode
"dēoran sweorde, swā hit gedēfe wæs;
"næs hīe þære fylla gefēan hæfdon,
"mān-fordǣdla, þæt hīe mē þēgon,
"symbel ymb-sæton sǣ-grunde nēah,
565 "ac on mergenne mēcum wunde
"be yð-lāfe uppe lāgon,
"sweordum āswefede, þæt syððan nā
"ymb brontne ford brim-liðende
"lāde ne letton. Lēoht ēastan cōm,
570 "beorht bēacen godes; brimu swaðredon,
"þæt ic sǣ-næssas gesēon mihte,
"windige weallas. Wyrð oft nereð
"unfǣgne eorl, ðonne his ellen dēah!
"Hwæðere mē gesælde, þæt ic mid sweorde ofslōh
575 "niceras nigene. Nō ic on niht gefrægn
"under heofones hwealf heardran feohtan,
"nē on ēg-strēamum earmran mannan;
"hwæðere ic fāra feng fēore gedigde,
"siðes wērig. Þā mec sǣ oðbær,
580 "flōd æfter faroðe, on Finna land,
"wadu weallendu. Nō ic wiht fram þē
"swylcra searo-nīða secgan hýrde,
"billa brōgan: Breca nǣfre gīt

- "æt heaðo-lāce, nē gehwæðer incer
 585 "swā dēorlice dæd gefremede
 "fāgum sweordum
 " nō ic þæs gylpe;
 "þēah þū þīnum brōðrum tō banan wurde,
 "hēafod-mægum; þæs þū in helle scealt
 590 "werhðo drēogan, þēah þīn wit duge,
 "Secge ic þē tō sōðe, sunu Ecglāfes,
 "þæt næfre Grendel swā fela gryra gefremede,
 "atol æglāca ealdre þīnum,
 "hȳnðo on Heorote, gif þīn hige wære,
 595 "sefa swā searo-grim, swā þū self talast.
 "Ac hē hafað onfunden, þæt hē þā fāhðe ne þearf,
 "atole ecg-þræce ēower lēode
 "swīðe onsittan, Sige-Scyldinga;
 "nymeð nȳd-bāde, nānegum ārað
 600 "lēode Deniga, ac hē on lust wīgeð,
 "swefeð ond sendeð, secce ne wēneð
 "tō Gār-Denum. Ac him Gēata sceal
 "eafōð and ellen ungeāra nū
 "gūðe gebēodan. Gæð eft sē þe mōt
 605 "tō medo mōdig, siððan morgen-lēoht
 "ofer ylða bearn oðres dōgores,
 "sunne swegl-wered sūðan scīneð!"
 Þā wæs on sālum since brytta
 gamol-feax and gūð-rōf, gēoce gelyfde
 610 brego Beorht-Dena; gehȳrde on Bēowulfe
 folces hyrde fæst-rædne geþōht.
 Þær wæs hæleða hleahtor; hlyn swynsode,
 word wæron wynsume. Ēode Wealhþēow forð,
 cwēn Hrōðgāres, cynna gemyndig,
 615 grētte gold-hroden guman on healle,
 and þā frēolic wīf ful gesealde
 ærest Ēast-Dena ēðel-wearde,
 bæd hine bliðne æt þære bēor-þege,
 lēodum lēofne; hē on lust geþeah
 620 symbel and sele-ful, sige-rōf kyning.
 Ymb-ēode þā ides Helminga
 duguðe and geogoðe dæl æghwylcne;

- sinc-fato sealde, oð þæt sāl ālamp,
 þæt hīo Bēowulfe, bēag-hroden cwēn,
 625 mōde gepungen, medo-ful ætbær;
 grētte Gēata lēod, gode þancode
 wīs-fæst wordum, þæs þe hire se willa gelamp,
 þæt hēo on ānigne eorl gelȳfde
 fyrena frōfre. Hē þæt ful geþeah,
 630 wæl-rēow wiga æt Wealhþēon,
 and þā gyddode gūðe gefȳsed,
 Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgþēowes:
 "Ic þæt hogode, þā ic on holm gestāh,
 "sā-bāt gesæt mid mīnra secga gedriht,
 635 "þæt ic ānunga ēowra lēoda
 "willan geworhte, oððe on wæl crunge,
 "fēond-grāpum fæst. Ic gefremman sceal
 "eorlic ellen, oððe ende-dæg
 "on þisse meodu-healle mīnne gebīdan."
 640 Þām wīfe þā word wēl līcodon,
 gilp-cwide Gēates; ēode gold-hroden
 frēolicu folc-cwēn tō hire frēan sittan.
 Þā wæs eft swā ær inne on healle
 þrȳð-word sprecen, þēod on sǣlum,
 645 sige-folca swēg, oð þæt semninga
 sunu Healfdenes sēcean wolde
 æfen-ræste; wiste æt þām āhlācan
 tō þām hēah-sele hilde geþīnged,
 siððan hīe sunnan lēoht gesēon ne meahton,
 650 oððe nīpende niht ofer ealle,
 scadu-helma gesceapu scrīðan cwōman,
 wan under wolcnum. Werod eall ārās.
 Grētte þā giddum guma oðerne,
 Hrōðgār Bēowulf, and him hæl ābēad,
 655 wīn-ærnes geweald and þæt word ācwæð:
 "Nǣfre ic ānegum men ær ālȳfde,
 "siððan ic hond and rond hebban mihte,
 "þrȳð-ærn Dena būton þē nū þā.
 "Hafa nū and geheald hūsa sēlest;
 660 "gemyne mǣrðo, mægen-ellen cȳð,
 "waca wið wrāðum! Ne bið þē wilna gād,

”gif þū þæt ellen-weorc aldre gedīgest.”

The Watch for Grendel

Fit XI

Ƣā him Hrōðgār gewāt mid his hæleða gedryht,
eodur Scyldinga ūt of healle;
665 wolde wīg-fruma Wealhþeo sēcan,
cwēn tō gebeddan Hæfde kyninga wuldor
Grendle tō-gēanes, swā guman gefrungon,
sele-weard āseted, sundor-nytte behēold
ymb aldor Dena, eoton weard ābēad;
670 hūru Gēata lēod georne truwode
mōdgan mægnes, metodes hylde.
Ƣā hē him of dyde īsern-byrnan,
helm of hafelan, sealde his hyrsted sweord,
īrena cyst ombiht-þegne,
675 and gehealdan hēt hilde-geatwe.
Gespræc Ƣā se gōda gylp-worda sum
Bēowulf Gēata, ær hē on bed stige:
"Nō ic mē an here-wæsmum hnāgran talige
"gūð-geweorca, þonne Grendel hine;
680 "forþan ic hine sweorde swebban nelle,
"aldre benēotan, þēah ic eal mæge.
"Nāt hē Ƣāra gōda, þæt hē mē on-gēan slēa,
"rand gehēawe, þēah þe hē rōf sīe
"nīð-geweorca; ac wit on niht sculon
685 "secge ofersittan, gif hē gesēcean dear
"wīg ofer wæpen, and siððan wītīg god
"on swā hwæðere hond hālig dryhten
"mārðo dēme, swā him gemet þince."
Hylde hine Ƣā heaðo-dēor, hlēor-bolster onfēng
690 eorles andwlitan; and hine ymb monig

- snellīc sǣ-rinc sele-reste gebēah.
 Nænig heora þōhte þæt hē þanon scolde
 eft eard-lufan æfre gesēcean,
 folc oððe frēo-burh, þær hē āfēded wæs,
 695 ac hīe hæfdon gefrūnen, þæt hīe ær tō fela micles
 in þām wīn-sele wæl-dēað fornam,
 Denigea lēode. Ac him dryhten forgeaf
 wīg-spēda gewiofu, Wedera lēodum
 frōfor and fultum, þæt hīe fēond heora
 700 þurh ānes cræft ealle ofercōmon,
 selfes mihtum: sōð is gecyðed,
 þæt mihtig god manna cynnes
 wēold wīde-ferhð. Cōm on wanre niht
 scrīðan sceadu-genga. Scēotend swāfon,
 705 þā þæt horn-reced healdan scoldon,
 ealle būton ānum. Þæt wæs yldum cūð,
 þæt hīe ne mōste, þā metod nolde,
 se syn-scaða under sceadu bregdan;
 ac hē wæccende wrāðum on andan
 710 bād bolgen-mōd beadwa geþinges.

Grendel's Raid

Fit XII

- Þā cōm of mōre under mist-hleoðum
Grendel gongan, godes yrre bær.
Mynte se mǣn-scaða manna cynnes
sumne besyrwan in sele þām hēan;
715 wōð under wolcnum, tō þæs þe hē wīn-reced,
gold-sele gumena, gearwost wisse
fættum fāhne. Ne wæs þæt forma sīð,
þæt hē Hrōðgāres hām gesōhte:
nǣfre hē on aldor-dagum ær nē siððan
720 heardran hæle, heal-þegnas fand!
Cōm þā tō recede rinc sīðian
drēamum bedæled. Duru sōna onarn
fȳr-bendum fæst, syððan hē hire folmum hrān;
onbræd þā bealo-hȳdig, þā hē ābolgen wæs,
725 recedes mūðan. Raðe æfter þon
on fāgne flōr fēond treddode,
ēode yrre-mōd; him of ēagum stōd
līge gelicost lēoht unfæger.
Geseah hē in recede rinca manige,
730 swefan sibbe-gedriht samod ætgædere,
mago-rinca hēap: þā his mōd āhlōg,
mynte þæt hē gedælde, ær þon dæg cwōme,
atol āglāca, ānra gehwylces
lif wið līce, þā him ālumpen wæs
735 wist-fylle wēn. Ne wæs þæt wyrd þā gēn,
þæt hē mā mōste manna cynnes
þicgean ofer þā niht. Þrȳð-swȳð behēold
mæg Higelāces, hū se mǣn-scaða

- under fār-gripum gefaran wolde.
 740 Nē þæt se āglāca yldan þōhte,
 ac hē gefēng hraðe forman siðe
 slæpendne rinc, slāt unwearnum,
 bāt bān-locan, blōd ēdrum dranc,
 syn-snædum swealh: sōna hæfde
 745 unlyfigendes eal gefeormod
 fēt and folma. Forð nēar ætstōp,
 nam þā mid handa hige-þihtigne
 rinc on ræste; ræhte ongēan
 fēond mid folme, hē onfēng hraðe
 750 inwit-þancum and wið earm gesæt.
 Sōna þæt onfunde fyrena hyrde,
 þæt hē ne mētte middan-geardes
 eorðan scēata on elran men
 mund-gripe māran: hē on mōde wearð
 755 forht on ferhðe, nō þy ær fram meahte;
 hyge wæs him hin-fūs, wolde on heolster flēon,
 sēcan dēofla gedræg: ne wæs his drohtoð þær,
 swylce hē on ealder-dagum ær gemētte.
 Gemunde þā se gōda mæg Higelāces
 760 æfen-spræce, up-lang āstōd
 and him fæste wiðfēng. Fingras burston;
 eoten wæs ūt-weard, eorl furður stōp.
 Mynte se mæra, þær hē meahte swā,
 wīdre gewindan and on weg þanon
 765 flēon on fen-hopu; wiste his fingra geweald
 on grames grāpum. Þæt wæs gēocor sið,
 þæt se hearm-scaða tō Heorute ātēah:
 dryht-sele dynede, Denum eallum wearð,
 ceaster-būendum, cēnra gehwylcum,
 770 eorlum ealu-scerwen. Yrre wæron bēgen,
 rēðe rēn-weardas. Reced hlynsode;
 þā wæs wundor micel, þæt se wīn-sele
 wiðhæfde heaðo-dēorum, þæt hē on hrūsan ne fēol,
 fæger fold-bold; ac hē þæs fæste wæs
 775 innan and ūtan īren-bendum
 searo-þoncum besmiðod. Þær fram sylle ābēag
 medu-benc monig mīne gefræge,

golde geregnad, þær þā graman wunnon;
 þæs ne wēndon ær witan Scyldinga,
 780 þæt hit ā mid gemete manna ænig
 betlic and bān-fāg tōbreca meahte,
 listum tōlūcan, nymðe līges fæðm
 swulge on swaðule. Swēg up āstāg
 nīwe geneahhe; Norð-Denum stōd
 785 atelīc egesa ānra gehwylcum
 þāra þe of wealle wōp gehȳrdon,
 gryre-lēoð galan godes andsacan,
 sige-lēasne sang, sār wānigean
 helle hæftan. Hēold hine tō fæste
 790 sē þe manna wæs mægene strengest
 on þām dæge þysses lifes.

Bēowulf Tears Off Grendel's Arm

Fit XIII

Nolde eorla hlēo ænige þinga
þone cwealm-cuman cwicne forlætan,
nē his lif-dagas lēoda ænigum
795 nytte tealde. Þær genehost brægd
eorl Bēowulfes ealde lāfe,
wolde frēa-drihtnes feorh ealgian
māres þēodnes, þær hīe meahton swā;
hīe þæt ne wiston, þā hīe gewin drugon,
800 heard-hicgende hilde-mecgas,
and on healfa gehwone hēawan þōhton,
sāwle sēcan, þæt þone syn-scaðan
ænig ofer eorðan irenna cyst,
gūð-billa nān grētan nolde;
805 ac hē sige-wæpnum forsworen hæfde,
ecga gehwylcre. Scolde his aldor-gedāl
on þām dæge þysses lifes
earmlīc wurðan and se ellor-gāst
on fēonda geweald feor sīðian.
810 Þā þæt onfunde sē þe fela æror
mōdes myrðe manna cynne
fyrene gefremede (hē wæs fāg wið god)
þæt him se līc-homa læstan nolde,
ac hine se mōdega mæg Hygelāces
815 hæfde be honda; wæs gehwæðer oðrum
lifigende lāð. Līc-sār gebād

- atol æglæca, him on eaxle wearð
 syn-dolh sweotol, seonowe onsprungon
 burston bān-locan. Bēowulfe wearð
 820 gūð-hrēð gyfeðe; scolde Grendel þonan
 feorh-sēoc flēon under fen-hleoðu,
 sēcean wyn-lēas wīc; wiste þē geornor,
 þæt his aldres wæs ende gegongen,
 dōgera dæg-rīm. Denum eallum wearð
 825 æfter þām wæl-rāse willa gelumpen.
 Hæfde þā gefælsod, sē þe ær feorran cōm,
 snotor and swyð-ferhð sele Hrōðgāres,
 genered wið nīðe. Niht-weorce gefeh,
 ellen-mærðum; hæfde Ēast-Denum
 830 Gēat-mecga lēod gilp gelæsted,
 swylce oncȳððe ealle gebētte,
 inwid-sorge, þē hīe ær drugon
 and for þrēa-nȳdum þolian scoldon,
 torn unlȳtel. Þæt wæs tācen sweotol,
 835 syððan hilde-dēor hond ālegde,
 earm and eaxle (þær wæs eal geador
 Grendles grāpe) under gēapne hrōf.

The Joy at Heorot

Fit XIV

Þā wæs on morgen mīne gefræge
ymb þā gif-healle gūð-rinc monig:
840 fērdon folc-togan feorran and nēan
geond wīd-wegas wundor scēawian,
lāðes lāstas. Nō his lif-gedāl
sārlic þūhte secga ānegum,
þāra þe tīr-lēases trode scēawode,
845 hū hē wērig-mōd on weg þanon,
nīða ofercumen, on nicera mere
fæge and geflȳmed feorh-lāstas bær.
Þær wæs on blōde brim weallende,
atol yða geswing eal gemenged
850 hātan heolfre, heoro-drēore wēol;
dēað-fæge dēog, siððan drēama lēas
in fen-freoðo feorh ālegde
hæðene sāwle, þær him hel onfēng.
Þanon eft gewiton eald-gesiðas,
855 swylce geong manig of gomen-wāðe,
fram mere mōdge, mēarum rīdan,
beornas on blancum. Þær wæs Bēowulfes
mārðo mæned; monig oft gecwæð,
þætte sūð nē norð be sām tweonum
860 ofer eormen-grund oðer nānig
under swegles begong sēlra nære
rond-hæbbendra, rīces wyrðra.
Nē hīe hūru wine-drihten wiht ne lōgon,
glædne Hrōðgār, ac þæt wæs gōd cyning.

- 865 Hwīlum heaðo-rōfe hlēapan lēton,
 on geflīt faran fealwe mēaras,
 þær him fold-wegas fægere þūhton,
 cystum cūðe; hwīlum cyninges þegn,
 guma gilp-hlæden gidða gemyndig,
 870 sē þe eal-fela eald-gesegena
 worn gemunde, word oðer fand
 sōðe gebunden: secg eft ongan
 sið Bēowulfes snyttrum styrian
 and on spēd wrecan spel gerāde,
 875 wordum wrixlan, wēl-hwylc gecwæð,
 þæt hē fram Sigemunde secgan hȳrde,
 ellen-dædum, uncūðes fela,
 Wælsinges gewin, wīde siðas,
 þāra þe gumena bearn gearwe ne wiston,
 880 fæhðe and fyrene, būton Fitela mid hine,
 þonne hē swylces hwæt secgan wolde
 eam his nefan, swā hīe ā wæron
 æt nīða gehwām nȳd-gesteallan:
 hæfdon eal-fela eotena cynnes
 885 sweordum gesæged. Sigemunde gesprong
 æfter dēað-dæge dōm unlȳtel,
 syððan wīges heard wyrm ācwealde,
 hordes hȳrde; hē under hārne stān,
 æðelinges bearn, āna genēðde
 890 frēcne dæde; ne wæs him Fitela mid.
 Hwæðre him gesælde, þæt þæt swurd þurhwōd
 wrætlicne wyrm, þæt hit on wealle ætstōd,
 dryhtlic īren; draca morðre swealt.
 Hæfde āglæca elne gegongen,
 895 þæt hē bēah-hordes brūcan mōste
 selfes dōme: sǣ-bāt gehlōd,
 bær on bearm scipes beorhte frætwa,
 Wælses eafera; wyrm hāt gemealt.
 Sē wæs wreccena wīde mǣrost
 900 ofer wer-þēode, wīgendra hlēo
 ellen-dædum: hē þæs āron þāh.
 Siððan Heremōdes hild sweðrode
 eafoð and ellen. Hē mid eotenum wearð

- on fēonda geweald forð forlācen,
 905 snūde forsended. Hine sorh-wylmas
 lemede tō lange, hē his lēodum wearð,
 eallum æðelingum tō aldor-ceare;
 swylce oft bemearn ærran mælum
 swið-ferhðes sið snotor ceorl monig,
 910 sē þe him bealwa tō bōte gelyfde,
 þæt þæt þeodnes bearn gepēon scolde,
 fæder-æðelum onfōn, folc gehealdan,
 hord and hlēo-burh, hæleða rīce,
 ēðel Scyldinga. Hē þær eallum wearð,
 915 mæg Higelāces manna cynne,
 frēondum gefægra; hine fyren onwōd.
 Hwīlum flitende fealwe strāte
 mēarum mæton. Þā wæs morgen-lēoht
 scofen and scynded. Ēode scealc monig
 920 swið-hicgende tō sele þām hēan,
 searo-wundor sēon, swylce self cyning,
 of brýd-būre bēah-horda weard,
 tryddode tīr-fæst getrume micle,
 cystum gecyðed, and his cwēn mid him
 925 medo-stig gemæt mægða hōse.

Hrothgar's Gratulation

Fit XV

- Hrōðgār maðelode (hē tō healle gēong,
stōd on stapole, geseah stēapne hrōf
golde fāhne and Grendles hond):
"þisse ansýne al-wealdan þanc
930 "lungre gelimpe! Fela ic lāðes gebād,
"gryнна æt Grendle: ā mæg god wyrcan
"wunder æfter wundre, wuldres hyrde!
"Þæt wæs ungeāra, þæt ic ænigra mē
"wēana ne wēnde tō wīdan feore
935 "bōte gebīdan þonne blōde fāh
"hūsa sēlest heoro-drēorig stōd;
"wēa wīd-scofen witenā gehwylcne
"þāra þe ne wēndon, þæt hīe wīde-ferhð
"lēoda land-geweorc lāðum beweredon
940 "succum and scinum. Nū scealc hafað
"þurh drihtnes miht dæd gefremede,
"þē wē ealle ær ne meahton
"snyttrum besyrwan. Hwæt! þæt secgan mæg
"efne swā hwylc mægða, swā þone magan cende
945 "æfter gum-cynnum, gyf hēo gýt lyfað,
"þæt hyre eald-metod ēste wære
"bearn-gebyrdo. Nū ic Bēowulf
"þec, secg betsta, mē for sunu wylle
"frēogan on ferhðe; heald forð tela
950 "nīwe sibbe. Ne bið þē nænigra gād
"worolde wilna, þē ic geweald hæbbe.
"Ful-oft ic for læssan lēan teohhode

- "hord-weorðunge hnāhran rince,
 "sāmran æt sæcce. Þū þē self hafast
 955 "dǣdum gefremed, þæt þīn dōm lyfað
 "āwa tō aldre. Alwalda þec
 "gōde forgyld, swā hē nū gýt dyde!"
 Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgbēowes:
 "Wē þæt ellen-weorc ēstum miclum,
 960 "feohtan fremedon, frēcne genēðdon
 "eafōð uncūðes; ūðe ic swiððor,
 "þæt þū hinc selfne gesēon mōste,
 "fēond on frætewum fyl-wērigne!
 "Ic hine hrædlice heardan clammum
 965 "on wæl-bedde wriðan þōhte,
 "þæt hē for mund-gripe mīnum scolde
 "licgean lif-bysig, būtan his līc swice;
 "ic hine ne mihte, þā metod nolde,
 "ganges getwāman, nō ic him þæs georne ætfealh,
 970 "feorh-genīðlan; wæs tō fore-mihtig
 "fēond on fēðe. Hwæðere hē his folme forlēt
 "tō lif-wraðe lāst weardian,
 "earm and eaxle; nō þær ænige swā þēah
 "fēa-sceaft guma frōfre gebohte:
 975 "nō þý leng leofað lāð-getēona
 "synnum geswenced, ac hyne sār hafað
 "in nýd-gripe nearwe befongen,
 "balwon bendum: þær ābīdan sceal
 "maga māne fāh miclan dōmes,
 980 "hū him scīr metod scrīfan wille."
 Þā wæs swīgra secg, sunu Ecglāfes,
 on gylp-spræce gūð-geweorca,
 siððan æðelingas eorles cræfte
 ofer hēahne hrōf hand scēawedon,
 985 fēondes fingras, foran æghwylc;
 wæs stēde nægla gehwylc, stýle gelīcost,
 hǣðenes hand-sporu hilde-rinces
 egle unhēoru; æg-hwylc gecwæð,
 þæt him heardra nān hrīnan wolde
 990 īren ær-gōd, þæt þæs āhlācan
 blōdige beadu-folme onberan wolde.

The Banquet and the Gifts

Fit XVI

- þā wæs hāten hreðe Heort innan-weard
folmum gefrætwod: fela þæra wæs
wera and wīfa, þē þæt wīn-reced,
995 gest-sele gyredon. Gold-fāg scinon
web æfter wāgum, wundor-sīona fela
secga gehwylcum þāra þe on swylc starað
Wæs þæt beorhte bold tōbrocen swiðe
eal inne-weard īren-bendum fæst,
1000 heorras tōhlidene; hrōf āna genæs
ealles ansund, þā se āglæca
fyren-dædum fāg on flēam gewand,
aldres or-wēna. Nō þæt yðe byð
tō beflēonne (fremme sē þe wille!)
- 1005 ac gesacan sceal sāwl-berendra
nȳde genȳdde niðða bearna
grund-būendra gearwe stōwe,
þær his līc-homa leger-bedde fæst
swefeð æfter symle. Þā wæs sāl and mæl,
1010 þæt tō healle gang Healfdenes sunu;
wolde self cyning symbel þicgan.
Ne gefrægen ic þā mægðe māran weorode
ymb hyra sinc-gyfan sēl gebæran.
Bugon þā tō bence blæd-āgende,
1015 fylle gefægon. Fægere geþægon
medo-ful manig māgas þāra
swið-hicgende on sele þām hēan,
Hrōðgār and Hrōðulf. Heorot innan wæs

- frēondum āfyllled; nalles fācen-stafas
 1020 Pēod-Scyldingas þenden fremedon.
 Forgeaf þā Bēowulfe bearn Healfdenes
 segen gyl登enne sigores tō lēane,
 hroden hilde-cumbor, helm and byrnan;
 mære māððum-sweord manige gesāwon
 1025 beforan beorn beran. Bēowulf geþah
 ful on flette; nō hē þære feoh-gyfte
 for scēotendum scamigan þorfte,
 ne gefrægn ic frēondlicor fēower mādmas
 golde gegyrede gum-manna fela
 1030 in ealo-bence oðrum gesellan.
 Ymb þæs helmes hrōf hēafod-beorge
 wīrum bewunden walan ūtan hēold,
 þæt him fēla lāfe frēcne ne meahton
 scūr-heard sceððan, þonne scyld-freca
 1035 ongēan gramum gangan scolde.
 Heht þā eorla hlēo eahta mēaras,
 fæted-hlēore, on flet tēon
 in under eoderas; þāra ānum stōd
 sadol searwum fāh since gewurðad,
 1040 þæt wæs hilde-setl hēah-cyninges,
 þonne sweorda gelāc sunu Healfdenes
 efnan wolde; nāfre on ōre læg
 wīd-cūðes wīg, þonne walu fēollon.
 And þā Bēowulfe bēga gehwæðres
 1045 eodor Ingwina onweald getēah,
 wicga and wāpnā; hēt hine wēl brūcan.
 Swā manlice mære þēoden,
 hord-weard hāleða heaðo-rāsas geald
 mēarum and mādnum, swā hī nāfre man lyhð,
 1050 sē þe secgan wile sōð æfter rihte.

Song of Hrothgar's Poet-The Lay of Hnaef and Hengest

Fit XVII

- þā gýt æghwylcum eorla drihten
þāra þe mid Bēowulfe brim-lāde tēah,
on þære medu-bence māððum gesealde,
yrfe-lāfe, and þone ænne heht
1055 golde forgyldan, þone þe Grendel ær
māne ācwealde, swā hē hyra mā wolde,
nefne him wītig god wyrd forstōde
and þæs mannes mōd: metod eallum wēold
gumena cynnes, swā hē nū gīt dēð;
1060 forþan bið andgit æghwær sēlest,
ferhðes fore-þanc! fela sceal gebīdan
lēofes and lāðes, sē þe longe hēr
on þyssum win-dagum worolde brūceð.
Þær wæs sang and swēg samod ætgædere
1065 fore Healfdenes hilde-wīsan,
gomen-wudu grēted, gid oft wrecen,
þonne heal-gamen Hrōðgāres scop
æfter medo-bence mænan scolde
Finnes eaferum, þā hīe se fār befeat:
1070 "Hæleð Healfdenes, Hnæf Scyldinga,
"in Fr..es wæle feallan scolde.
"Nē hūru Hildeburh herian þorfte
"Eotena trēowe: unsynnum wearð
"beloren lēofum æt þām lind-plegan
1075 "bearnum and brōðrum; hīe on gebyrd hruron

- "gāre wunde; þæt wæs geōmuru ides.
 "Nalles hōlinga Hōces dōhtor
 "meotod-sceaft bemearn, syððan morgen cōm,
 "þā hēo under swegle gesēon meahte
 1080 "morðor-bealo māga, þær hēo ær mæste hēold
 "worolde wynne: wīg ealle fornam
 "Finnes þegnas, nemne fēaum ānum,
 "þæt hē ne mehte on þām meðel-stede
 "wīg Hengeste wiht gefeohtan,
 1085 "nē þā wēa-lāfe wīge forþringan
 "þōodnes þegne; ac hig him geþingo budon,
 "þæt hīe him oðer flet eal gerýmdon,
 "healle and hēah-setl, þæt hīe healfre gewæld
 "wið Eotena bearn āgan mōston,
 1090 "and æt feoh-gyftum Folcwaldan sunu
 "dōgra gehwylce Dene weorðode,
 "Hengestes hēap hringum wenede,
 "efne swā swīðe sinc-gestrēonum
 "fættan goldes, swā hē Frēsena cyn
 1095 "on bēor-sele byldan wolde.
 "Þā hīe getruwedon on twā healfa
 "fæste frioðu-wære; Fin Hengeste
 "elne unflitme āðum benemde,
 "þæt hē þā wēa-lāfe weotena dōme
 1100 "ārum heolde, þæt þær ænig mon
 "wordum nē worcum wære ne brāce,
 "nē þurh inwit-searo æfre gemānden,
 "þēah hīe hira bēag-gyfan banan folgedon
 "þēoden-lēase, þā him swā geþearfod wæs:
 1105 "gyf þonne Frýsna hwylc frēcnan sprāce
 "þæs morðor-hetes myndgiend wære,
 "þonne hit sweordes ecg syððan scolde.
 "Åð wæs geæfned and icge gold
 "āhæfen of horde. Here-Scyldinga
 1110 "betst beado-rinca wæs on bæl gearu;
 "æt þām āde wæs ēð-gesýne
 "swāt-fāh syrce, swýn eal-gylden,
 "eofer iren-heard, æðeling manig
 "wundum āwyrded; sume on wæle crungon.

- 1115 "Hēt þā Hildeburh æt Hnæfes āde
 "hire selfre sunu sweoloðe befæstan,
 "bān-fatu bærnān and on bæl dōn.
 "Earme on eaxle ides gnornode,
 "geōmrode giddum; gūð-rinc āstāh.
 1120 "Wand tō wolcnum wæl-fýra mæst,
 "hlynnode for hlāwe; hafelan multon,
 "ben-geato burston, þonne blōd ætspranc
 "lāð-bite līces. Līg ealle forswealg,
 "gæsta gīfrost, þāra þe þær gūð fornam
 1125 "bēga folces; wæs hira blæd scacen.

The Gleeman's Tale Is Ended

Fit XVIII

- "Gewiton him þā wīgend wīca nēosian,
"frēondum befeallen Frýsland gesēon,
"hāmas and hēa-burh. Hengest þā gýt
"wæl-fāgne winter wunode mid Finne
1130 "ealles unhlitme; eard gemunde,
"þēah þe hē ne meahte on mere drīfan
"hringed-stefnan; holm storme wēol,
"won wið winde; winter yðe belēac
"īs-gebinde oð þæt oðer cōm
1135 "geār in geardas, swā nū gýt dēð,
"þā þe syngales sēle bewitiað,
"wuldor-torhtan weder. Þā wæs winter scacen,
"fæger foldan bearm; fundode wrecca,
"gist of geardum; hē tō gyrn-wræce
1140 "swiðor þōhte, þonne tō sǣ-lāde,
"gif hē torn-gemōt þurhtēon mihte,
"þæt hē Eotena bearn inne gemunde.
"Swā hē ne forwyrnde worold-rādenne,
"þonne him Hūnlāfing hilde-lēoman,
1145 "billa sēlest, on bearm dyde:
"þæs wāron mid Eotenum ecge cūðe.
"Swylce ferhð-frecan Fin eft begeat
"sweord-bealo slīðen æt his selfes hām,
"siððan grimne gripe Gūðlaf ond Ōslāf
1150 "æfter sǣ-siðe sorge mǣndon,

- "æt witon wēana dæl; ne meahthe wāfre mōd
 "forhabban in hreðre. þā wæs heal hroden
 "fēonda fēorum, swilce Fin slægen,
 "cyning on corðre, and sēo cwēn numen.
 1155 "Scēotend Scyldinga tō scypum feredon
 "eal in-gesteald eorð-cyninges,
 "swylce hīe æt Finnes hām findan meahton
 "sigla searo-gimma. Hīe on sǣ-lāde
 "drihtlice wīf tō Denum feredon,
 1160 "læddon tō lēodum." Lēoð wæs āsungen,
 glēo-mannes gyd. Gamen eft āstāh,
 beorhtode benc-swēg, byrelas sealdon
 wīn of wunder-fatum. þā cwōm Wealhþeo forð
 gān under gyldnum bēage, þær þā gōdan twēgen
 1165 sǣton suhter-gefæderan; þā gýt wæs hīera sib ætgædere
 æghwylc oðrum trýwe. Swylce þær Unferð þyle
 æt fōtum sæt frēan Scyldinga: gehwylc hiora his ferhðe
 trēowde,
 þæt hē hæfde mōd micel, þēah þe hē his māgum nǣre
 ārfæst æt ecga gelācum. Spræc þā ides Scyldinga:
 1170 "Onfōh þissum fulle, frēo-drihten mīn,
 "sinces brytta; þū on sǣlum wes,
 "gold-wine gumena, and tō Gēatum sprec
 "mildum wordum! Swā sceal man dōn.
 "Bēo wið Gēatas glæd, geofena gemyndig;
 1175 "nēan and feorran þū nū friðu hafast.
 "Mē man sægde, þæt þū þē for sunu wolde
 "here-rinc habban. Heorot is gefǣlsod,
 "bēah-sele beorhta; brūc þenden þū mōte
 "manigra mēda and þīnum māgum lǣf
 1180 "folc and rīce, þonne þū forð scyle
 "metod-scaft sēon. Ic mīnne can
 "glædne Hrōðulf, þæt hē þā geogoðe wile
 "ārum healdan, gyf þū ær þonne hē,
 "wine Scildinga, worold oflættest;
 1185 "wēne ic, þæt hē mid gōde gyldan wille
 "uncran eaferan, gif hē þæt eal gemon,
 "hwæt wit tō willan and tō worð-myndum
 "umbor wesendum ær ārna gefremedon."

Hwearf þā bī bence, þær hyre byre wæron,
1190 Hrēðrīc and Hrōðmund, and hæleða bearn,
giogoð ætgædere; þær se gōda sæt
Bēowulf Gēata be þām gebrōðrum twām.

Bēowulf's Jewelled Collar. the Heroes Rest

Fit XIX

- Him wæs ful boren and frēond-laðu
wordum bewægned and wunden gold
1195 ēstum geēawed, earm-hrēade twā,
hrægl and hringas, heals-bēaga mæst
þāra þe ic on foldan gefrægen hæbbe.
Nænigne ic under swegle sēlran hýrde
hord-māððum hæleða, syððan Hāma ætwæg
1200 tō þære byrhtan byrig Brōsinga mene,
sigle and sinc-fæt, searo-nīðas fealh
Eormenrīces, gecēas ēcne ræd.
Þone hring hæfde Higelāc Gēata,
nefa Swertinges, nýhstan sīðe,
1205 siððan hē under segne sinc ealgode,
wæl-rēaf werede; hyne Wyrð fornam,
syððan hē for wlenco wēan āhsode,
fāhðe tō Frýsum; hē þā frætwe wæg,
eorclan-stānas ofer yða ful,
1210 rīce þeoden, hē under rande gecranc;
gehwearf þā in Francna fæðm feorh cyninges,
brēost-gewædu and se bēah somod:
wyrsan wīg-frecan wæl rēafedon
æfter gūð-sceare, Gēata lēode
1215 hreā-wīc hēoldon. Heal swēge onfēng.
Wealhþeo maðelode, hēo fore þām werede spræc:
"Brūc þisses bēages, Bēowulf, lēofa

- "hyse, mid hāle, and þisses hrægles nēot
 "þēod-gestrēona, and geþēoh tela,
 1220 "cen þec mid cræfte and þyssum cnýhtum wes
 "lāra līðe! ic þē þæs lēan geman.
 "Hafast þū gefēred, þæt þē feor and nēah
 "ealne wīde-ferhð weras ehtigað,
 "efne swā sīde swā sǣ bebūgeð
 1225 "windige weallas. Wes, þenden þū lifige,
 "æðeling ēadig! ic þē an tela
 "sinc-gestrēona. Bēo þū suna mīnum
 "dǣdum gedēfe drēam healdende!
 "Hēr is æghwylc eorl ōðrum getrýwe,
 1230 "mōdes milde, man-drihtne hold,
 "þegnas syndon geþwāre, þēod eal gearo:
 "druncne dryht-guman, dōð swā ic bidde!"
 Ēode þā tō setle. Þær wæs symbla cyst,
 druncon wīn weras: wyrd ne cūdon,
 1235 geō-sceaft grimme, swā hit āgangen wearð
 eorla manegum, syððan æfen cwōm
 and him Hrōðgār gewāt tō hofe sīnum,
 rīce tō ræste. Reced weardode
 unrīm eorla, swā hīe oft ǣr dydon:
 1240 benc-þelu beredon, hit geond-bræded wearð
 beddum and bolstrum. Bēor-scealca sum
 fūs and fāge flet-ræste gebēag.
 Setton him tō hēafdum hilde-randas,
 bord-wudu beorhtan; þær on bence wæs
 1245 ofer æðelinge yð-gesēne
 heaðo-stēapa helm, hringed byrne,
 þrec-wudu þrymlic. Wæs þēaw hyra,
 þæt hīe oft wæron an wīg gearwe,
 gē æt hām gē on herge, gē gehwæðer þāra
 1250 efne swylce mæla, swylce hira man-dryhtne
 þearf gesælde; wæs sēo þēod tilu.

Grendel's Mother Attacks the Ring-Danes

Fit XX

- Sigon þā tō slāpe. Sum sære angeald
æfen-ræste, swā him ful-oft gelamp,
siððan gold-sele Grendel warode,
1255 unriht æfnde, oð þæt ende becwōm,
swylt æfter synnum. Þæt gesȳne wearð,
wīd-cūð werum, þætte wrecend þā gýt
lifde æfter lāðum, lange þrāge
æfter gūð-ceare; Grendles mōdor,
1260 ides āglāc-wīf yrmðe gemunde,
sē þe wæter-egesan wunian scolde,
cealde strēamas, siððan Cain wearð
tō ecg-banan āngan brēðer,
fæderen-mæge; hē þā fāg gewāt,
1265 morðre gemearcod man-drēam flēon,
wēsten warode. Þanon wōc fela
geōsceaft-gāsta; wæs þāra Grendel sum,
heoro-wearh hetelīc, sē æt Heorote fand
wæccendne wer wīges bīdan,
1270 þær him āglāca æt-grāpe wearð;
hwæðre hē gemunde mægenes strenge,
gim-fæste gife, þē him god sealde,
and him tō anwaldan āre gelȳfde,
frōfre and fultum: þȳ hē þone fēond ofercwōm,
1275 gehnægde helle gāst: þā hē hēan gewāt,
drēame bedæled dēað-wīc sēon,

- man-cynnes fēond. And his mōdor þā gýt
 gīfre and galg-mōd gegān wolde
 sorh-fulne sīð, suna dēað wrecan.
- 1280 Cōm þā tō Heorote, þær Hring-Dene
 geond þæt sæld swāfun. Þā þær sōna wearð
 ed-hwyrft eorlum, siððan inne fealh
 Grendles mōdor; wæs se gryre lāssa
 efne swā micle, swā bið mægða cræft,
- 1285 wīg-gryre wīfes be wāpned-men,
 þonne heoru bunden, hamere gepuren,
 sweord swāte fāh swīn ofer helme,
 ecgum dyhtig andweard scireð.
 Þā wæs on healle heard-ecg togen,
- 1290 sweord ofer setlum, sīd-rand manig
 hafen handa fæst; helm ne gemunde,
 byrnan sīde, þe hine se brōga angeat.
 Hēo wæs on ofste, wolde ūt þanon
 fēore beorgan, þā hēo onfunden wæs;
- 1295 hraðe hēo æðelinga ānne hæfde
 fæste befangen, þā hēo tō fenne gang;
 sē wæs Hrōðgāre hæleða lēofost
 on gesīðes hād be sām tweonum,
 rīce rand-wiga, þone þe hēo on ræste ābrēat,
- 1300 blæd-fæstne beorn. Næs Bēowulf þær,
 ac wæs oðer in ær geteohhod
 æfter mādðum-gife mærum Gēate.
 Hrēam wearð on Heorote. Hēo under heolfre genam
 cūðe folme; cearu wæs genīwod
- 1305 geworden in wīcum: ne wæs þæt gewrixle til,
 þæt hīe on bā healfa bicgan scoldon
 frēonda fēorum. Þā wæs frōd cyning,
 hār hilde-rinc, on hrēon mōde,
 syððan hē aldor-þegn unlyfigendne,
- 1310 þone dēorestan dēadne wisse.
 Hraðe wæs tō būre Bēowulf fetod,
 sigor-ēadig secg. Samod ær-dæge
 ēode eorla sum, æðele cempa
 self mid gesīðum, þær se snottra bād,
- 1315 hwæðre him al-walda æfre wille

æfter wēa-spelle wyrpe gefremman.
Gang þā æfter flōre fyrd-wyrðe man
mid his hand-scale (heal-wudu dynede)
þæt hē þone wīsan wordum hnægde
1320 frēan Ingwina; frægn gif him wære
æfter nēod-laðu niht getæse.

Sorrow at Heorot: Aeschere's Death

Fit XXI

- Hrōðgār maðelode, helm Scildinga:
"Ne frīn þū æfter sǣlum! Sorh is genīwod
"Denigea lēodum. Dēad is Æsc-here,
1325 "Yrmenlāfes yldra brōðor,
"mīn rūn-wita and mīn rǣd-bora,
"eaxl-gestealla, þonne wē on orlege
"hafelan weredon, þonne hniton fēðan,
"eoferas cnysedan; swylc scolde eorl wesan
1330 "æðeling ær-gōd, swylc Æsc-here wæs.
"Wearð him on Heorote tō hand-banan
"wæl-gæst wæfre; ic ne wāt hwæder
"atol æse wlanc eft-sīðas tēah,
"fylle gefrægnod. Hēo þā fāhðe wræc,
1335 "þē þū gystran niht Grendel cwealdest
"þurh hǣstne hād heardum clammum,
"forþan hē tō lange lēode mīne
"wanode and wyrde. Hē æt wīge gecrang
"ealdres scyldig, and nū oðer cwōm
1340 "mihtig mǣn-scaða, wolde hyre mæg wrecan,
"gē feor hafað fāhðe gestæled,
"þæs þe þincean mæg þegne monegum,
"sē þe æfter sinc-gyfan on sefan grēoteð,
"hreðer-bealo hearde; nū sēo hand ligeð,
1345 "sē þe ēow wēl-hwylcra wilna dohte.
"Ic þæt lond-būend lēode mīne

- "sele-rædende secgan hȳrde,
 "þæt hīe gesāwon swylce twēgen
 "micle mearc-stapan mōras healdan,
 1350 "ellor-gæstas: þāra oðer wæs,
 "þæs þe hīe gewislicost gewitan meahton,
 "idese onlīcnes, oðer earm-sceapen
 "on weres wæstmum wræc-lāstas træd,
 "næfne hē wæs māra þonne ænig man oðer,
 1355 "þone on geār-dagum Grendel nemdon
 "fold-būende: nō hīe fæder cunnon,
 "hwæðer him ænig wæs ær ācenned
 "dymra gāsta. Hīe dȳgel lond
 "warigeað, wulf-hleoðu, windige næssas,
 1360 "frēcne fen-gelād, þær fyr-gen-strēam
 "under næssa genipu niðer gewīteð,
 "flōd under foldan; nis þæt feor heonon
 "mīl-gemearces, þæt se mere standeð,
 "ofer þām hongiað hrīmge bearwas,
 1365 "wudu wyrtum fæst, wæter oferhelmað.
 "Þær mæg nihta gehwām nīð-wundor sēon,
 "fȳr on flōde; nō þæs frōd leofað
 "gumena bearna, þæt þone grund wite;
 "pēah þe hāð-stapa hundum geswenced,
 1370 "heorot hornum trum holt-wudu sēce,
 "feorran geflȳmed, ær hē feorh seleð,
 "aldor on ofre, ær hē in wille,
 "hafelan hȳdan. Nis þæt hēoru stōw:
 "þonon ȳð-geblond up āstīgeð
 1375 "won tō wolcnum, þonne wind styreð
 "lāð gewidru, oð þæt lyft drysmað,
 "roderas rēotað. Nū is ræd gelang
 "eft æt þē ānum! Eard gīt ne const,
 "frēcne stōwe, þær þū findan miht
 1380 "sinnigne secg: sēc gif þū dyrre!
 "Ic þe þā fæhðe fēo lēanige,
 "eald-gestrēonum, swā ic ær dyde,
 "wundnum golde, gyf þū on weg cymest."

Bēowulf Seeks the Monster in the Haunts of the Nixies

Fit XXII

- Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgþēowes:
1385 "Ne sorga, snotor guma! sēlre bið æghwæm,
"þæt hē his frēond wrece, þonne hē fela murne;
"ūre æghwylc sceal ende gebīdan
"worolde lifes; wyrce sē þe mōte
"dōmes ær dēaðe! þæt bið driht-guman
1390 "unlifgendum æfter sēlest.
"Ārīs, rīces weard; uton hraðe fēran,
"Grendles māgan gang scēawigan!
"Ic hit þe gehāte: nō hē on helm losað,
"nē on foldan fæðm, nē on fyrgen-holt,
1395 "nē on gyfenes grund, gā þær hē wille.
"Þys dōgor þū geþyld hafa
"wēana gehwylces, swā ic þe wēne tō!"
Āhlēop þā se gomela, gode þancode,
mihtigan drihtne, þæs se man gespræc.
1400 Þā wæs Hrōðgāre hors gebæted,
wicg wunden-feax. Wīsa fengel
geatolīc gengde; gum-fēða stōp
lind-hæbbendra. Lāstas wæron
æfter wald-swaðum wīde gesýne,
1405 gang ofer grundas; gegnum fōr þā
ofer myrcan mōr, mago-þegna bær
þone sēlestan sāwol-lēasne,
þāra þe mid Hrōðgāre hām eahtode.

- Ofer-ēode þā æðelinga bearn
 1410 stēap stān-hliðo, stige nearwe,
 enge ān-paðas, un-cūð gelād,
 neowle næssas, nicor-hūsa fela;
 hē fēara sum beforan gengde
 wīstra monna, wong scēawian,
 1415 oð þæt hē fāringa fyr-gen-bēamas
 ofer hārne stān hleonian funde,
 wyn-lēasne wudu; wæter under stōd
 drēorig and gedrēfed. Denum eallum wæs,
 winum Scyldinga, weorce on mōde,
 1420 tō gepolianne þegne monegum,
 oncȳð eorla gehwām, syððan Æsc-heres
 on þām holm-clife hafelan mēttan.
 Flōd blōde wēol (folc tō sǣgon)
 hātan heolfre. Horn stundum song
 1425 fūslic fyrd-lēoð. Fēða eal gesæt;
 gesāwon þā æfter wætere wyrm-cynnes fela,
 sellīce sǣ-dracan sund cunnian,
 swylce on næs-hleoðum nicras licgean,
 þā on undern-mæl oft bewitigað
 1430 sorh-fulne sīð on segl-rāde,
 wyrmas and wil-dēor; hīe on weg hruron
 bitere and gebolgne, bearhtm ongeāton,
 gūð-horn galan. Sumne Gēata lēod
 of flān-bogan fēores getwǣfde,
 1435 ȳð-gewinnes, þæt him on aldre stōd
 here-strǣl hearda; hē on holme wæs
 sundes þē sǣnra, þē hyne swylt fornam.
 Hræðe wearð on ȳðum mid eofer-sprēotum
 heoro-hōcȳhtum hearde genearwod,
 1440 nīða genǣged and on næs togen
 wundorlic wæg-bora; weras scēawedon
 gryrelīcne gist. Gyrede hine Bēowulf
 eorl-gewǣdum, nalles for ealdre mearn:
 scolde here-byrne hondum gebrōden,
 1445 sīd and searo-fāh, sund cunnian,
 sēo þe bān-cofan beorgan cūðe,
 þæt him hilde-grāp hreðre ne mihte,

- eorres inwit-feng, aldre gesceððan;
 ac se hwīta helm hafelan werede,
 1450 sē þe mere-grundas mengan scolde,
 sēcan sund-gebland since geweorðad,
 befongen frēa-wrāsnum, swā hine fyrn-dagum
 worhte wāpna smið, wundrum tēode,
 besette swīn-līcum, þæt hine syððan nō
 1455 brond nē beado-mēcas bītan ne meahton.
 Næs þæt þonne mætost mægen-fultuma,
 þæt him on þearfe lāh þyle Hrōðgāres;
 wæs þām hæft-mēce Hrunting nama,
 þæt wæs ān foran eald-gestrēona;
 1460 ecg wæs īren āter-tēarum fāh,
 āhyrded heaðo-swāte; nāfre hit æt hilde ne swāc
 manna ængum þāra þe hit mid mundum bewand,
 sē þe gryre-siðas gegān dorste,
 folc-stede fāra; næs þæt forma sið,
 1465 þæt hit ellen-weorc æfnan scolde.
 Hūru ne gemunde mago Ecglāfes
 eafodes cræftig, þæt hē ær gespræc
 wīne druncen, þā hē þæs wāpnes onlāh
 sēlran sweord-frecan: selfa ne dorste
 1470 under yðā gewin aldre genēðan,
 driht-scype drēogan; þær hē dōme forlēas,
 ellen-mārðum. Ne wæs þām oðrum swā,
 syððan hē hine tō gūðe gegyred hæfde.

The Battle with the Water-Drake

Fit XXIII

- Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgþēowes:
1475 "geþenc nū, se mæra maga Healfdenes,
"snottra fengel, nū ic eom sīðes fūs,
"gold-wine gumena, hwæt wit geō spræcon,
"gif ic æt þearfe þīnre scolde
"aldre linnan, þæt þū mē ā wære
1480 "forð-gewitenum on fæder stæle;
"wes þū mund-bora mīnum mago-þegnum,
"hond-gesellum, gif mec hild nime:
"swylce þū þā mādmas, þē þū mē sealdest,
"Hrōðgār lēofa, Higelāce onsend.
1485 "Mæg þonne on þām golde ongitan Gēata dryhten,
"gesēon sunu Hrēðles, þonne hē on þæt sinc starað,
"þæt ic gum-cystum gōdne funde
"bēaga bryttan, brēac þonne mōste.
"And þū Unferð læt ealde lāfe,
1490 "wrætlic wæg-sweord wīd-cūðne man
"heard-ecg habban; ic mē mid Hruntinge
"dōm gewyrce, oððe mec dēað nimeð."
Æfter þām wordum Weder-Gēata lēod
efste mid elne, nalas andsware
1495 bīdan wolde; brim-wylm onfēng
hilde-rince. Þā wæs hwīl dæges,
ær hē þone grund-wong ongytan mehte.
Sōna þæt onfunde, sē þe flōda begong

- heoro-gīfre behēold hund missēra,
 1500 grim and grādig, þæt þær gumena sum
 aël-wihta eard ufan cunnode.
 Grāp þā tōgēanes, gūð-rinc gefēng
 atolan clommum; nō þȳ ær in gescōd
 hālan lice: hring ūtan ymb-bearh,
 1505 þæt hēo þone fyrd-hom þurh-fōn ne mihte,
 locene leoðo-syrca lāðan fingrum.
 Bær þā sēo brim-wylf, þā hēo tō botme cōm,
 hringa þengel tō hofe sīnum,
 swā hē ne mihte nō (hē þæs mōdig wæs)
 1510 wæpna gewealdan, ac hine wundra þæs fela
 swencte on sunde, sǣ-dēor monig
 hilde-tūxum here-syrca bræc,
 ēhton āglæcan. Þā se eorl ongeat,
 þæt hē in nið-sele nāt-hwylcum wæs,
 1515 þær him nānig wæter wihte ne sceðede,
 nē him for hrōf-sele hrīnan ne mehte
 fær-gripe flōdes: fȳr-lēoht geseah,
 blācne lēoman beorhte scīnan.
 Ongeat þā se gōda grund-wyrgerne,
 1520 mere-wīf mihtig; mægen-ræs forgeaf
 hilde-bille, hond swenge ne oftēah,
 þæt hire on hafelan hring-mǣl āgōl
 grādig gūð-lēoð. Þā se gist onfand,
 þæt se beado-lēoma bītan nolde,
 1525 aldre sceððan, ac sēo ecg geswāc
 þēodne æt þearfe: þolode ær fela
 hond-gemōta, helm oft gescær,
 fāges fyrd-hrægl: þæt wæs forma sīð
 dēorum māðme, þæt his dōm ālæg.
 1530 Eft wæs ān-ræd, nalas elnes læt,
 mārða gemyndig mæg Hygelāces;
 wearp þā wunden-mǣl wrættum gebunden
 yrre ōretta, þæt hit on eorðan læg,
 stīð and stȳl-ecg; strenge getruwode,
 1535 mund-gripe mægenes. Swā sceal man dōn,
 þonne hē æt gūðe gegān þenceð
 longsumne lof, nā ymb his lif cearað.

- Gefēng þā be eaxle (nalas for fāhðe mearn)
 Gūð-Gēata lēod Grendles mōdor;
 1540 brægd þā beadwe heard, þā hē gebolgen wæs,
 feorh-geñiðlan, þæt hēo on flet gebēah.
 Hēo him eft hraðe and-lēan forgeald
 grimman grāpum and him tōgēanes fēng;
 oferwearp þā wērig-mōd wigena strengest,
 1545 fēðe-cempa, þæt hē on fylle wearð.
 Ofsæt þā þone sele-gyst and hyre seaxe getēah,
 brād and brūn-ecg wolde hire bearn wrecan,
 āngan eaferan. Him on eaxle læg
 brēost-net brōden; þæt gebearh fēore,
 1550 wið ord and wið ecge ingang forstōd.
 Hæfde þā forsīðod sunu Ecgpēowes
 under gynne grund, Gēata cempa,
 nemne him heaðo-byrne helpe gefremede,
 here-net hearde, and hālig god
 1555 gewēold wīg-sigor, wītig drihten;
 rodera rædend hit on ryht gescēd,
 yðelīce syððan hē eft āstōd.

Bēowulf Slays the Sprite

Fit XXIV

- Geseah þā on searwum sige-ēadig bil,
eald sweord eotenisc ecgum þȳhtig,
1560 wigena weorð-mynd: þæt wæs wāpnā cyst,
būton hit wæs mære þonne ænig mon oðer
tō beadu-lāce ætberan meahte
gōd and geatolīc gīganta geweorc.
Hē gefēng þā fetel-hilt, freca Scildinga,
1565 hrēoh and heoro-grim hring-mæl gebrægd,
aldres orwēna, yrringa slōh,
þæt hire wið halse heard grāpode,
bān-hringas bræc, bil eal þurh-wōd
fægne flæsc-homan, hēo on flet gecrong;
1570 sweord wæs swātig, secg weorce gefeh.
Līxte se lēoma, lēoht inne stōd,
efne swā of hefene hādre scīneð
rodores candel. Hē æfter recede wlāt,
hwearf þā be wealle, wāpen hafenade
1575 heard be hiltum Higelāces þegn,
yrre and ān-ræd. Næs sēo ecg fracod
hilde-rince, ac hē hraðe wolde
Grendle forgyldan gūð-ræsa fela
þāra þe hē geworhte tō West-Denum
1580 oftor micle þonne on ænne sīð,
þonne hē Hrōðgāres heorð-genēatas
slōh on sweofote, slāpende fræt
folces Denigea fȳf-tȳne men
and oðer swylc ūt of-ferede,

- 1585 lāðlicu lāc. Hē him þæs lēan forgeald,
 rēðe cempa, tō þæs þe hē on ræste geseah
 gūð-wērigne Grendel licgan,
 aldor-lēasne, swā him ær gescōd
 hild æt Heorote; hrā wīde sprong,
 1590 syððan hē æfter dēaðe drepe þrowade,
 heoro-sweng heardne, and hine þā hēafde becearf,
 Sōna þæt gesāwon snottre ceorlas,
 þā þe mid Hrōðgāre on holm wliton,
 þæt wæs yð-geblond eal gemenged,
 1595 brim blōde fāh: blonden-feaxe
 gomele ymb gōdne ongeador spræcon,
 þæt hig þæs æðelinges eft ne wēndon,
 þæt hē sige-hrēðig sēcean cōme
 mārne þeoden; þā þæs monige gewearð,
 1600 þæt hine sēo brim-wylf ābroten hæfde.
 Þā cōm nōn dāges. Næs ofgēafon
 hwate Scyldingas; gewāt him hām þonon
 gold-wine gumena. Gistas sētan,
 mōdes sēoce, and on mere staredon,
 1605 wiston and ne wēndon, þæt hīe heora wine-drihten
 selfne gesāwon. Þā þæt sweord ongan
 æfter heaðo-swāte hilde-gicelum
 wīg-bil wanian; þæt wæs wundra sum,
 þæt hit eal gemealt īse gelīcost,
 1610 þonne forstes bend fæder onlæteð,
 onwindeð wæl-rāpas, sē þe geweald hafað
 sæla and mæla; þæt is sōð metod.
 Ne nom hē in þām wīcum, Weder-Gēata lēod,
 māðm-æhta mā, þēh hē þær monige geseah,
 1615 būton þone hafelan and þā hilt somod,
 since fāge; sweord ær gemealt,
 forbarn brōden mæl: wæs þæt blōd tō þæs hāt,
 ættren ellor-gæst, sē þær inne swealt.
 Sōna wæs on sunde, sē þe ær æt sæcce gebād
 1620 wīg-hryre wrāðra, wæter up þurh-dēaf;
 wæron yð-gebland eal gefælsod,
 ēacne eardas, þā se ellor-gæst
 oflēt lif-dagas and þās lēnan gesceaft.

- Cōm þā tō lande lid-manna helm
 1625 swīð-mōd swymman, sǣ-lāce gefeah,
 mægen-byrðenne þāra þe hē him mid hæfde.
 Ēodon him þā tōgēanes, gode þancodon,
 þrȳðlic þegna hēap, þēodnes gefēgon,
 þæs þe hī hyne gesundne gesēon mōston.
 1630 Þā wæs of þām hrōran helm and byrne
 lungre ālȳsed: lagu drūsade,
 wæter under wolcnum, wæl-drēore fāg.
 Fērdon forð þonon fēðe-lāstum
 ferhðum fægne, fold-weg mǣton,
 1635 cūðe stræte; cyning-balde men
 from þām holm-clife hafelan bāron
 earfoðlice heora æghwæðrum
 fela-mōdigra: fēower scoldon
 on ðām wæl-stenge weorcum geferian
 1640 tō þām gold-sele Grendles hēafod,
 oð þæt semninga tō sele cōmon
 frome fyrd-hwate fēower-tȳne
 Gēata gongan; gum-dryhten mid
 mōdig on gemonge meodo-wongas træd.
 1645 Þā cōm in gān ealdor þegna,
 dǣd-cēne mon dōme gewurðad,
 hæle hilde-dēor. Hrōðgār grētan:
 Þā wæs be feaxe on flet boren
 Grendles hēafod, þær guman druncon,
 1650 egeslic for eorlum and þære idese mid:
 wlite-sēon wrætlic weras onsāwon.

Hrothgar's Gratitude: He Discourses

Fit XXV

- Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgbēowes:
"Hwæt! wē þē þās sǣ-lāc, sunu Healfdenes,
"lēod Scyldinga, lustum brōhton,
1655 "tīres tō tǣcne, þē þū hēr tō lōcast.
"Ic þæt unsōfte ealdre gedigde:
"wigge under wætere weorc genēðde
"earfoðlice, æt-rihte wæs
"gūð getwāfed, nymðe mec god scylde.
1660 "Ne meahte ic æt hilde mid Hruntinge
"wiht gewyrcean, þēah þæt wæpen dūge,
"ac mē geūðe ylða waldend,
"þæt ic on wāge geseah wlitig hangian
"eald sweord ēacen (oftost wīsode
1665 "winigea lēasum) þæt ic þȳ wæpne gebræ.
"Ofslōh þā æt þære sǣcce (þā mē sǣl āgeald)
"hūses hyrdas. Þā þæt hilde-bil
"forbarn, brogden mǣl, swā þæt blōd gesprang,
"hātost heaðo-swāta: ic þæt hilt þānan
1670 "fēondum ætferede; fyren-dāda wræc,
"dēað-cwealm Denigea, swā hit gedēfe wæs.
"Ic hit þē þonne gehāte, þæt þū on Heorote mōst
"sorh-lēas swefan mid þīnra secga gedryht,
"and þegna gehwylc þīnra lēoda,
1675 "duguðe and ioguðe, þæt þū him ondrædan ne þearft,
"pēoden Scyldinga, on þā healfe,

- "aldor-bealu eorlum, swā þū ær dydest."
 Pā wæs gylden hilt gamelum rince.
 hārum hild-fruman, on hand gyfen,
 1680 enta ær-geweorc, hit on æht gehwearf
 æfter dēofla hryre Denigea frēan,
 wundor-smiða geweorc, and pā pās worold ofgeaf
 grom-heort guma, godes andsaca,
 morðres scyldig, and his mōdor ēac;
 1685 on geweald gehwearf worold-cyninga
 þām sēlestan be sām twēonum
 pāra þe on Sceden-igge sceattas dælde.
 Hrōðgār maðelode, hylt scēawode,
 ealde lāfe, on þām wæs ōr writen
 1690 fyrn-gewinnes: syððan flōd ofslōh,
 gifen gēotende, gīganta cyn,
 frēcne gefērdon: þæt wæs fremde þēod
 ēcean dryhtne, him pæs ende-lēan
 þurh wæteres wylm waldend sealde.
 1695 Swā wæs on þām scennum scīran goldes
 þurh rūn-stafas rihte gemearcod,
 geseted and gesæd, hwām þæt sweord geworht,
 irena cyst ærest wære,
 wreoðen-hilt and wyrm-fāh. pā se wīsa spræc
 1700 sunu Healfdenes (swīgedon ealle):
 "Þæt lā mæg secgan, sē þe sōð and riht
 "fremeð on folce, (feor eal gemon
 "eald ēðel-weard), þæt þes eorl wære
 "geboren betera! Blæd is āræred
 1705 "geond wīd-wegas, wine mīn Bēowulf,
 "þīn ofer þēoda gehwylce. Eal þū hit gepylдум healdest,
 "mægen mid mōdes snyttrum. Ic þe sceal mīne gelæstan
 "frēode, swā wit furðum spræcon; þū scealt tō frōfre we-
 orðan
 "eal lang-twidig lēodum þīnum,
 1710 "hæleðum tō helpe. Ne wearð Heremōd swā
 "eaforum Ecgwelan, Ār-Scyldingum;
 "ne gewēox hē him tō willan, ac tō wæl-fealle
 "and tō dēað-cwalum Deniga lēodum;
 "brēat bolgen-mōd bēod-genēatas,

- 1715 "eaxl-gesteallan, oð þæt hē āna hwearf,
 "māre þēoden. mon-drēamum from:
 "þeah þe hine mihtig god mægenes wynnum,
 "eafeðum stēpte, ofer ealle men
 "forð gefremede, hwæðere him on ferhðe grēow
 1720 "brēost-hord blōd-rēow: nallas bēagas geaf
 "Denum æfter dōme; drēam-lēas gebād,
 "þæt hē þæs gewinnes weorc þrowade,
 "lēod-bealo longsum. Þū þē lār be þon,
 "gum-cyste ongit! ic þis gid be þē
 1725 "āwræc wintrum frōd. Wundor is tō secganne,
 "hū mihtig god manna cynne
 "þurh sīdne sefan snyttru bryttað,
 "eard and eorl-scipe, hē āh ealra geweald.
 "Hwīlum hē on lufan lāteð hworfan
 1730 "monnes mōd-geþonc mæran cynnes,
 "seleð him on ēðle eorðan wyne,
 "tō healdanne hlēo-burh wera,
 "gedēð him swā gewealdene worolde dālas,
 "sīde rīce, þæt hē his selfa ne mæg
 1735 "for his un-snyttrum ende gepencean;
 "wunað hē on wiste, nō hine wiht dweleð,
 "ādī nē ylðo, nē him inwit-sorh
 "on sefan sweorceð, nē gesacu ōhwær,
 "ecg-hete ēoweð, ac him eal worold
 1740 "wendeð on willan; hē þæt wyrse ne con,
 "oð þæt him on innan ofer-hygda dæl
 "weaxeð and wridað, þonne se weard swefeð,
 "sāwele hyrde: bið se slæp tō fæst,
 "bisgum gebunden, bona swīðe nēah,
 1745 "sē þe of flān-bogan fyrenum scēoteð.

The Discourse Is Ended.-Bēowulf Prepares to Leave

Fit XXVI

"Ponne bið on hreðre under helm drepem
"biteran stræle: him bebeorgan ne con
"wom wundor-bebodum wergan gāstes;
"þinceð him tō lýtēl, þæt hē tō lange hēold,
1750 "gȳtsað grom-hȳdig, nallas on gylp seleð
"fætte bēagas and hē þā forð-gesceaft
"forgyteð and forgȳmeð, þæs þe him ær god sealde
"wuldres waldend, weorð-mynda dæl.
"Hit on ende-stæf eft gelimpeð,
1755 "þæt se līc-homa lāne gedrēoseð,
"fæge gefealleð; fēhð oðer tō,
"sē þe unmunlice mādmas dāleð,
"eorles ær-gestrēon, egesan ne gȳmeð.
"Bebeorh þē þone bealo-nīð, Bēowulf lēofa,
1760 "secg se betsta, and þē þæt sēlre gecēos,
"ēce rādas; oferhȳda ne gȳm,
"mære cempa! Nū is þīnes mægnes blād
"āne hwīle; eft sōna bið,
"þæt þec ādl oððe ecg eafoðes getwāfeð,
1765 "oððe fȳres feng oððe flōdes wylm,
"oððe gripe mēces oððe gāres fliht,
"oððe atol ylðo, oððe ēagena bearhtm
"forsiteð and forsworced; semninga bið,

- "þæt þec, dryht-guma, dēað oferswýðeð.
 1770 "Swā ic Hring-Dena hund missēra
 "wēold under wolcnum, and hig wigge belēac
 "manigum mægða geond þysne middan-geard,
 "æscum and ecgum, þæt ic mē ænigne
 "under swegles begong gesacan ne tealde.
 1775 "Hwæt! mē þæs on ēðle edwenden cwōm,
 "gryn æfter gomene, seoððan Grendel wearð,
 "eald-gewinna, in-genga mīn:
 "ic þære sōcne singāles wæg
 "mōd-ceare micle. Þæs sig metode þanc,
 1780 "ēcean drihtne, þæs þe ic on aldre gebād,
 "þæt ic on þone hafelan heoro-drēorigne
 "ofer eald gewin ēagum starige!
 "Gā nū tō setle, symbel-wynne drēoh
 "wīgge weorðad: unc sceal worn fela
 1785 "māðma gemānra, siððan morgen bið."
 Gēat wæs glæd-mōd, gēong sōna tō,
 setles nēosan, swā se snottra heht.
 Þā wæs eft swā ær ellen-rōfum,
 flet-sittendum fægere gereorded
 1790 nīowan stefne. Niht-helm geswearc
 deorc ofer dryht-gumum. Duguð eal ārās;
 wolde blonden-feax beddes nēosan,
 gamela Scylding. Gēat ungemetes wēl,
 rōfne rand-wigan restan lyste:
 1795 sōna him sele-þegn sīðes wērgum,
 feorran-cundum forð wīsade,
 se for andrysum ealle beweotede
 þegnes þearfe, swylce þy dōgore
 hēaðo-liðende habban scoldon.
 1800 Reste hine þā rūm-heort; reced hlīfade
 gēap and gold-fāh, gæst inne swæf,
 oð þæt hrefn blaca heofones wynne
 blið-heort bodode. Þā cōm beorht sunne
 scacan ofer grundas; scaðan ōnetton,
 1805 wāron æðelingas eft tō lēodum
 fūse tō farenne, wolde feor þanon
 cuma collen-ferhð cēoles nēosan.

Heht þā se hearda Hrunting beran,
sunu Ecglāfes, heht his sweord niman,
1810 lēoflic īren; sægde him þæs lēanes þanc,
cwæð hē þone gūð-wine gōdne tealde,
wīg-cræftigne, nales wordum lōg
mēces ecge: þæt wæs mōdig secg.
And þā sīð-frome searwum gearwe
1815 wīgend wæron, ēode weorð Denum
æðeling tō yppan, þær se oðer wæs
hæle hilde-dēor, Hrōðgār grētte.

The Parting Words

Fit XXVII

- Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgbēowes:
"Nū wē sǣ-liðend secgan wyllað
1820 "feorran cumene, þæt wē fundiað
"Higelāc sēcan. Wæron hēr tela
"willum bewenede; þū ūs wēl dohtest.
"Gif ic þonne on eorðan ōwihte mæg
"þīnre mōd-lufan mārān tilian,
1825 "gumena dryhten, þonne ic gýt dyde,
"gūð-geweorca ic bēo gearo sōna.
"Gif ic þæt gefricge ofer flōda begang,
"þæt þec ymbe-sittend egesan þýwað,
"swā þec hetende hwīlum dydon,
1830 "ic þē þūsenda þegna bringe,
"hæleða tō helpe. Ic on Higelāce wāt,
"Gēata dryhten, þēah þe hē geong sý,
"folces hyrde, þæt hē mec fremman wile
"wordum and worcum, þæt ic þē wēl herige,
1835 "and þē tō gēoce gār-holt bere
"mægenes fultum, þær þē bið manna þearf;
"gif him þonne Hrēðric tō hofum Gēata
"geþingeð, þēodnes bearn, hē mæg þær fela
"frēonda findan: feor-cýððe bēoð
1840 "sēlran gesōhte þām þe him selfa dēah."
Hrōðgār maðelode him on andsware:
"Þē þā word-cwydas wittig drihten
"on sefan sende! ne hýrde ic snotorlicor
"on swā geongum feore guman þingian:

- 1845 "þū eart mægenes strang and on mōde frōd,
 "wīs word-cwida. Wēn ic talige,
 "gif þæt gegangeð, þæt þe gār nymeð,
 "hild heoru-grimme Hrēðles eaferan,
 "ādī oððe īren ealdor þīnne,
 1850 "folces hyrde, and þū þīn feorh hafast,
 "þæt þe Sæ-Gēatas sēlran næbben
 "tō gecēosenne cyning ænigne,
 "hord-weard hæleða, gif þū healdan wylt
 "māga rīce. Mē þīn mōd-sefa
 1855 "līcað leng swā wēl, lēofa Bēowulf:
 "hafast þū gefēred, þæt þām folcum sceal,
 "Gēata lēodum and Gār-Denum
 "sib gemānum and sacu restan,
 "inwit-nīðas, þē hīe ær drugon;
 1860 "wesān, þenden ic wealde wīdan rīces,
 "māðmas gemāne, manig oðerne
 "gōdum gegrētan ofer ganotes bæð;
 "sceal hring-naca ofer hēaðu bringan
 "lāc and luf-tācen. Ic þā lēode wāt
 1865 "gē wið fēond gē wið frēond fæste geworhte
 "æghwæs untæle ealde wīsan."
 Þā gīt him eorla hlēo inne gesealde,
 mago Healfdenes māðmas twelfe,
 hēt hine mid þām lācum lēode swāse
 1870 sēcean on gesyntum, snūde eft cuman.
 Gecyste þā cyning æðelum gōd,
 þēoden Scildinga, þegen betstan
 and be healse genam; hruron him tēaras,
 blonden-feaxum: him wæs bēga wēn,
 1875 ealdum infrōdum, oðres swīðor,
 þæt hī seoððan gesēon mōston
 mōdige on meðle. Wæs him se man tō þon lēof,
 þæt hē þone brēost-wylm forberan ne mehte,
 ac him on hreðre hyge-bendum fæst
 1880 æfter dēorum men dyrne langað
 beorn wið blōde. Him Bēowulf þānan,
 gūð-rinc gold-wlanc græs-moldan træd,
 since hrēmig: sē-genga bād

āgend-frēan, sē þe on ancre rād.
1885 Þā wæs on gange gifu Hrōðgāres
oft geæhted: þæt wæs ān cyning
æghwæs orleahtrē, oð þæt hine ylðo benam
mægenes wynnum, sē þe oft manegum scōd.

Bēowulf Returns to Geatland.-The Queens Hygd and Thrytho

Fit XXVIII

- Cwōm þā tō flōde fela-mōdigra
1890 hæg-stealdra hēap; hring-net bāron,
locene leoðo-syrca. Land-weard onfand
eft-sið eorla, swā hē ær dyde;
nō hē mid hearme of hlīðes nosan
gæstas grētte, ac him tōgēanes rād;
1895 cwæð þæt wilcuman Wedera lēodum
scawan scīr-hame tō scipe fōron.
Þā wæs on sande sǣ-gēap naca
hladen here-wædum, hringed-stefna
mēarum and mǣðmum: mæst hlīfade
1900 ofer Hrōðgāres hord-gestrēonum.
Hē þām bāt-wearde bunden golde
swurd gesealde, þæt hē syððan wæs
on meodu-bence mǣðme þy weorðra,
yrfe-lāfe. Gewāt him on yð-nacan,
1905 drēfan dēop wæter, Dena land ofgeaf.
Þā wæs be mæste mere-hrægla sum,
segl sǣle fæst. Sund-wudu þunede,
nō þær wēg-flotan wind ofer yðum
siðes getwǣfde; sǣ-genga fōr,
1910 flēat fāmig-heals forð ofer yðe,
bunden-stefna ofer brim-strēamas,

- þæt hīe Gēata clifu ongitan meahton,
 cūðe næssas. Cēol up geþrang,
 lyft-geswenced on lande stōd.
 1915 Hraðe wæs æt holme hȳð-weard gearo,
 sē þe ær lange tīd, lēofra manna
 fūs, æt faroðe feor wlātode;
 sælde tō sande sīd-fæðme scip
 oncer-bendum fæst, þȳ læs hym ȳða þrym
 1920 wudu wynsuman forwrecan meahte.
 Hēt þā up beran æðelinga gestrēon,
 frætwe and fæt-gold; næs him feor þanon
 tō gesēcanne sinces bryttan:
 Higelāc Hrēðling þær æt hām wunað,
 1925 selfa mid gesīðum sǣ-wealle nēah;
 bold wæs betlīc, brego-rōf cyning,
 hēa on healle, Hygd swīðe geong,
 wīs, wēl-þungen, þēah þe wintra lȳt
 under burh-locan gebiden hǣbbe
 1930 Hæreðes dōhtor: næs hīo hnāh swā þēah,
 nē tō gnēað gifa Gēata lēodum,
 māðm-gestrēona. Mod Þryðo wæg,
 fremu folces cwēn, firen ondrysne:
 nānig þæt dorste dēor genēðan
 1935 swāesra gesīða, nefne sin-frēa,
 þæt hire an dāges ēagum starede;
 ac him wæl-bende weotode tealde,
 hand-gewriðene: hraðe seoððan wæs
 æfter mund-gripe mēce gepinged,
 1940 þæt hit sceaðen-mæl scȳran mōste,
 cwealm-bealu cȳðan. Ne bið swylc cwēnlīc þēaw
 idese tō efnanne, þēah þe hīo ænlicu sȳ,
 þætte freoðu-webbe fēores onsæce
 æfter līge-torne lēofne mannan.
 1945 Hūru þæt onhōhsnode Heminges mæg;
 ealo drincende oðer sǣdan,
 þæt hīo lēod-bealewa læs gefremede,
 inwit-nīða, syððan ærest wearð
 gyfen gold-hroden geongum cēman,
 1950 æðelum dīore, syððan hīo Offan flet

ofer fealone flōd be fæder lāre
 sīðe gesōhte, þær hīo syððan wēl
 in gum-stōle, gōde mære,
 lif-gesceafta lifigende brēac,
 1955 hīold hēah-lufan wið hæleða brego,
 ealles mon-cynnes mīne gefræge
 þone sēlestan bī sām twēonum
 eormen-cynnes; forþām Offa wæs
 geofum and gūðum gār-cēne man,
 1960 wīde geweorðod; wīsdōme hēold
 ēðel sīnne, þonon Ēomær wōc
 hæleðum tō helpe, Heminges mæg,
 nefa Gārmundes, nīða cræftig.

His Arrival. Hygelac's Reception

Fit XXIX

- Gewāt him þā se hearda mid his hond-scole
1965 sylf æfter sande sǣ-wong tredan,
wīde waroðas. Woruld-candel scān,
sigel sūðan fūs: hī sīð drugon,
elne geēodon, tō þæs þe eorla hlēo,
bonan Ongenþēowes burgum on innan,
1970 geongne gūð-cyning gōdne gefrūnon
hringas dǣlan. Higelāce wæs
sīð Bēowulfes snūde gecȳðed,
þæt þær on worðig wīgendra hlēo,
lind-gestealla lifigende cwōm,
1975 heaðo-lāces hāl tō hofe gongan.
Hraðe wæs gerȳmed, swā se rīca bebēad,
fēðe-gestum flet innan-weard.
Gesæt þā wið sylfne, sē þā sæcce genæs,
mæg wið mæge, syððan man-dryhten
1980 þurh hlēoðor-cwyde holdne gegrēte
mēaglum wordum. Meodu-scencum
hwearf geond þæt reced Hæreðes dōhtor:
lufode þā lēode, līð-wæge bær
hælum tō handa. Higelāc ongan
1985 sīnne geseldan in sele þām hēan
fægre fricgean, hyne fyrwet bræc,
hwylce Sǣ-Gēata sīðas wæron:
"Hū lomp ēow on lāde, lēofa Bīowulf,

- "þā þū fāringa feorr gehogodest,
 1990 "sæcce sēcean ofer sealt wæter,
 "hilde tō Hiorote? Ac þū Hrōðgāre
 "wīd-cūðne wēan wihte gebēttest,
 "mārum þēodne? Ic þæs mōd-ceare
 "sorh-wylmum sēað, sīðe ne truwode
 1995 "lēofes mannes; ic þē lange bæd,
 "þæt þū þone wæl-gæst wihte ne grētte,
 "lēte Sūð-Dene sylfe geweorðan
 "gūðe wið Grendel. Gode ic þanc secge,
 "þæs þe ic þē gesundne gesēon mōste."
 2000 Bīowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgbīowes:
 "Þæt is undyrne, dryhten Higelāc,
 "māre gemēting monegum fira,
 "hwylc orleg-hwīl uncer Grendles
 "wearð on þām wange, þær hē worna fela
 2005 "Sige-Scildingum sorge gefremede,
 "yrmðe tō aldre; ic þæt eal gewræc,
 "swā ne gylpan þearf Grendles māga
 "ænig ofer eorðan ūht-hlem þone,
 "sē þe lengest leofað lāðan cynnes,
 2010 "fenne bifongen. Ic þær furðum cwōm,
 "tō þām hring-sele Hrōðgār grētan:
 "sōna mē se mæra mago Healfdenes,
 "syððan hē mōd-sefan mīnne cūðe,
 "wið his sylfes sunu setl getāhte.
 2015 "Weorod wæs on wynne; ne seah ic wīdan feorh
 "under heofenes hwealf heal-sittendra
 "medu-drēam māran. Hwīlum mæru cwēn,
 "friðu-sibb folca flet eall geond-hwearf,
 "bædde byre geonge; oft hīo bēah-wriðan
 2020 "secge sealde, ær hīo tō setle gēong.
 "Hwīlum for duguðe dōhtor Hrōðgāres
 "eorlum on ende ealu-wæge bær,
 "þā ic Frēaware flet-sittende
 "nemnan hýrde, þær hīo nægled sinc
 2025 "hæleðum sealde: sīo gehāten wæs,
 "geong gold-hroden, gladum suna Frōdan;
 "hafað þæs geworden wine Scyldinga

"rīces hyrde and þæt ræd talað,
"þæt hē mid þy wīfe wæl-fæhðā dæl,
2030 "sæcca gesette. Oft nō seldan hwær
"æfter lēod-hryre lȳtle hwīle
"bon-gār būgeð, þēah sēo brȳd dūge!

Bēowulf's Story of the Slayings

Fit XXX

- "Mæg þæs þonne ofþyncan þēoden Heaðobeardna
"and þegna gehwām þāra lēoda,
2035 "þonne hē mid fāmnan on flett gæð,
"dryht-bearn Dena duguða biwenede:
"on him gladiað gomeþra lāfe
"heard and hring-mæl, Heaðobeardna gestrēon,
"þenden hīe þām wæpnum wealdan mōston,
2040 "oð þæt hīe forlæddan tō þām lind-plegan
"swæse gesiðas ond hyra sylfra feorh.
"Þonne cwið æt bēore, sē þe bēah gesyhð,
"eald æsc-wiga, sē þe eall geman
"gār-cwealm gumena (him bið grim sefa),
2045 "onginneð geōmor-mōd geongne ceman
"þurh hreðra gehygd higes cunnian,
"wīg-bealu weccēan and þæt word ācwyð:
"Meaht þū, mīn wine, mēce gecnāwan,
"þone þin fæder tō gefeohte bær
2050 "'under here-grīman hindeman siðe,
"dýre īren, þær hyne Dene slōgon,
"wēoldon wæl-stōwe, syððan wiðer-gyld læg,
"æfter hāleða hryre, hwate Scyldungas?
"Nu hēr þāra banena byre nāt-hwylces,
2055 "'frætsum hrēmig on flet gæð,
"morðres gylpeð and þone māððum byreð,
"þone þe þū mid rihte rædan sceoldest!"

- "Manað swā and myndgað mæla gehwylce
 "sārum wordum, oð þæt sāl cymeð,
 2060 "þæt se fāmnan þegn fore fæder dædum
 "æfter billes bite blōd-fāg swefeð,
 "ealdres scyldig; him se oðer þonan
 "losað lifigende, con him land geare.
 "Þonne bīoð brocene on bā healfe
 2065 "āð-sweord eorla; syððan Ingelde
 "weallað wæl-nīðas and him wīf-lufan
 "æfter cear-wælmum cōlran weorðað.
 "Þy ic Heaðobeardna hyldo ne telge,
 "dryht-sibbe dæl Denum unfæcne,
 2070 "frēond-scipe fæstne. Ic sceal forð sprecan
 "gēn ymbe Grendel, þæt þū geare cunne,
 "sinces brytta, tō hwan syððan wearð
 "hond-ræs hæleða. Syððan heofones gim
 "glād ofer grundas, gæst yrre cwōm,
 2075 "eatol æfen-grom, ūser nēosan,
 "pær wē gesunde sæl weardodon;
 "pær wæs Hondscīo hild onsæge,
 "feorh-bealu fægum, hē fyrmest læg,
 "gyrded cempa; him Grendel wearð,
 2080 "mārum magu-þegne tō mūð-bonan,
 "lēofes mannes lic eall forswealg.
 "Nō þy ār ūt þā gēn īdel-hende
 "bona blōdig-tōð bealewa gemyndig,
 "of þām gold-sele gongan wolde,
 2085 "ac hē mægnes rōf mīn costode,
 "grāpode gearo-folm. Glōf hangode
 "sīd and syllic searo-bendum fæst,
 "sīo wæs orþoncum eall gegyrwed
 "deofles cræftum and dracan fellum:
 2090 "hē mec pær on innan unsynnigne,
 "dīor dæd-fruma, gedōn wolde,
 "manigra sumne: hyt ne mihte swā,
 "syððan ic on yrre upp-riht āstōd.
 "Tō lang ys tō reccenne, hū ic þām lēod-sceaðan
 2095 "yfla gehwylces ond-lēan forgeald;
 "pær ic, þēoden mīn, þīne lēode

- "weorðode weorcum. Hē on weg losade,
 "lȳtle hwīle lif-wynna brēac;
 "hwæðre him sīo swīðre swaðe weardade
 2100 "hand on Hiorte and hē hēan þonan,
 "mōdes geōmor mere-grund gefēoll.
 "Mē þone wæl-rās wine Scildunga
 "fættan golde fela lēanode,
 "manegum mādum, syððan mergen cōm
 2105 "and wē tō symble geseten hæfdon.
 "Þær wæs gidd and glēo; gomela Scilding
 "fela fricgende feorran rehte;
 "hwīlum hilde-dēor hearpan wynne,
 "gomen-wudu grētte; hwīlum gyd āwræc
 2110 "sōð and sārlic; hwīlum syllic spell
 "rehte æfter rihte rūm-heort cyning.
 "Hwīlum eft ongan eldo gebunden,
 "gomel gūð-wiga gioguðe cwīðan
 "hilde-strengo; hreðer inne wēoll,
 2115 "þonne hē wintrum frōd worn gemunde.
 "Swā wē þær inne andlangne dæg
 "nīode nāman, oð þæt niht becwōm
 "ōðer tō yldum. Þa wæs eft hraðe
 "gearo gyrn-wræce Grendeles mōdor,
 2120 "sīðode sorh-full; sunu dēað fornam,
 "wīg-hete Wedra. Wīf unhȳre
 "hyre bearn gewræc, beorn ācwealde
 "ellenlice; þær wæs Æsc-here,
 "frōdan fyrn-witan, feorh ūðgenge;
 2125 "nōðer hȳ hine ne mōston, syððan mergen cwōm,
 "dēað-wērigne Denia lēode
 "bronde forbærnan, nē on bæl hladan
 "lēofne mannan: hīo þæt lic ætbær
 "fēondes fæðmum under firgen-strēam.
 2130 "Þæt wæs Hrōðgāre hrēowa tornost
 "þāra þe lēod-fruman lange begeāte;
 "þā se þeoden mec þīne life
 "healsode hrēoh-mōd, þæt ic on holma geþring
 "eorl-scipe efnde, ealdre genēðde,
 2135 "mārðo fremede: hē mē mēde gehēt.

"Ic þā þæs wælnes, þē is wīde cūð,
 "grimne gryrelīcne grund-hyrde fond.
 "Þær unc hwīle wæs hand gemāne;
 "holm heolfre wēoll and ic hēafde becearf
 2140 "in þām grund-sele Grendeles mōdor
 "ēacnum ecgum, unsōfte þonan
 "feorh oðferede; næs ic fæge þā gýt,
 "ac mē eorla hlēo eft gesealde
 "māðma menigeo, maga Healfdenes.

He Gives Presents to Hygelac. Hygelac Rewards Him. Hygelac's Death. Bēowulf Reigns

Fit XXXI

- 2145 "Swā se þēod-kyning þēawum lyfde;
"nealles ic þām lēanum forloren hæfde,
"mægnas mēde, ac hē mē mādmas geaf,
"sunu Healfdenes, on sīnne sylfes dōm;
"þā ic þē, beorn-cyning, bringan wylle,
2150 "ēstum geȳwan. Gēn is eall æt þē
"lissa gelong: ic lȳt hafo
"hēafod-māga, nefne Hygelāc þec!"
Hēt þā in beran eafor, hēafod-segn,
heaðo-stēapne helm, hāre byrnan,
2155 gūð-sweord geatolīc, gyd æfter wræc:
"Mē þis hilde-sceorp Hrōðgār sealde,
"snotra fengel, sume worde hēt,
"þæt ic his ærest þē eft gesægde,
"cwæð þæt hyt hæfde Hiorogār cyning,
2160 "lēod Scyldunga lange hwīle:
"nō þȳ ær suna sīnum syllan wolde,
"hwatum Heorowearde, þēah hē him hold wære,
"brēost-gewādu. Brūc ealles well!"
Hȳrde ic þæt þām frætwum fēower mēaras
2165 lungre gelīce lāst weardode,

- æppel-fealuwe; hē him ēst getēah
 mēara and māðma. Swā sceal mæg dōn,
 nealles inwit-net ōðrum bregdan,
 dyrnum cræfte dēað rēnian
 2170 hond-gesteallan. Hygelāce wæs,
 nīða heardum, nefa swyðe hold
 and gehwæðer ōðrum hrōðra gemyndig.
 Hȳrde ic þæt hē þone heals-bēah Hygde gesealde,
 wrætlicne wundur-māððum, þone þe him Wealhþeo geaf,
 2175 þeodnes dōhtor, þrīo wicg somod
 swancor and sadol-beorht; hyre syððan wæs
 æfter bēah-þege brēost geweorðod.
 Swā bealdode bearn Ecgbēowes,
 guma gūðum cūð, gōdum dædum,
 2180 drēah æfter dōme, nealles druncne slōg
 heorð-genēatas; næs him hrēoh sefa,
 ac hē man-cynnes mæste cræfte
 gin-fæstan gife, þē him god sealde,
 hēold hilde-dēor. Hēan wæs lange,
 2185 swā hyne Gēata bearn gōdne ne tealdon,
 nē hyne on medo-bence micles wyrðne
 drihten wereda gedōn wolde;
 swyðe oft sægdon, þæt hē slēac wære,
 æðeling unfrom: edwenden cwōm
 2190 tīr-ēadigum menn torna gehwylces.
 Hēt þā eorla hlēo in gefetian,
 heaðo-rōf cyning, Hrēðles lāfe,
 golde gegyrede; næs mid Gēatum þā
 sinc-māððum sēlra on sweordes hād;
 2195 þæt hē on Bīowulfes bearm ālegde,
 and him gesealde seofan þūsendo,
 bold and brego-stōl. Him wæs bām samod
 on þām lēod-scipe lond gecynde,
 eard ēðel-riht, ōðrum swiðor
 2200 sīde rīce, þām þær sēlra wæs.
 Eft þæt geīode ufaran dōgrum
 hilde-hlæmmum, syððan Hygelāc læg
 and Heardrēde hilde-mēceas
 under bord-hrēoðan tō bonan wurdon,

- 2205 þā hyne gesōhtan on sige-þēode
 hearde hilde-frecan, Heaðo-Scilfingas,
 niðra genægdan nefan Hererīces.
 Syððan Bēowulfe brāde rīce
 on hand gehwearf: hē gehēold tela
 2210 fīftig wintru (wæs þā frōd cyning,
 eald ēðel-weard), oð þæt ān ongan
 deorcum nihtum draca rīcsian,
 sē þe on hēare hāðe hord beweotode,
 stān-beorh stēapne: stīg under læg,
 2215 eldum uncūð. Þær on innan gīong
 niðra nāt-hwylces nēode gefēng
 hæðnum horde hond . d . . . geþ . . hwylc
 since fāhne, hē þæt syððan
 . . . þ . . . lð . þ . . l . g
 2220 slæpende be fyre, fyrena hyrde
 þeofes cræfte, þæt sie ðioð
 . idh . folc-beorn, þæt hē gebolgen wæs.

The Fire-Drake. the Hoard

Fit XXXII

- Nealles mid geweoldum wyrm-horda . . . cræft
sōhte sylfes willum, sē þe him sære gesceōd,
2225 ac for þrēa-nēdlan þēow nāt-hwylces
hæleða bearna hete-swengeas flēah,
for ofer-þearfe and þær inne fealh
secg syn-bysig. Sōna in þā tīde
þæt þām gyste br . g . stōd,
2230 hwæðre earm-sceapen
.. ð . . . sceapen o i r . . e se fæs begeat,
sinc-fæt geseah: þær wæs swylcra fela
in þām eorð-scræfe ær-gestrēona,
swā hȳ on geār-dagum gumena nāt-hwylc
2235 eormen-lāfe æðelan cynnes
þanc-hycgende þær gehȳdde,
deore mǣðmas. Ealle hīe dēað fornam
ærran mælum, and se ān þā gēn
lēoda duguðe, sē þær lengest hwearf,
2240 weard wine-geōmor wīscste þæs yldan,
þæt hē lȳtel fæc long-gestrēona
brūcan mōste. Beorh eal gearo
wunode on wonge wæter-ȳðum nēah,
nīwe be næsse nearo-cræftum fæst:
2245 þær on innan bær eorl-gestrēona
hringa hyrde hard-fyrdne dæl
fættan goldes, fēa worda cwæð:
"Heald þū nū, hrūse, nū hæleð ne mōston,
"eorla æhte. Hwæt! hit ær on þē
2250 "gōde begeāton; gūð-dēað fornam,

- "feorh-bealo frēcne fȳra gehwylcne,
 "lēoda mīnra, þāra þe þis lif ofgeaf,
 "gesāwon sele-drēam. Nāh hwā sweord wege
 "oððe fetige fæted wæge,
 2255 "drync-fæt dēore: duguð ellor scōc.
 "Sceal se hearda helm hyrsted golde
 "fætum befeallen: feormiend swefað,
 "þā þe beado-grīman bȳwan sceoldon,
 "gē swylce sēo here-pād, sīo æt hilde gebād
 2260 "ofer borda gebræc bite irena,
 "brosnað æfter beorne. Ne mæg byrnan hring
 "æfter wīg-fruman wīde fēran
 "hæleðum be healfe; næs hearpan wyn,
 "gomen glēo-bēames, nē gōd hafoc
 2265 "geond sæl swingeð, nē se swifta mearh
 "burh-stede bēateð. Bealo-cwealm hafað
 "fela feorh-cynna feorr onsended!"
 Swā giōmor-mōd gιοhðo mǣnde,
 ān æfter eallum unblīðe hwēop,
 2270 dægес and nihtes, oð þæt dēaðes wylm
 hrān æt heortan. Hord-wynne fond
 eald ūht-sceaða opene standan,
 sē þe byrnende biorgas sēceð
 nacod nīð-draca, nihtes flēogeð
 2275 fȳre befangen; hyne fold-būend
 wīde gesāwon. Hē gēwunian sceall
 hlāw under hrūsan, þær hē hǣðen gold
 warað wintrum frōd; ne byð him wihte þē sēl.
 Swā se þēod-sceaða þrēo hund wintra
 2280 hēold on hrūsan hord-ærna sum
 ēacen-cræftig, oð þæt hyne ān ābealh
 mon on mōde: man-dryhtne bær
 fæted wæge, frioðo-wære bād
 hlāford sīnne. Þā wæs hord rāsod,
 2285 onboren bēaga hord, bēne getiðad
 fēa-sceaftum men. Frēa scēawode
 fīra fȳrn-geweorc forman sīðe.
 Þā se wȳrm onwōc, wrōht wæs genīwad;
 stonc þā æfter stāne, stearc-heort onfand

- 2290 fēondes fōt-lāst; hē tō forð gestōp,
 dyrnan cræfte, dracan hēafde nēah.
 Swā mæg unfæge ēaðe gedīgan
 wēan and wræc-sið, sē þe waldendes
 hyldo gehealdeð. Hord-weard sōhte
 2295 georne æfter grunde, wolde guman findan,
 þone þe him on sweofote sāre getēode:
 hāt and hrēoh-mōd hlāw oft ymbe hwearf,
 ealne ūtan-weardne; nē þær ænig mon
 wæs on þære wēstenne. Hwæðre hilde gefeh,
 2300 beado-weorces: hwīlum on beorh æthwearf,
 sinc-fæt sōhte; hē þæt sōna onfand,
 þæt hæfde gumena sum goldes gefandod
 hēah-gestrēona. Hord-weard onbād
 earfoðlice, oð þæt æfen cwōm;
 2305 wæs þā gebolgen beorges hyrde,
 wolde se lāða līge forgylðan
 drinc-fæt dýre. Þā wæs dæg sceacen
 wyrme on willan, nō on wealle leng
 bīdan wolde, ac mid bāle fōr,
 2310 fýre gefýsed. Wæs se fruma egeslic
 lēodum on lande, swā hyt lungre wearð
 on hyra sinc-gifan sāre geendod.

Beowulf Resolves to Kill the Fire-Drake

Fit XXXIII

- Pā se gæst ongan glēdum spīwan,
 beorht hofu bærnan; bryne-lēoma stōd
2315 eldum on andan; nō þær āht cwices
 lāð lyft-floga læfan wolde.
 Wæs þæs wyrmes wīg wīde gesyne,
 nearo-fāges nīð nēan and feorran,
 hū se gūð-sceaða Gēata lēode
2320 hatode and hýnde: hord eft gescēat,
 dryht-sele dyrnne ær dāges hwīle.
 Hæfde land-wara lige befangen,
 bæle and bronde; beorges getruwode,
 wīges and wealles: him sēo wēn gelēah.
2325 Pā wæs Biowulfe brōga gecyðed
 snūde tō sōðe, þæt his sylfes him
 bolda sēlest bryne-wylmum mealt,
 gif-stōl Gēata. þæt þām gōdan wæs
 hrēow on hreðre, hyge-sorga mæst:
2330 wēnde se wīsa, þæt hē wealdende,
 ofer ealde riht, ēcean dryhtne
 bitre gebulge: brēost innan wēoll
 þeostrum geþoncum, swā him geþywe ne wæs.
 Hæfde lig-draca lēoda fæsten,
2335 ēa-lond ūtan, eorð-weard þone
 glēdum forgrunden. Him þæs gūð-cyning,
 Wedera þioden, wræce leornode.

- Heht him þā gewyrcean wīgendra hlēo
 eall-īrenne, eorla dryhten
 2340 wīg-bord wrætlic; wisse hē gearwe,
 þæt him holt-wudu helpan ne meahte,
 lind wið lige. Sceolde lān-daga
 æðeling ær-gōd ende gebīdan
 worulde lifes and se wurm somod;
 2345 þēah þe hord-welan hēolde lange.
 Oferhogode þā hringa fengel,
 þæt hē þone wīd-flogan weorode gesōhte,
 sīdan herge; nō hē him þā sæcce ondrēd,
 nē him þæs wyrmes wīg for wiht dyde,
 2350 eafod and ellen; forþon hē ær fela
 nearo nēðende nīða gedigde,
 hilde-hlemma, syððan hē Hrōðgāres,
 sigor-ēadig secg, sele fælsode
 and æt gūðe forgrāp Grendeles mægum,
 2355 lāðan cynnes. Nō þæt lāsest wæs
 hond-gemota, þær mon Hygelāc slōh,
 syððan Gēata cyning gūðe ræsum,
 frēa-wine folces Frēslondum on,
 Hrēðles eafora hioro-dryncum swealt,
 2360 bille gebēaten; þonan Bīowulf cōm
 sylfes cræfte, sund-nytte drēah;
 hæfde him on earme ... XXX
 hilde-geatwa, þā hē tō holme stāg.
 Nealles Hetware hrēmge þorfton
 2365 fēðe-wīges, þē him foran ongēan
 linde bāron: lýt eft becwōm
 fram þām hild-frecan hāmes nīosan.
 Oferswam þā sioleða bigong sunu Ecgpēowes,
 earm ān-haga eft tō lēodum,
 2370 þær him Hygd gebēad hord and rīce,
 bēagas and brego-stōl: bearne ne truwode,
 þæt hē wið æl-fylcum ēðel-stōlas
 healdan cūðe, þā wæs Hygelāc dēad.
 Nō þy ær fēa-sceaft findan meahton
 2375 æt þām æðelinge ænige þinga,
 þæt hē Heardrēde hlāford wære,

- oððe þone cyne-dōm cīosan wolde;
 hwæðre hē him on folce frēond-lārum hēold,
 ēstum mid āre, oð þæt hē yldra wearð,
 2380 Weder-Gēatum wēold. Hyne wræc-mæcgas
 ofer sǣ sōhtan, suna Ōhteres:
 hæfdon hȳ forhealden helm Scylfinga,
 þone sēlestan sǣ-cyninga,
 þāra þe in Swīo-rīce sinc brytnade,
 2385 mārne þēoden. Him þæt tō mearce wearð;
 hē þær orfeorme feorh-wunde hlēat
 sweordes swengum, sunu Hygelāces;
 and him eft gewāt Ongenþiowes bearn
 hāmes nīosan, syððan Heardrēd læg;
 2390 lēt þone brego-stōl Bīowulf healdan,
 Gēatum wealdan: þæt wæs gōd cyning.

Retrospect of Bēowulf.—Strife Between Sweonas and Geatas

Fit XXXIV

Sē þæs lēod-hryres lēan gemunde
uferan dōgrum, Ēadgilse wearð
fēa-sceaftum fēond. Folce gesteppe
2395 ofer sǣ sīde sunu Ōhteres
wigum and wǣpnum: hē gewræc syððan
cealdum cear-siðum, cyning ealdre binēat.
Swā hē nīða gehwane genesen hæfde,
slīðra geslyhta, sunu Ecgþiowes,
2400 ellen-weorca, oð þone ānne dæg,
þē hē wið þām wyrme gewegan sceolde.
Gewāt þā twelfa sum torne gebolgen
dryhten Gēata dracan scēawian;
hæfde þā gefrūnen, hwanan sīo fæhð ārās,
2405 bealo-nið biorna; him tō bearme cwōm
māððum-fæt mære þurh þæs meldan hond,
Sē wæs on þām prēate preotteoða secg,
sē þæs orleges ōr onstealde,
hæft hyge-giōmor, sceolde hēan þonon
2410 wong wīsian: hē ofer willan gīong
tō þæs þe hē eorð-sele ānne wisse,
hlāw under hrūsan holm-wylme nēh,
ȳð-gewinne, sē wæs innan full
wrætta and wīra: weard unhīore,

- 2415 gearo gūð-freca, gold-māðmas hēold,
 eald under eorðan; næs þæt yðe cēap,
 tō gegangenne gumena ænigum.
 Gesæt þā on næsse nīð-heard cyning,
 þenden hælo ābēad heorð-genēatum
 2420 gold-wine Gēata: him wæs geōmor sefa,
 wæfre and wæl-fūs, Wyrð ungemete nēah,
 sē þone gomelan grētan sceolde,
 sēcean sǣwle hord, sundur gedælan
 lif wið līce: nō þon lange wæs
 2425 feorh æðelinges flæsce bewunden.
 Bīowulf maðelade, bearn Ecgbēowes:
 "Fela ic on giogoðe guð-ræsa genæs,
 "orleg-hwīla: ic þæt eall gemon.
 "Ic wæs syfan-wintre, þā mec sinca baldor,
 2430 "frēa-wine folca æt mīnum fæder genam,
 "hēold mec and hæfde Hrēðel cyning,
 "geaf mē sinc and symbel, sibbe gemunde;
 "næs ic him tō life lāðra ōwihte
 "beorn in burgum, þonne his bearna hwylc,
 2435 "Herebeald and Hæðcyn, oððe Hygelāc mīn.
 "Wæs þām yldestan ungedēfelīce
 "mæges dædum morðor-bed strēd,
 "syððan hyne Hæðcyn of horn-bogan,
 "his frēa-wine flāne geswencte,
 2440 "miste mercelses and his mæg ofscēt,
 "brōðor oðerne, blōdigan gāre:
 "þæt wæs feoh-lēas gefeoht, fyrenum gesyngad
 "hreðre hyge-mēðe; sceolde hwæðre swā þēah
 "æðeling unwrecen ealdres linnan.
 2445 "Swā bið geōmorlic gomelum ceorle
 "tō gebīdanne, þæt his byre rīde
 "giong on galgan, þonne hē gyd wrece,
 "sārigne sang, þonne his sunu hangað
 "hrefne tō hrōðre and hē him helpe ne mæg,
 2450 "eald and in-frōd, ænige gefremman.
 "Symble bið gemyndgad morna gehwylc
 "eaforan ellor-sīð; oðres ne gýmeð
 "tō gebīdanne burgum on innan

"yrfe-weardes, þonne se ān hafað
2455 "þurh dēaðes nȳd dāda gefondad.
"Gesyhð sorh-cearig on his suna būre
"wīn-sele wēstne, wind-gereste,
"rēote berofene; rīdend swefað
"hæleð in hoðman; nis þær hearpan swēg,
2460 "gomen in geardum, swylce þær iū wæron.

Memories of Past Time.-The Feud with the Fire-Drake

Fit XXXV

- "Gewīteð þonne on sealman, sorh-lēoð gæleð
"ān æfter ānum: þūhte him eall tō rūm,
"wongas and wīc-stede. Swā Wedra helm
"æfter Herebealde heortan sorge
2465 "weallende wæg, wihte ne meahte
"on þām feorh-bonan fæhðe gebētan:
"nō þȳ ær hē þone heaðo-rinc hatian ne meahte
"lāðum dædum, þēah him lēof ne wæs.
"Hē þā mid þære sorge, þē him sīo sār belamp,
2470 "gum-drēam ofgeaf, godes lēoht gecēas;
"eaferum læfde, swā dēð ēadig mon,
"lond and lēod-byrig, þā hē of life gewāt.
"Þā wæs synn and sacu Swēona and Gēata,
"ofer wīd wæter wrōht gemāne,
2475 "here-nīð hearda, syððan Hrēðel swealt,
"oððe him Ongenþēowes eaferan wēran
"frome fyrd-hwate, frēode ne woldon
"ofer heafo healdan, ac ymb Hrēosna-beorh
"eatolne inwit-scear oft gefremedon.
2480 "Þæt mæg-wine mīne gewræcan,
"fæhðe and fyrene, swā hyt gefræge wæs,
"þēah þe oðer hit ealdre gebohte,
"heardan cēape: Hæðcynne wearð,
"Gēata dryhtne, gūð onsæge.
2485 "Þā ic on morgne gefrægn mæg oðerne

- "billes ecgum on bonan stælan,
 "þær Ongenþēow Eofores nīosade:
 "gūð-helm tōglād, gomela Scylfing
 "hrēas heoro-blāc; hond gemunde
 2490 "fæhðo genōge, feorh-sweng ne oftēah.
 "Ic him þā māðmas, þē hē mē sealde,
 "geald æt gūðe, swā mē gifeðe wæs,
 "lēohtan sweorde: hē mē lond forgeaf,
 "eard ēðel-wyn. Næs him ænig þearf,
 2495 "þæt hē tō Gifðum oððe tō Gār-Denum
 "oððe in Swīo-rīce sēcean þurfe
 "wyrsan wīg-frecan, weorðe gecýpan;
 "symle ic him on fēðan beforan wolde,
 "āna on orde, and swā tō aldre sceall
 2500 "sæcce fremman, þenden þis sweord þolað,
 "þæt mec ær and sīð oft gelæste,
 "syððan ic for dugeðum Dæghrefne wearð
 "tō hand-bonan, Hūga cempan:
 "nalles hē þā frætwe Frēs-cyninge,
 2505 "brēost-weorðunge bringan mōste,
 "ac in campe gecrong cumbles hyrde,
 "æðeling on elne. Ne wæs ecg bona,
 "ac him hilde-grāp heortan wylmas,
 "bān-hūs gebræc. Nū sceall billes ecg,
 2510 "hond and heard sweord ymb hord wīgan."
 Bēowulf maðelode, bēot-wordum spræc
 nīehstan sīðe: "Ic genēðde fela
 "gūða on geogoðe; gýt ic wylle,
 "frōd folces weard, fæhðe sēcan,
 2515 "mærdum fremman, gif mec se mǣn-sceaða
 "of eorð-sele ūt gesēceð!"
 Gegrētte þā gumena gehwylcne,
 hwate helm-berend hindeman sīðe,
 swāse gesīðas: "Nolde ic sweord beran,
 2520 "wāpen tō wyrme, gif ic wiste hū
 "wið þām āglæcean elles meahte
 "gylpe wiðgrīpan, swā ic giō wið Grendle dyde;
 "ac ic þær heaðu-fýres hātes wēne,
 "rēðes and-hāttres: forþon ic mē on hafu

- 2525 "bord and byrnan. Nelle ic beorges weard
 "oferflēon fōtes trem, fēond unhyre,
 "ac unc sceal weorðan æt wealle, swā unc Wyrð geteoð,
 "metod manna gehwæs. Ic eom on mōde from,
 "þæt ic wið þone gūð-flogan gylp ofersitte.
- 2530 "Gebīde gē on beorge byrnum werede,
 "secgas on searwum, hwæðer sēl mæge
 "æfter wæl-ræse wunde gedýgan
 "uncer twēga. Nis þæt ēower sīð,
 "nē gemet mannes, nefne mīn ānes,
 2535 "þæt hē wið āglæcean eofoðo dæle,
 "eorl-scype efne. Ic mid elne sceall
 "gold gegangan oððe gūð nimeð,
 "feorh-bealu frēcne, frēan ēowerne!"
 Ārās þā bī ronde rōf ōretta,
- 2540 heard under helm, hioro-sercean bær
 under stān-cleofu, strengo getruwode
 ānes mannes: ne bið swylc earges sīð.
 Geseah þā be wealle, sē þe worna fela,
 gum-cystum gōd, gūða gedigde,
 2545 hilde-hlemma, þonne hnitan fēðan,
 (stōd on stān-bogan) strēam ūt þonan
 brecan of beorge; wæs þære burnan wælm
 heaðo-fýrum hāt: ne meahte horde nēah
 unbyrnende ænige hwīle
- 2550 dēop gedýgan for dracan lēge.
 Lēt þā of brēostum, þā hē gebolgen wæs,
 Weder-Gēata lēod word ūt faran,
 stearc-heort styrnde; stefn in becōm
 heaðo-torht hlynnan under hārne stān.
- 2555 Hete wæs onhrēred, hord-weard oncnīow
 mannes reorde; næs þær māra fyrst,
 frēode tō friclan. From ārest cwōm
 oruð āglæcean ūt of stāne,
 hāt hilde-swāt; hrūse dynede.
- 2560 Biorn under beorge bord-rand onswāf
 wið þām gryre-gieste, Gēata dryhten:
 þā wæs hring-bogan heorte gefýsed
 sæcce tō sēceanne. Sweord ær gebræ

- gōd gūð-cyning gomele lāfe,
 2565 ecgum unglēaw, æghwæðrum wæs
 bealo-hycgendra brōga fram oðrum.
 Stīð-mōd gestōd wið stēapne rond
 winia bealdor, þā se wyrm gebēah
 snūde tōsomne: hē on searwum bād.
 2570 Gewāt þā byrnende gebogen scrīðan tō,
 gescīfe scyndan. Scyld wēl gebearg
 life and līce læssan hwīle
 mǣrum þēodne, þonne his myne sōhte,
 þær hē þȳ fyrste forman dōgore
 2575 wealdan mōste, swā him Wyrð ne gescrāf
 hrēð æt hilde. Hond up ābræd
 Gēata dryhten, gryre-fāhne slōh
 incge lāfe, þæt sīo ecg gewāc
 brūn on bāne, bāt unswīðor,
 2580 þonne his þīod-cyning þearfe hæfde,
 bysigum gebāded. Þā wæs beorges weard
 æfter heaðu-swenge on hrēoum mōde,
 wearp wæl-fyre, wīde sprungon
 hilde-lēoman: hrēð-sigora ne gealp
 2585 gold-wine Gēata, gūð-bill geswāc
 nacod æt nīðe, swā hyt nō sceolde,
 īren ær-gōd. Ne wæs þæt ēðe sīð,
 þæt se mǣra maga Ecgbēowes
 grund-wong þone ofgyfan wolde;
 2590 sceolde wyrmes willan wīc eardian
 elles hwergen, swā sceal æghwylc mon
 ālǣtan lān-dagas. Næs þā long tō þon,
 þæt þā āglǣcean hȳ eft gemēttan.
 Hyrte hyne hord-weard, hreðer æðme wēoll,
 2595 nīwan stefne: nearo þrowode
 fyre befongen sē þe ær folce wēold.
 Nealles him on hēape hand-gesteallan,
 æðelinga bearn ymbe gestōdon
 hilde-cystum, ac hȳ on holt bugon,
 2600 ealdre burgan. Hiora in ānum wēoll
 sefa wið sorgum: sibb æfre ne mæg
 wiht onwendan, þām þe wēl penceð.

Wiglaf Helps Bēowulf in the Feud

Fit XXXVI

Wiglāf wæs hāten Wēoxstānes sunu,
lēoflic lind-wiga, lēod Scylfinga,
2605 mæg Ælfheres: geseah his mon-dryhten
under here-grīman hāt þrowian.
Gemunde þā þā āre, þē hē him ær forgeaf
wīc-stede weligne Wægmundinga,
folc-rihta gehwylc, swā his fæder āhte;
2610 ne mihte þā forhabban, hond rond gefēng,
geolwe linde, gomel swyrd getēah,
þæt wæs mid eldum Eanmundes lāf,
suna Ōhteres, þām æt sæcce wearð
wracu wine-lēasum Wēohstānes bana
2615 mēces ecgum, and his mægum ætbær
brūn-fāgne helm, hringde byrnan,
eald sweord eotonisc, þæt him Onela forgeaf,
his gædelinges gūð-gewædu,
fyrd-searo fūslic: nō ymbe þā fæhðe spræc,
2620 þeah þe hē his brōðor bearn ābredwade.
Hē frætwe gehēold fela missēra,
bill and byrnan, oð þæt his byre mihte
eorl-scipe efnan, swā his ær-fæder;
geaf him þā mid Gēatum gūð-gewæda
2625 æghwæs unrīm; þā hē of ealdre gewāt,
frōd on forð-weg. Þā wæs forma sīð
geongan cempan, þæt hē gūðe ræs

- mid his frēo-dryhtne fremman sceolde;
 ne gemealt him se mōd-sefa, nē his mæges lāf
 2630 gewāc æt wīge: þæt se wyrm onfand,
 syððan hīe tōgædre gegān hæfdon.
 Wīglāf maðelode word-rihta fela,
 sægde gesiðum, him wæs sefa geōmor:
 "Ic þæt mæl geman, þær wē medu þēgun,
 2635 "þonne wē gehēton ūssum hlāforde
 "in bīor-sele, þē ūs þās bēagas geaf,
 "þæt wē him þā gūð-geatwa gylðan woldon,
 "gif him þyslicu þearf gelumpe,
 "helmas and heard sweord: þē hē ūsic on herge gecēas
 2640 "tō þyssum sið-fate sylfes willum,
 "onmunde ūsic mārða and mē þās māðmas geaf,
 "þē hē ūsic gār-wīgend gōde tealde,
 "hwate helm-berend, þēah þe hlāford ūs
 "þis ellen-weorc āna āþōhte
 2645 "tō gefremmanne, folces hyrde,
 "forþām hē manna mæst mārða gefremede,
 "dæda dollicra. Nū is sē dæg cumen,
 "þæt ūre man-dryhten mægenes behōfað
 "gōdra gūð-rinca: wutun gangan tō,
 2650 "helpan hild-fruman, þenden hyt sý,
 "glēd-egesa grim! God wāt on mec,
 "þæt mē is micle lēofre, þæt mīnne lic-haman
 "mid mīnne gold-gyfan glēd fæðmie.
 "Ne þynceð mē gerysne, þæt wē rondas beren
 2655 "eft tō earde, nemne wē āror mægen
 "fāne gefyllan, feorh ealgian
 "Wedra þīodnes. Ic wāt geare,
 "þæt nāron eald-gewyrht, þæt hē āna scyle
 "Gēata duguðe gnorn þrowian,
 2660 "gesīgan æt sæcce: sceal ūrum þæt sweord and helm,
 "byrne and byrdu-scrūd bām gemæne."
 Wōð þā þurh þone wæl-rēc, wīg-heafolan bær
 frēan on fultum, fēa worda cwæð:
 "Lēofa Bīowulf, lāest eall tela,
 2665 "swā þū on geoguð-fēore geāra gecwæde,
 "þæt þū ne ālāte be þē lifigendum

- "dōm gedrēosan: scealt nū dædum rōf,
 "æðeling ān-hȳdig, ealle mægene
 "feorh ealgian; ic þē fullæstu!"
- 2670 Æfter þām wordum wyrn yrre cwōm,
 atol inwit-gæst ōðre sīðe,
 fȳr-wylmum fāh fionda nīosan,
 lāðra manna; līg-ȳðum forborn
 bord wið ronde: byrne ne meahte
- 2675 geongum gār-wigan gēoce gefremman:
 ac se maga geonga under his mæges scyld
 elne geēode, þā his āgen wæs
 glēdum forgrunden. Þā gēn gūð-cyning
 mārða gemunde, mægen-strengo,
- 2680 slōh hilde-bille, þæt hyt on heafolan stōd
 nīðe genȳded: Nægling forbærst,
 geswāc æt sæcce sweord Bīowulfes
 gomol and græg-mæl. Him þæt gifeðe ne wæs,
 þæt him irenna ecge mihton
- 2685 helpan æt hilde; wæs sīo hond tō strong,
 sē þe mēca gehwane mīne gefræge
 swenge ofersōhte, þonne hē tō sæcce bær
 wāpen wundrum heard, næs him wihte þē sēl.
 Þā wæs þēod-sceaða þriddan sīðe,
- 2690 frēcne fȳr-draca fāhða gemyndig,
 ræsde on þone rōfan, þā him rūm āgeald,
 hāt and heaðo-grim, heals ealne ymbefēng
 biteran bānum; hē geblōdegod wearð
 sāwul-drīore; swāt ȳðum wēoll.

Bēowulf Wounded to Death

Fit XXXVII

- 2695 Ðā ic æt þearfe gefrægn þēod-cyninges
and-longne eorl ellen cȳðan,
cræft and cēnðu, swā him gecynde wæs;
ne hēdde hē þæs heafolan, ac sīo hand gebarn
mōdiges mannes, þær hē his mæges healp,
2700 þæt hē þone nīð-gæst nioðor hwēne slōh,
secg on searwum, þæt þæt sweord gedēaf
fāh and fāted, þæt þæt fȳr ongon
sweðrian syððan. Ðā gēn sylf cyning
gewēold his gewitte, wæll-seaxe gebræ,
2705 biter and beadu-scearp, þæt hē on byrnan wæg:
forwrat Wedra helm wȳrm on middan.
Fēond gefyldan (ferh ellen wræc),
and hī hyne þā bēgen ābroten hæfdon,
sib-æðelingas: swȳlc sceolde secg wesana,
2710 þegn æt þearfe. Ðæt þām þēodne wæs
sīðast sīge-hwīle sylfes dædum,
worlde geweorces. Ðā sīo wund ongon,
þē him se eorð-draca ær geworhte,
swelan and swellan. Hē þæt sōna onfand,
2715 þæt him on brēostum bealo-nīð wēoll,
attor on innan. Ðā se æðeling gīong,
þæt hē bī wealle, wīs-hycgende,
gesæt on sesse; seah on enta geweorc,
hū þā stān-bogan stapulum fæste
2720 ēce eorð-reced innan hēoldon.
Hyne þā mid handa heoro-drēorigne
þēoden mārne þegn ungemete till,

- wine-dryhten his wætere gelafede,
 hilde-sædne and his helm onspēon.
- 2725 Bīowulf maðelode, hē ofer benne spræc,
 wunde wæl-blēate (wisse hē gearwe,
 þæt hē dæg-hwīla gedrogen hæfde
 eorðan wynne; þā wæs eall sceacen
 dōgor-gerīmes, dēað ungemete nēah):
- 2730 "Nū ic suna mīnum syllan wolde
 "gūð-gewædu, þær mē gifeðe swā
 "ænig yrfe-weard æfter wurde,
 "lice gelenge. Ic þās lēode hēold
 "fiftig wintra: næs se folc-cyning
- 2735 "ymbe-sittendra ænig þāra,
 "þē mec gūð-winum grētan dorste,
 "egesān þēon. Ic on earde bād
 "mæl-gesceafta, hēold mīn tela,
 "ne sōhte searo-nīðas, nē mē swōr fela
- 2740 "āða on unriht. Ic þæs ealles mæg,
 "feorh-bennum sēoc, gefēan habban:
 "forþām mē wītan ne þearf waldend fīra
 "morðor-bealo māga, þonne mīn sceaceð
 "līf of līce. Nū þū lungre
- 2745 "geong, hord scēawian under hārne stān,
 "Wīglāf lēofa, nū se wyrm ligeð,
 "swefeð sære wund, since berēafod.
 "Bīo nū on ofoste, þæt ic ær-welan,
 "gold-æht ongite, gearo scēawige
- 2750 "swegle searo-gimmas, þæt ic þy sēft mæge
 "æfter māððum-welan mīn ālætan
 "līf and lēod-scipe, þone ic longe hēold."

The Jewel-Hoard. the Passing of Beowulf

Fit XXXVIII

þā ic snūde gefrægn sunu Wīhstānes
æfter word-cwydum wundum dryhtne
2755 hýran heaðo-sīocum, hring-net beran,
brogdne beadu-sercean under beorges hrōf.
Geseah þā sige-hrēðig, þā hē bī sesse gēong,
mago-þegn mōdig māððum-sigla fela,
gold glitinian grunde getenge,
2760 wundur on wealle and þæs wyrmes denn,
ealdes ūht-flogan, orcas stondan,
fyrn-manna fatu feormend-lēase,
hyrstum behrorene: þær wæs helm monig,
eald and ōmig, earm-bēaga fela,
2765 searwum gesæled. Sinc ēaðe mæg,
gold on grunde, gumena cynnes
gehwone ofer-hīgian, hýde sē þe wylle!
Swylce hē siomian geseah segn eall-gylden
hēah ofer horde, hond-wundra mæst,
2770 gelocen leoðo-cræftum: of þām lēoma stōd,
þæt hē þone grund-wong ongitan meahte,
wræte giوند-wlitan. Næs þæs wyrmes þær
onsýn ænig, ac hyne ecg fornam.
þā ic on hlāwe gefrægn hord rēafian,
2775 eald enta geweorc ānne mannan,
him on bearm hladan bunan and discas
sylfes dōme, segn ēac genom,

- bēacna beorhtost; bill ær-gescōd
 (ecg wæs īren) eald-hlāfordes
 2780 þām þāra mǣðma mund-bora wæs
 longe hwīle, līg-egesan wæg
 hātne for horde, hioro-weallende,
 middel-nihtum, oð þæt hē morðre swealt.
 Ār wæs on ofoste eft-sīðes georn,
 2785 frætsum gefyrðred: hyne fyrwet bræc,
 hwæðer collen-ferð cwicne gemette
 in þām wong-stede Wedra þēoden,
 ellen-sīocne, þær hē hine ær forlēt.
 Hē þā mid þām mǣðmum mārne þīoden,
 2790 dryhten sīnne drīorigne fand
 ealdres æt ende: hē hine eft ongon
 wæteres weorpan, oð þæt wordes ord
 brēost-hord þurhbræc. Bēowulf mǣdelode,
 gomel on giohðe (gold scēawode):
 2795 "Ic þāra frætwa frēan ealles þanc
 "wuldur-cyninge wordum secge,
 "ēcum dryhtne, þē ic hēr on starie,
 "þæs þe ic mōste mīnum lēodum
 "ær swylt-dæge swylc gestrȳnan.
 2800 "Nū ic on mǣðma hord mīne bebohte
 "frōde feorh-lege, fremmað gē nū
 "lēoda þearfe; ne mæg ic hēr leng wesan.
 "Hātað heaðo-mære hlāw gewyrcean,
 "beorhtne æfter bære æt brimes nosan;
 2805 "se scel tō gemyndum mīnum lēodum
 "hēah hlīfian on Hrones næsse,
 "þæt hit sǣ-līðend syððan hātan
 "Bīowulfes biorh, þā þe brentingas
 "ofer flōda genipu feorran drīfað."
 2810 Dyde him of healse hring gyldenne
 þīoden þrīst-hȳdig, þegne gesealde,
 geongum gār-wigan, gold-fāhne helm,
 bēah and byrnan, hēt hyne brūcan well:
 "Pū eart ende-lāf ūsses cynnes,
 2815 "Wægmundinga; ealle Wȳrd forswēof,
 "mīne mǣgas tō metod-sceafte,

“eorlas on elne: ic him æfter sceal.”
Þæt wæs þām gomelan gingeste word
brēost-gehygdum, ær hē bæl cure,
2820 hāte heaðo-wylmas: him of hreðre gewāt
sāwol sēcean sōð-fæstra dōm.

The Coward-Thanes

Fit XXXIX

- Pā wæs gegongen guman unfrōdum
earfoðlice, þæt hē on eorðan geseah
þone lēofestan līfes æt ende
2825 blēate gebāran. Bona swylce læg,
egeslic eorð-draca, ealdre berēafod,
bealwe gebæded: bēah-hordum leng
wyrm wōh-bogen wealdan ne mōste,
ac him irenna ecga fornāmon,
2830 hearde heaðo-scearpe homera lāfe,
þæt se wīd-floga wundum stille
hrēas on hrūsan hord-ærne nēah,
nalles æfter lyfte lācende hwearf
middel-nihtum, mād̥m-æhta wlonc
2835 ansyn ywde: ac hē eorðan gefēoll
for þæs hild-fruman hond-geweorce.
Hūru þæt on lande lýt manna pāh
mægen-āgendra mīne gefræge,
þēah þe hē dāda gehwæs dyrstig wære,
2840 þæt hē wið attor-sceaðan oreðe geræsde,
oððe hring-sele hondum styrede,
gif hē wæccende weard onfunde
būan on beorge. Bīowulfe wearð
dryht-mād̥ma dāl dēaðe forgolden;
2845 hæfde æghwæðer ende gefēred
lēnan līfes. Næs pā lang tō þon,
þæt pā hild-latan holt ofgēfan,
týdre trēow-logan týne ætsomne,
pā ne dorston ær dareðum lācan

- 2850 on hyra man-dryhtnes miclan þearfe;
 ac hȳ scamende scyldas bāran,
 gūð-gewædu, þær se gomela læg:
 wliton on Wīglāf. Hē gewērgad sæt,
 fēðe-cempa frēan eaxlum nēah,
 2855 wehte hyne wætre; him wiht ne spēow;
 ne meahte hē on eorðan, þēah hē ūðe wēl,
 on þām frum-gāre feorh gehealdan,
 nē þæs wealdendes willan wiht oncirran;
 wolde dōm godes dædum rædan
 2860 gumena gehwylcum, swā hē nū gēn dēð.
 Þā wæs æt þām geongan grim andswaru
 ēð-begēte þām þe ær his elne forlēas.
 Wīglāf maðelode, Wēohstānes sunu,
 secg sārīg-ferð seah on unlēofe:
 2865 "Þæt lā mæg secgan, sē þe wyle sōð spreca,
 "þæt se mon-dryhten, se ēow þā māðmas geaf,
 "ēored-geatwe, þē gē þær on standað,
 "þonne hē on ealu-bence oft gesealde
 "heal-sittendum helm and byrnan,
 2870 "þēoden his þegnum, swylce hē þrȳðlicost
 "ōhwær feor oððe nēah findan meahte,
 "þæt hē gēnunga gūð-gewædu
 "wrāðe forwurpe. Þā hyne wīg beget,
 "nealles folc-cyning fyrd-gesteallum
 2875 "gylpan þorfte; hwæðre him god ūðe,
 "sigora waldend, þæt hē hyne sylfne gewræc
 "āna mid ecge, þā him wæs elnes þearf,
 "Ic him lif-wraðe lȳtle meahte
 "ætgifan æt gūðe and ongan swā þēah
 2880 "ofer mīn gemet mæges helpa:
 "symle wæs þȳ sāmra, þonne ic sweorde drep
 "ferð-genīðlan, fȳr unswīðor
 "wēoll of gewitte. Wergendra tō lȳt
 "þrong ymbe þēoden, þā hyne sīo þrāg becwōm.
 2885 "Nū sceal sinc-þego and swyrd-gifu
 "eall ēðel-wyn ēowrum cynne,
 "lufen ālicgean: lond-rihtes mōt
 "þære mæg-burge monna æghwylc

"īdel hweorfan, syððan æðelingas
2890 "feorran gefricgean flēam ēowerne,
"dōm-lēasan dæd. Dēað bið sēlla
"eorla gehwylcum þonne edwīt-līf!"

The Soldier's Dirge and Prophecy

Fit XL

Heht þā þæt heaðo-weorc tō hagan bīodan
up ofer ēg-clif, þær þæt eorl-weorod
2895 morgen-longne dæg mōd-giōmor sæt,
bord-hæbbende, bēga on wēnum
ende-dōgores and eft-cymes
lēofes monnes. Lȳt swīgode
nīwra spella, sē þe næs gerād,
2900 ac hē sōðlice sægde ofer ealle;
"Nū is wil-geofa Wedra lēoda,
"dryhten Gēata dēað-bedde fæst,
"wunað wæl-reste wyrmes dædum;
"him on efn ligeð ealdor-gewinna,
2905 "siex-bennum sēoc: sweorde ne meahte
"on þām āglācean ænige þinga
"wunde gewyrcean. Wīglāf siteð
"ofer Biowulfe, byre Wihstānes,
"eorl ofer ōðrum unlifigendum,
2910 "healdeð hige-mēðum hēafod-wearde
"lēofes and lāðes. Nū ys lēodum wēn
"orleg-hwīle, syððan underne
"Froncum and Frȳsum fyll cyninges
"wīde weorðeð. Wæs sīo wrōht scepen
2915 "heard wið Hūgas, syððan Higelāc cwōm
"faran flot-herge on Frēsna land,
"þær hyne Hetware hilde gehnægdon,

- "elne geēodon mid ofer-mægene,
 "þæt se byrn-wiga būgan sceolde,
 2920 "fēoll on fēðan: nalles frætwe geaf
 "ealdor dugoðe; ūs wæs ā syððan
 "Merewīoinga milts ungyfeðe.
 "Nē ic tō Swēo-þēode sibbe oððe trēowe
 "wihte ne wēne; ac wæs wīde cūð,
 2925 "þætte Ongenþīo ealdre besnyðede
 "Hæðcyn Hrēðling wið Hrefna-wudu,
 "þā for on-mēðlan ærest gesōhton
 "Gēata lēode Gūð-scilfingas.
 "Sōna him se frōda fæder Ōhtheres,
 2930 "eald and eges-full ond-slyht āgeaf,
 "ābrēot brim-wīsan, brýd āhēorde,
 "gomela īo-meowlan golde berofene,
 "Onelan mōdor and Ōhtheres,
 "and þā folgode feorh-genīðlan
 2935 "oð þæt hī oðēodon earfoðlice
 "in Hrefnes-holt hlāford-lēase.
 "Besæt þā sin-herge sweorda lāfe
 "wundum wērges, wēan oft gehēt
 "earnre teohhe andlonge niht:
 2940 "cwæð hē on mergenne mēces ecgum
 "gētan wolde, sume on galg-trēowum
 "fuglum tō gamene. Frōfor eft gelamp
 "sārig-mōdum somod ær-dæge,
 "syððan hīe Hygelāces horn and bīman
 2945 "gealdor ongeāton. Þā se gōða cōm
 "lēoda dugoðe on lāst faran.

He Tells of the Swedes and the Geatas

Fit XLI

- "Wæs sīo swāt-swaðu Swēona and Gēata,
"wæl-ræs wera wīde gesȳne,
"hū þā folc mid him fæhðe tōwehton.
2950 "Gewāt him þā se gōda mid his gædelingum,
"frōd fela geōmor fæsten sēcean,
"eorl Ongenþīo ufor oncirde;
"hæfde Higelāces hilde gefrūnen,
"wlonces wīg-cræft, wiðres ne truwode,
2955 "þæt hē sǣ-mannum onsacan mihte,
"hēaðo-liðendum hord forstandan,
"bearn and brýde; bēah eft þonan
"eald under eorð-weall. Þā wæs æht boden
"Swēona lēodum, segn Higelāce.
2960 "Freoðo-wong þone forð oferēodon,
"syððan Hrēðlingas tō hagan þrungon.
"Þær wearð Ongenþīo ecgum sweorda,
"blonden-fexa on bīd wrecen,
"þæt se þēod-cyning þafian sceolde
2965 "Eofores ānne dōm: hyne yrringa
"Wulf Wonrēding wǣpne geræhte,
"þæt him for swenge swāt ædrum sprong
"forð under fexe. Næs hē forht swā þēh,
"gomela Scilfing, ac forgeald hraðe
2970 "wyrsan wrixle wæl-hlem þone,
"syððan þēod-cyning þyder oncirde:

- "ne meahte se snella sunu Wonrēdes
 "ealdum ceorle ond-slyht giofan,
 "ac hē him on hēafde helm ær gescer,
 2975 "þæt hē blōde fāh būgan sceolde,
 "fēoll on foldan; næs hē fæge þā gīt,
 "ac hē hyne gewyrpte, þēah þe him wund hrīne,
 "Lēt se hearda Higelāces þegn
 "brādne mēce, þā his brōðor læg,
 2980 "eald sweord eotonisc, entiscne helm,
 "brecan ofer bord-weal: þā gebēah cyning,
 "folces hyrde, wæs in feorh dropen.
 "Þā wæron monige, þē his mæg wriðon,
 "ricone ārærdon, þā him gerȳmed wearð,
 2985 "þæt hīe wæl-stōwe wealdan mōston.
 "Þenden rēafode rinc oðerne,
 "nam on Ongenþīo īren-byrnan,
 "heard swyrd hilted and his helm somod;
 "hāres hyrste Higelāce bær.
 2990 "Hē þām frætwwum fēng and him fægre gehēt
 "lēana fore lēodum and gelæste swā:
 "geald þone gūð-ræs Gēata dryhten,
 "Hrēðles eafora, þā hē tō hām becōm,
 "Jofore and Wulfe mid ofer-māðmum,
 2995 "sealde hiora gehwæðrum hund þūsenda
 "landes and locenra bēaga; ne þorfte him þā lēan oðwītan
 "mon on middan-gearde, syððan hīe þā mæra geslōgon;
 "and þā Jofore forgeaf āngan dōhtor,
 "hām-weorðunge, hylde tō wedde.
 3000 "Þæt ys sīo fāhðo and se fēond-scipe,
 "wæl-nīð wera, þæs þe ic wēn hafo,
 "þē ūs sēceað tō Swēona lēode,
 "syððan hīe gefricgeað frēan ūserne
 "ealdor-lēasne, þone þe ær gehēold
 3005 "wið hettendum hord and rice,
 "æfter hāleða hryre hwate Scylfingas,
 "folc-ræd fremede oððe furður gēn
 "eorl-scipe efnde. Nū is ofost betost,
 "þæt wē þēod-cyning þær scēawian
 3010 "and þone gebringan, þē ūs bēagas geaf,

- "on ād-fære. Ne scel ānes hwæt
 "meltan mid þām mōdigan, ac þær is māðma hord.
 "gold unrīme grimme gecēapod
 "and nū æt sīðestan sylfes fēore
 3015 "bēagas gebohte; þā sceal brond fretan,
 "æled þeccean, nalles eorl wegan
 "māððum tō gemyndum, nē mægð scýne
 "habban on healse hring-weorðunge,
 "ac sceall geōmor-mōd golde berēafod
 3020 "oft nalles āne el-land tredan,
 "nū se here-wīsa hleahtor ālegde,
 "gamen and glēo-drēam. Forþon sceall gār wesan
 "monig morgen-ceald mundum bewunden,
 "hæfen on handa, nalles hearpan swēg
 3025 "wīgend weccan, ac se wonna hrefn
 "fūs ofer fāgum, fela reordian,
 "earne secgan, hū him æt æte spēow,
 "þenden hē wið wulf wæl rēafode."
 Swā se secg hwata secgende wæs
 3030 lāðra spella; hē ne lēag fela
 wyrda nē worda. Weorod eall ārās,
 ēodon unblīðe under Earna næs
 wollen-tēare wundur scēawian.
 Fundon þā on sande sāwul-lēasne
 3035 hlim-bed healdan, þone þe him hringas geaf
 ærran mælum: þā wæs ende-dæg
 gōdum gegongen, þæt se gūð-cyning,
 Wedra þēoden, wundor-dēaðe swealt.
 Ær hī gesēgan syllicran wiht,
 3040 wyrm on wonge wiðer-ræhtes þær
 lāðne licgean: wæs se lēg-draca,
 grimlic gryre-gæst, glēdum beswæled,
 sē wæs fiftiges fōt-gemearces.
 lang on legere, lyft-wynne hēold
 3045 nihtes hwīlum, nyðer eft gewāt
 dennes nīosian; wæs þā dēaðe fæst,
 hæfde eorð-scrafta ende genyttod.
 Him big stōdan bunan and orcas,
 discas lāgon and dýre swyrd,

- 3050 ðmige þurh-etone, swā hīe wið eorðan fæðm
 þūsend wintra þær eardodon:
 þonne wæs þæt yrfe ēacen-cræftig,
 iū-monna gold galdre bewunden,
 þæt þām hring-sele hrīnan ne mōste
3055 gumena ænig, nefne god sylfa,
 sigora sōð-cyning, sealde þām þe hē wolde
 (hē is manna gehyld) hord openian,
 efne swā hwylcum manna, swā him gemet þūhte.

Wīglaf Speaks. the Building of the Bale-Fire

Fit XLII

- 3060 Þā wæs gesȳne, þæt se sīð ne þāh
 þām þe unrihte inne gehȳdde
 wræte under wealle. Weard ær ofslōh
 fēara sumne; þā sīo fāhð gewearð
 gewrecen wrāðlice. Wundur hwār, þonne
 eorl ellen-rōf ende gefēre
- 3065 līf-gesceafta, þonne leng ne mæg
 mon mid his māgum medu-seld būan.
 Swā wæs Biowulfe, þā hē biorges weard
 sōhte, searo-nīðas: seolfa ne cūðe,
 þurh hwæt his worulde gedāl weorðan sceolde;
- 3070 swā hit oð dōmes dæg dīope benemdon
 þēodnas mære, þā þæt þær dydon,
 þæt se secg wære synnum scildig,
 hergum geheaðerod, hell-bendum fæst,
 wommum gewītnad, sē þone wong strāde.
- 3075 Næs hē gold-hwæt: gearwor hæfde
 āgendes ēst ær gescēawod.
 Wīglāf maðelode, Wihstānes sunu:
 "Oft sceall eorl monig ānes willan
 "wræc adrēogan, swā ūs geworden is.
- 3080 "Ne meahton wē gelæran lēofne þēoden,
 "rīces hyrde rād ænigne,
 "þæt hē ne grētte gold-weard þone,
 "lēte hyne licgean, þær hē longe wæs,

- "wīcum wunian oð woruld-ende.
 3085 "Hēoldon hēah gesceap: hord ys gescēawod,
 "grimme gegongen; wæs þæt gifeðe tō swīð,
 "þē þone þēoden þyder ontyhte.
 "Ic wæs þær inne and þæt eall geond-seh,
 "recedes geatwa, þā mē gerȳmed wæs,
 3090 "nealles swæslice sið ālȳfed
 "inn under eorð-weall. Ic on ofoste gefēng
 "micle mid mundum mægen-byrðenne
 "hord-gestrēona, hider ūt ætbær
 "cynige mīnum: cwico wæs þā gēna,
 3095 "wīs and gewittig; worn eall gespræc
 "gomol on gehðo and ēowic grētan hēt,
 "bæd þæt gē geworhton æfter wines dædum
 "in bæl-stede beorh þone hēan
 "micelne and mārne, swā hē manna wæs
 3100 "wīgend weorð-fullost wīde geond eorðan,
 "þenden hē burh-welan brūcan mōste.
 "Uton nū efstan oðre siðe
 "sēon and sēcean searo-geþræc,
 "wundur under wealle! ic ēow wīsigē,
 3105 "þæt gē genōge nēan scēawiað
 "bēagas and brād gold. Sie sīo bær gearo
 "ædre geæfned, þonne wē ūt cymen,
 "and þonne geferian frēan ūserne,
 "lēofne mannan, þær hē longe sceal
 3110 "on þæs waldendes wære gepolian."
 Hēt þā gebēodan byre Wīhstānes,
 hæle hilde-dīor, hæleða monegum
 bold-āgendra, þæt hīe bæl-wudu
 feorran feredon, folc-āgende
 3115 gōdum tōgēnes: "Nū sceal glēd fretan
 "(weaxan wonna lēg) wigena strengel,
 "þone þe oft gebād īsern-scūre,
 "þonne stræla storm, strengum gebæded,
 "scōc ofer scild-weall, sceft nytte hēold,
 3120 "feðer-gearwum fūs flāne full-ēode."
 Hūru se snotra sunu Wīhstānes
 ācīgde of corðre cyninges pegnas

- syfone tōsomne þā sēlestan,
 ēode eahta sum under inwit-hrōf;
 3125 hilde-rinc sum on handa bær
 æled-lēoman, sē þe on orde gēong.
 Næs þā on hlytme, hwā þæt hord strude,
 syððan or-wearde ænigne dæl
 secgas gesēgon on sele wunian,
 3130 læne licgan: lýt ænig mearn,
 þæt hī ofostlice ūt geferedon
 dýre mǣðmas; dracan ēc scufun,
 wýrm ofer weall-clif, lēton wæg niman,
 flōd fæðmian frætwa hyrde.
 3135 Þær wæs wunden gold on wæn hladen,
 æghwæs unrīm, æðeling boren,
 hār hilde-rinc tō Hrones næsse.

Bēowulf's Funeral Pyre

Fit XLIII

- Him þā gegiredan Gēata lēode
āð on eorðan un-wāclīcne,
3140 helmum behongen, hilde-bordum,
beorhtum byrnum, swā hē bēna wæs;
ālegdon þā tō-middes mārne þēoden
hæleð hīofende, hlāford lēofne.
Ongunnon þā on beorge bæl-fýra mæst
3145 wīgend weccan: wudu-rēc āstāh
sweart ofer swioðole, swōgende lēg,
wōpe bewunden (wind-blond gelæg)
oð þæt hē þā bān-hūs gebrocen hæfde,
hāt on hreðre. Higum unrōte
3150 mōd-ceare mændon mon-dryhtnes cwealm;
swylce giōmor-gyd lat . con meowle
. wunden heorde . . .
serg (?) cearig sælde geneahhe
þæt hīo hyre gas hearde
3155 ede wælfylla wonn . .
hildes egesan hyðo
haf mid heofon rēce swealh (?)
Geworhton þā Wedra lēode
hlāw on hliðe, sē wæs hēah and brād,
3160 wæg-liðendum wīde gesýne,
and betimbredon on tyn dagum
beadu-rōfes bēcn: bronda betost
wealle beworhton, swā hyt weorðlicost
fore-snotre men findan mihton.

- 3165 Hī on beorg dydon bēg and siglu,
 eall swylce hyrsta, swylce on horde ær
 nīð-hȳdige men genumen hæfdon;
 forlēton eorla gestrēon eorðan healðan,
 gold on grēote, þær hit nū gēn lifað
 3170 eldum swā unnyt, swā hit æror wæs.
 Þā ymbe hlāw riodan hilde-dēore,
 æðelinga bearn ealra twelfa,
 woldon ceare cwīðan, kyning mænan,
 word-gyd wrecan and ymb wer sprecan,
 3175 eahtodan eorl-scipe and his ellen-weorc
 duguðum dēmdon, swā hit ge-dēfe bið,
 þæt mon his wine-dryhten wordum herge,
 ferhðum frēoge, þonne hē forð scile
 of līc-haman lāne weorðan.
 3180 Swā begnornodon Gēata lēode
 hlāfordes hryre, heorð-genēatas,
 cwædon þæt hē wære woruld-cyning
 mannum mildust and mon-þwærust,
 lēodum līðost and lof-geornost.

The Fight at Finnsburg

Appendix

- " næs byrnað næfre."
Hleoðrode þā heaðo-geong cyning:
"Ne þis ne dagað ēastan, ne hēr draca ne flēogeð,
"ne hēr þisse healle hornas ne byrnað,
5 "ac fēr forð berað fugelas singað,
"gylleð græg-hama, gūð-wudu hlynneð,
"scyld scefte oncwýð. Nū scýneð þes mōna
"waðol under wolcnum; nū ārīsað wēa-dæda,
"þē þisne folces nīð fremman willað.
10 "Ac onwacnigeað nū, wīgend mīne,
"hebbað ēowre handa, hicgeað on ellen,
"winnað on orde, wesað on mōde!"
Þā ārās monig gold-hladen þegn, gyrde hine his swurde;
þā tō dura ēodon drihtlice ceman,
15 Sigeferð and Eaha, hyra sweord getugon,
and æt oðrum durum Ordlāf and Gūðlāf,
and Hengest sylf; hwearf him on lāste.
Þā gīt Gārulf Gūðere styrode,
þæt hīe swā frēolic feorh forman sīðe
20 tō þære healle durum hýrsta ne bēaran,
nū hyt nīða heard ānyman wolde:
ac hē frægn ofer eal undearninga,
dēor-mōd hæleð, hwā þā duru hēolde.
"Sigeferð is mīn nama (cwæð hē), ic eom Secgena lēod,
25 "wrecca wīde cūð. Fela ic wēana gebād,
"heardra hilda; þē is gýt hēr witod,
"swæðer þū sylf tō mē sēcean wylle."

- Ðā wæs on wealle wæl-slihta gehlyn,
 sceolde cēlod bord cēnum on handa
 30 bān-helm berstan. Buruh-þelu dynede,
 oð þæt æt þære gūðe Gārulf gecrang,
 ealra ārest eorð-būendra,
 Gūðlāfes sunu; ymbe hine gōdra fela.
 Hwearf flacra hræw hræfn, wandrode
 35 sweart and sealo-brūn; swurd-lēoma stōd
 swylce eal Finns-buruh fýrenu wære.
 Ne gefrægn ic nāfre wurðlicor æt wera hilde
 sixtig sige-beorna sēl gebæran,
 ne nāfre swānas swētnē medo sēl forgyldan,
 40 þonne Hnæfe guldon his hæg-stealdas.
 Hig fuhton fíf dagas, swā hyra nān ne fēol
 driht-gesīða, ac hig þā duru hēoldon.
 Ðā gewāt him wund hæleð on wæg gangan,
 sāde þæt his byrne ābrocen wære,
 45 here-sceorpum hrōr, and ēac wæs his helm þyrl.
 Ðā hine sōna frægn folces hyrde,
 hū þā wīgend hyra wunda genāson
 oððe hwæðer þāra hyssa

The Old English Physiologus: The Panther

Original Old English Poem

Monge sindon geond middangeard
unrīmu cynn, [þāra] þe wē æþelu ne magon
ryhte āreccan nē rīm witan;
þæs wīde sind geond wor[u]l[d] innan
5 fugla and dēora foldhrērendra
wornas widsceope, swā wæter bibūgeð
þisne beorhtan bōsm, brim grymetende,
sealtȳpa geswing.
Wē bi sumum hȳrdon
wrætlic[um] gecynd[e] wildra secgan,
10 fīrum frēamærne, feorlondum on,
eard weardian, ēðles nēotan,
æfter dūnscefum. Is þæt dēor Pandher
bi noman hāten, þæs þe niþpa bear[n],
wīsfæste weras, on gewritum cȳpa[ð]
15 bi þām ānstapan.
Sē is æ[g]hwām frēond,
duguða ēstig, būtan dracan ānum;
þām hē in ealle tīd andwrāð leofaþ,
þurh yfla gehwylc þe hē geæfnan mæg.
Ðæt is wrætlic dēor, wundrum scȳne,

- 20 hīwa gehwylces. Swā hāleð secgað,
 gæsthālge guman, þætte Iōsēphes
 tunece wære telga gehwylces
 blēom bregdende, þāra beorhtra gehwylc,
 æghwæs ænlīcra, oþrum līxte
 25 dryhta bearnum, swā þæs dēores hīw,
 blāc, brigda gehwæs, beorhtra and scýnra
 wundrum līxeð, þætte wrætlicra
 æghwylc oþrum, ænlīcra gīen
 and fægerra, frætwum blīceð,
 30 symle sellicra.
 Hē hafað sundorgecynd,
 milde, gemetfæst. Hē is monþwære,
 lufsum and lēoftæl: nele lāþes wiht
 æ[ng]um geæfnan būtan þām āttorsceapan,
 his fyrngflitan, þe ic ær fore sægde.
 35 Symle, fylle fægen, þonne fōddor þigeð,
 æfter þām gereordum ræste sēceð,
 dýgle stōwe under dūnscafum;
 ðær se þeo[d]wiga þrēonihta fæc
 swifeð on swe[o]fote, slāpe gebiesga[d].
 40 Þonne ellenrōf ūp āstondeð,
 þrymme gewelga[d], on þone þridan dæg,
 snēome of slāpe. Swēghlēoþor cymeð,
 wōþa wynsumast, þurh þæs wildres mūð;
 æfter pære stefne stenc ūt cymeð
 45 of þām wongstede– wynsumra stēam,
 swētttra and swīþra, swæcca gehwylcum,
 wyrta blōstmum and wudublēdum,
 eallum æþelīcra eorþan frætw[um].
 Þonne of ceastrum and cynestōlum
 50 and of burgsalum beornþrēat monig

- farað foldwegum folca þrýpum;
 ēoredcystum, ofestum gefýsde,
 dareðlācende –dēor [s]wā some–
 æfter þære stefne on þone stenc farað.
- 55 Swā is Dryhten God, drēama Rædend,
 eallum ēaðmēde ōprum gesceaftum,
 duguða gehwylcre, būtan dracan ānum,
 āttres ordfruman– þæt is se ealda fēond
 þone hē gesælde in sūsla grund,
- 60 and gefetrade fýrnum tēagum,
 biþeahte þrēanȳdum; and þȳ þridðan dæge
 of dīgle ārās, þæs þe hē dēað fore ūs
 þrēo niht þolade, þēoden engla,
 sigora Sellend. Þæt wæs swēte stenc,
- 65 wlitig and wynsum, geond woruld ealle.
 Siþþan tō þām swicce sōðfæste men,
 on healfa gehwone, hēapum þrungon
 geond ealne ymbhwyrft eorþan scēat[a].
 Swā se snottra gecwæð Sanctus Paulus:
- 70 'Monigfealde sind geond middangeard
 gōd ungnȳðe þe ūs tō giefе dæleð
 and tō feorhnere Fæder ælmihtig,
 and se ānga Hyht ealra gesceafta
 uppe ge nīpre.' Þæt is æþele stenc.

The Old English Physiologus: The Whale (Asp-Turtle)

Original Old English Poem

- Nū ic fitte gēn ymb fisca cynn
wille wōðcræfte wordum cȳpan
þurh mōdgemynd, bi þām miclan hwale.
Sē bið unwillum oft gemēted,
5 frēcne and fer[h]ðgrim, fareðlācendum,
niþþa gehwylcum; þām is noma cenned,
fyr[ge]nstrēama geflotan, Fastitocalon.
Is þæs hīw gelīc hrēofum stāne,
swylce wōrie bi wædes ofre,
10 sondbeorgum ymbseald, sārȳrica mæst,
swā þæt wēnaþ wægliþende
þæt hȳ on ēalond sum ēagum wliten;
and þonne gehȳd[i]að hēahstefn scipu
tō þām unlonde oncyrrāpum,
15 s[æ]llaþ sāmearas sundes æt ende,
and þonne in þæt ēglond ūp gewītað
collenfer[h]pe; cēolas stondað
bi staþe fæste strēame biwunden.
Ðonne gewīciað wērigfer[h]ðe,

- 20 faroðlācende, frēcnes ne wēnað.
 On þām ēalonde æled weccað,
 hēah fyr ælað. Hæleþ bēoþ on wynnum,
 rēonigmōde, ræste gel[y]ste.
 Ponne gefēleð fācnes cræftig
 25 þæt him þā fērend on fæste wuniaþ,
 wīc weardiað, wedres on luste,
 ðonne semninga on sealtne wæg
 mid þā nōþe niþer gewīteþ,
 gārsecges gæst, grund gesēceð,
 30 and þonne in dēaðsele drence bifæsteð
 scipu mid scealcum.
 Swā bið scinn[en]a þēaw,
 dēofla wīse, þæt hī droht[i]ende
 þurh dyrne meahht duguðe beswīcað,
 and on teosu tyhtaþ tilra dæda,
 35 wēmað on willan, þæt hī wraþe sēcen,
 frōfre tō fēondum, oþþæt hy fæste ðær
 æt þām wærlogan wīc gecēosað.
 Ponne þæt gecnāweð of cwicsūsle
 flāh fēond gemāh, þætte fīra gehwylc
 40 hæleþa cynnes on his hringe biþ
 fæste gefēged, hē him feorgbona,
 þurh slīpen searo, siþþan weorþeð,
 wloncum and hēanum þe his willan hēr
 firenum fremmað; mid þām hē fāringa,
 45 heolophelme biþeaht, helle sēceð,
 gōða gēasne, grundlēasne wylm
 under mistglōme, swā se micla hwæl
 se þe bisenceð sālīpende
 eorlas and yðmearas.
 Hē hafað oþre gecynd,

- 50 wæterþisa wlonc, wrætlicran gien.
 Þonne hine on holme hunger bysgað,
 and þone āglæcan ætes lystþ,
 ðonne se merewearð mūð ontýneð,
 wīde weleras; cymeð wynsum stenc
 55 of his innoþe, þætte oþre þurh þone,
 sǣfisca cynn, beswicen weorðap.
 Swimmað sundhwate þær se swēta stenc
 ūt gewīt[e]ð. Hī þær in farað,
 unware weorude, oþþæt se wīda ceaf
 60 gefylled bið; þonne færinga
 ymbe þā herehūþe hlemmeð tōgædre
 grimme gōman.
 Swā biþ gumena gehwām
 se þe oftost his unwærlice,
 on þās lānan tīd, lif biscēawað:
 65 lāteð hine beswīcan þurh swētnes stenc,
 lēasne willan, þæt hē biþ leahtrum fāh
 wið Wuldorcýning. Him se āwyrġda ongēan
 æfter hinsīþe helle ontýneð,
 þām þe lēaslice lices wynne
 70 ofer ferh[ð]gereiht fremedon on unræd.
 Þonne se fæcna in þām fæstenne
 gebrōht hafað, bealwes cræftig,
 æt þām [ā]dwylme, þā þe him on cleofiað,
 gyltum gehrodene, and ær georne his
 75 in hira lifdagum lārum hýrdon,
 þonne he þā grimman gōman bihlemmeð,
 æfter feorhcwale, fæste tōgædre,
 helle hlinduru. Nāgon hwyrft nē swice,
 ūtsīþ æfre, þā [þe] þær in cumað,
 80 þon mā þe þā fiscas, faraðlācende,

of þæs hwæles fenge hweorfan mōtan.

Forþon is eallunga

.

dryhtna Dryhtne, and ā dēoflum wiðsace

85 wordum and weorcum, þæt wē Wuldorcyning

gesēon mōton. Uton ā sibbe tō him,

on þās hwīlnan tīd, hælu sēcan,

þæt wē mid swā lēofne in lofe mōtan

tō wīdan feore wuldres nēotan.

The Old English Physiologus: The Partridge

Original Old English Poem

Hȳrde ic secgan gēn bi sumum fugle
wundorlīcne¹.

.
.
.

. fæger

þæt word þe gecwæð wuldres Ealdor:

5 'In swā hwylce tiid swā gē mid trēowe tō mē
on hyge hweorfað, and gē hellfirena
sweartra geswīcað, swā ic symle tō ēow
mid siblufan sōna gecyrre

þurh milde mōd; gē bēoð mē sibþan

10 torhte, tīrēadge, talade and rīmde,
beorhte gebrōþor on bearna stæġ.

Uton wē þȳ geornor Gode ōliccan,

firene fēogan, friþes earnian,

duguðe tō Dryhtne, þenden ūs dæg scīne,

15 þæt swā æþelne eardwīca cyst
in wuldres wlite wunian mōtan.

Finit.

¹Gap in the manuscript, probably of considerable length.

Editorial note: The partridge (like the cuckoo) broods the eggs of other birds. When they are hatched and grown, they fly off to their true parents. So men may turn from the devil, who has wrongfully gained possession of them, to their heavenly Father, who will receive them as his children.

The Battle of Ashdown

Old English Reader

871. Hēr cuôm sê here tō Rêadingum on Westseaxe, ond þæs ymb iii niht ridon ii eorlas ûp. Þa gemêtte hîe

Æþelwulf aldorman on Englafelda, ond him þær wiþ gefeaht, ond sige nam. Þæs ymb ii niht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôþur þær micle fierd tō Rêadingum gelæddon, ond wiþ þone here gefuhton; ond þær wæs micel wæl geslægen on gehwæpre hond, ond Æþelwulf aldorman wearþ ofslægen; ond þa Deniscan âhton wælstôwe gewald.

On þæs ymb ii niht gefeaht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôþur wiþ alne þone here on Æscesdûne. Ond hîe wærun on twæm gefylcum: on ôþrum wæs Bâchsecg ond Halfdene þa hæþnan cyningas, ond on ôþrum wæron þa eorlas. Ond þa gefeaht sê cyning Æþered wiþ þara cyninga getruman, ond þær wearþ sê cyning Bâgsecg ofslægen; ond Ælfred his brôþur wiþ þara eorla getruman, ond þær wearþ Sidroc eorl ofslægen sê alda, ond Sidroc eorl sê gioncga, ond Ôsbearn eorl, ond Fræna eorl, ond Hareld eorl; ond þa hergas bēgen gefliemde, ond fela þûsenda ofslægenra, ond onfeohende wæron oþ niht.

On þæs ymb xiiii niht gefeaht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôður wiþ þone here æt Basengum, ond þær þa Deniscan sige nâmon.

On þæs ymb ii mōnaþ gefeaht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôþur wiþ þone here æt Meretûne, ond hîe wærun on tuæm gefylcum, ond hîe bûtû gefliemdon, ond longe on dæg sige âhton; ond þær wearþ micel wælsliht on gehwæpere hond; ond þa Deniscan âhton wælstôwe

gewald; ond þær wearþ Hêahmund bisceop ofslægen, ond fela gôdra monna. Ond æfter þissum gefeohte cuôm micel sumorlida.

Onð þæs ofer Êastron gefôr Æþered cyning; onð hê rîcsode v gêar; onð his lîc lîþ æt Wînburnan.

Þâ fêng Ælfred Æþelwulfing his brôþur tô Wesseaxna rîce. Onð þæs ymb ânne mônað gefeaht Ælfred cyning wiþ alne þone here lýtle werede æt Wiltûne, onð hine longe on dæg gefliemde, onð þâ Deniscan âhton wælstôwe gewald.

Onð þæs gêares wurdon viiii folcgefeohht gefohten wiþ þone here on þý cynerîce be sûþan Temese, bûtan þâm þe him Ælfred þæs cyninges brôþur onð ânlîpig aldormon onð cyninges þegnas oft råde onridon þe mon nâ ne rîmde; onð þæs gêares wærun ofslægene viiii eorlas onð ân cyning. Onð þý gêare nâmon Westseaxe friþ wiþ þone here.

A Prayer of King Alfred

Old English Reader

Dryhten, ælmihtiga God, Wyrhta and Wealdend ealra gesceafta, ic bidde ðê for ðînre miclan mildheortnesse, and for ðære hâlgan rôde tâcne, and for Sanctæ Marian mægðhåde, and for Sancti Michaelles gehîersumnesse, and for ealra ðînra hâlgena lufan and hîera earnungum, ðæt ðû mê gewissie bet ðonne ic âworhte tô ðê; and gewissa mê tô ðinum willan, and tô mînre sâwle ðearfe, bet ðonne ic self cunne; and gestaðela mîn môd tô ðinum willan and tô mînre sâwle ðearfe; and gestranga mê wið ðæs dêofles costnungum; and âfierr fram mê ðâ fûlan gâlnesse and ælce unrihtwîsnesse; and gescield mê wið mînum wiðerwinnum, gesewenlîcum and ungesewenlîcum; and tæc mê ðînne willan tô wyrceanne; ðæt ic mæge ðê inweardlice lufian tôforan eallum ðingum, mid clænum geðance and mid clænum lîchaman. For ðon ðe ðû eart mîn Scieppend, and mîn Alîesend, mîn Fultum, mîn Frôfor, mîn Trêownes, and mîn Tôhopa. Sîe ðê lof and wuldor nû and â â â, tô worulde bûtan æghwilcum ende. Amen.

The Voyages of Ohthere and Wulfstan

Old English Reader

Ohthere's First Voyage

Ôthere sǣde his hlāforde, Ælfræde cyninge, þæt hê ealra Norðmonna norþmest bûde. Hê cwæð þæt hê bûde on þǣm lande norþweardum wiþ þā Westsæ. Hê sǣde þeah þæt þæt land sîe swîpe lang norþ þonan; ac hit is eal wêste, bûton on fêawum stôwum styccemælum wíciað Finnas, on huntoðe on wintra, ond on sumera on fiscope be þære sǣ. Hê sǣde þæt hê æt sumum cirre wolde fandian hû longe þæt land norþryhte læge, oþþe hwæðer ænig mon be norðan þǣm wêstenne bûde. Ða fôr hê norþryhte be þǣm lande lêt him ealne weg þæt wêste land on ðæt stêorbord, ond þa wîdsǣ on ðæt bæcbord þrîe dagas. Ða wæs hê swâ feor norþ swâ þa hwælhuntan firrest farap. Ða fôr hê þa gîet norþryhte swâ feor swâ hê meahte on þǣm ôþrum þrîm dagum gesiglan. Ða bæag þæt land þær eastryhte, oþþe sêo sǣ in on ðæt lond, hê nysse hwæðer, bûton hê wisse ðæt hê ðær bād westanwindes ond hwôn norþan, ond siglde ða east be lande swâ swâ hê meahte on fêower dagum gesiglan. Ða sceolde hê ðær bîdan ryhtnorþanwindes, for ðæm þæt land bæag þær sûþryhte, oþþe sêo sǣ in on ðæt land, hê nysse hwæper. Ða siglde hê þonan sûðryhte be lande

swâ swâ hê mehte on fîf dagum gesiglan. Ða læg þær ân micel ea ûp in on þæt land. Ða cirdon hîe ûp in on ða ea, for þǣm hîe ne dorston forþ bi þære ea siglan for unfripe; for þǣm ðæt land wæs eall gebûn on ôpre healfe þære eas. Ne mêtte hê ær nân gebûn land, siþþan hê from his âgnum hām fôr; ac him wæs ealne weg wêste land

on þæt stēorbord, būtan fiscerum ond fugelerum ônd huntum, ond þæt wæron eall Finnas; ond him wæs â wīdsæ on ðæt bæcbord. Ða Beormas hæfdon swīpe wel gebûd hira land: ac hīe ne dorston þær on cuman. Ac þāra Terfinna land wæs eal wēste, būton ðær huntan gewīcodon, oþpe fisceras, oþpe fugeleras.

Hē wæs swyðe spēdig man on þām æhtum þe heora spēda on bēoð, þæt is, on wilddrum. Hē hæfde þa gýt, ða hē þone cyningc sôhte, tamra dêora unbebohtra syx hund. Ða dêor hī hâtað 'hrânas'; þāra wæron syx stælrânas; ða bēoð swyðe dýre mid Finnum, for ðām hý fôð þa wildan hrânas mid. Hē wæs mid þām fyrstum mannum on þām lande næfde hē þeah mǎ ðonne twēntig hrýðera, and twēntig scēapa, and twēntig swýna; and þæt lýtle þæt hē erede, hē erede mid horsan. Ac hyra âr is mǣst on þām gafole þe ða Finnas him gyldað. Þæt gafol bið on dêora fellum, and on fugela feðerum, and hwales bāne, and on þām sciprāpum þe bēoð of hwæles hýde geworht and of sēoles. Æghwīlc gylt be hys gebyrdum. Sē byrdesta sceall gyl-dan fiftýne mearðes fell, and fīf hrânes, and ân beren fel, and tyn ambra feðra, and berenne kyrtel oððe yterenne, and twēgen sciprāpas; ægþer sý syxtig elna lang, oþer sý of hwæles hýde geworht, oþer of sīoles.

stôwum, swâ brâd swâ man mæg on twām wucum oferfêran; and on sumum stôwum swâ brâd swâ man mæg on syx dagum oferfêran.

Ohthere's Second Voyage

Ôhthere sǣde þæt sīo scīr hâtte Hâlgoland, þe hē on bûde. Hē cwæð þæt nân man ne bûde be norðan him. Þonne is ân port on sūðewardum þām lande, þone man hât Sciringeshêal. Þyder hē cwæð þæt man ne mihte geseglian on ânum mônðe, gyf man on niht wīcode, and ælce dæge hæfde ambyrne wind; and ealle ða hwīle hē sceal seglian be lande. And on þæt stēorbord him bið ærest Íra-land, and þonne ða ígland þe synd betux Íralande and þissum lande. Þonne is þis land, oð hē cymð tô Scirincgeshêale, and ealne weg on þæt bæcbord Norðweg.

Wið sūðan þone Sciringeshêal fylð swyðe mycel sǣ ûp in on ðæt land; sēo is brâdre þonne ænig man ofer sēon mæge. And is Gotland on ôðre healfe ongêan, and siððan Sillende. Sēo sǣ līð mænig hund mīla ûp in on þæt land.

Wulfstan's Voyage

Wulfstân sǣde þæt hê gefôre of Hǣðum, þæt hê wære on Trûsô on syfan dagum and nihtum, þæt þæt scip wæs ealne weg yrnende under segle. Weonodland him wæs

on stêorbord, and on bæcbord him wæs Langaland, and Lǣland, and Falster, and Scônêg; and þâs land eall hȳrað tō Denemearcan. And þonne Burgenda land wæs ūs on bæcbord, and þâ habbað him sylfe cyning. Ponne æfter Burgenda lande wæron ūs þâs land, þâ synd hâtene ærest Blêcinga-êg, and Méore, and Êowland, and Gotland on bæcbord; and þâs land hȳrað tō Swêom. And Weonodland wæs ūs ealne weg on stêorbord oð Wîslemûðan. Sêo Wîsle is swȳðe mycel êa, and hîo tōlið Witland and Weonodland; and þæt Witland belimpeð tō Estum; and sêo Wîsle lið út of Weonodlande, and lið in Estmere; and sê Estmere is hûru fiftêne mîla brâd. Ponne cymeð Ilfing êastan in Estmere of ðâm mere, ðe Trûsô standeð in stæðe; and cumað út samod in Estmere, Ilfing êastan of Estlande, and Wîsle sûðan of Winodlande. And þonne benimð Wîsle Ilfing hire naman, and ligeð of þæm mere west and norð on sǣ; for ðȳ hit man hæt Wîslemûða.

licgað bufan eorðan on hyra hûsum. And ealle þâ hwîle þe þæt lîc bið inne, þær sceal bêon gedrync and plega, oð ðone dæg þe hî hine forbærnað. Ponne þȳ ylcan dæge þe hî hine tō þæm âde beran wyllað, þonne tōdǣlað hî his feoh, þæt þær tō lāfe bið æfter þæm gedrynce and þæm plegan, on fîf oððe syx, hwȳlum on mâ, swâ swâ þæs fêos andêfn bið. Âlecgað hit ðonne forhwæga on ânre mîle þone mǣstan dǣl fram þæm tûne, þonne ôðerne, ðonne þone þridðan, oþ þe hyt eall âlêd bið on þære ânre mîle; and sceall bêon sê læsta dǣl nȳhst þæm tûne ðe sê dêada man on lið. ðonne sceolon bêon gesamnode ealle ðâ menn ðe swyftoste hors habbað on þæm lande, forhwæga on fîf mîlum oððe on syx mîlum fram þæm fêo. Ponne ærnað hȳ ealle tōweard þæm fêo ðonne cymeð sê man sê þæt swiftoste hors hafað tō þæm ærestan dǣle and tō þæm mǣstan, and swâ ælc æfter ôðrum, oþ hit bið eall genumen; and sê nimð þone læstan dǣl sê nȳhst þæm tûne þæt feoh gearneð. And þonne rîdeð ælc hys weges mid ðæm fêo, and hyt môtan habban eall; and for ðȳ þær bêoð þâ swiftan hors ungefôge dȳre. And þonne his gestrêon bêoð þus eall âspended, þonne byrð man hine út, and forbærneð mid his wæpnum and hrægle; and swiðost

ealle hys spêda hȳ forspendað mid þāem langan legere þæs dêadan mannes inne, and þæs þe hȳ be þāem wegum âlecgað, þe ðâ fremdan tō ærnað, and nimað. And þæt is mid Estum þêaw þæt þær sceal ælces geðêodes man bêon forbærned; and gyf þâr man ân bân findeð unforbærned, hî hit sceolan miclum gebêtan. And þær is mid Estum ân mægð þæt hî magon cyle gewyrcan; and þȳ þær licgað þa dêadan men swâ lange, and ne fûliað, þæt hȳ wyrcað þone cyle him on. And þêah man âsette twêgen fætels full ealað oððe wæteres, hȳ gedôð þæt ægþer bið oferfrozen, sam hit sȳ sumor sam winter.

The Story of Cædmon

Old English Reader

In ðysse abbudissan mynstre wæs sum brôðor syndriglice mid godcundre gife gemæred ond geweorðad, for þon he gewunade gerisenlice lêoð wyrcan, þâ ðe tô æfestnisse ond tô ârfæstnisse belumpon; swâ ðætte swâ hwæt swâ hê of godcundum stafum þurh bôceras geleornode, þæt hê æfter medmiclum fæce in scopgereorde mid þâ mæstan swêtnisse ond inbryrdnisse geglengde, ond in Englis-
cgereorde wel geworht forþ brôhte. Ond for his lêopsongum

monigra monna môd oft to worulde forhogdnisse ond tô gepêod-
nisse þæs heofonlican lifes onbærnde wæron. Ond êac swelce monige ôðre æfter him in Ongelþêode ongunnon æfeste lêoð wyrcan, ac nænig hwæðre him þæt gelice dôn ne meahte; for þon hê nâlæs from monnum nê ðurh mon gelæred wæs þæt hê ðone lêoðcræft leor-
nade, ac hê wæs godcundlice gefultumod, ond þurh Godes gife þone songcræft onfêng; ond hê for ðon næfre nôht lêasunge, nê îdles lêopes wyrcan ne meahte, ac efne þâ ân ðâ ðê tô æfestnisse belumpon ond his þâ æfestan tungan gedafenode singan.

gongende tô nêata scipene, þâra heord him wæs þære nihte bebo-
den; þâ hê ðâ þær on gelimplîcre tîde his leomu on reste gesette ond onslêpte, þa stôd him sum mon æt þurh swefn, ond hine hâlette ond grêtte, ond hine be his noman nemndê "Cædmon, sing mê hwæth-
wugu." Þâ ondswarede hê, ond cwæð: "Ne con ic nôht singan; ond ic for þon of þyssum gebêorscipe ût êode ond hider gewât, for þon ic nâht singan ne cûðe." Eft hê cwæð sê ðe wið hine sprecende wæs: "Hwæðre þû meaht mê singan." Þâ cwæð hê: "Hwæt sceal ic sin-
gan?" Cwæð hê: "Sing mê frumsceaft." Þâ hê ðâ þâs andsware on-
fêng, þâ ongon hê sôna singan, in herenesse Godes Scyppendes, þâ fers ond þâ word þe hê næfre ne gehyrde, þâra endebyrdnes þis is:

Hê ærest scēop eorðan bearnum heofon tō hrōfe, hâlig Scyppend; þâ middangeard monncynnes Weard, êce Drihten, æfter tēode fīrum foldan, Frēa ælmihtig.

gifu forgifen. Ðâ rehton heo him ond sægdon sum hâlig spell ond godcundre lâre word: bebudon him þâ, gif hê meahte, þæt hê in swînsunge lêoþsonges þæt gehwyrfde. Ðâ hê ðâ hæfde þâ wîsan onfongne, þâ êode hê hâm tō his hûse, ond cwôm eft on morgenne, ond þȳ betstan lêoðe geglenged him âsong ond âgeaf þæt him beboden wæs.

canônes bôca; ond bî Crîstes menniscnesse, ond bî his þrôwunge, ond bî his ûpâstîgnesse in heofonas; ond bî þæs Hâlgan Gâstes cyme, ond þâra apostola lâre; ond eft bî þæm dæge þæs tōweardan dômes, ond bî fyrhtu þæs tintreglîcan wîtes, ond bî swêtnesse þæs heofonlîcan rîces, hê monig lêoð geworhte; ond swelce êac ôðer monig be þæm godcundan fremsumnessum ond dômum hê geworhte. In eallum þæm hê geornlîce gêmde þæt hê men âtuge from synna lufan ond mândæda, ond tō lufan ond tō geornfulnesse âwehte gôdra dæda, for þon hê wæs, sê mon, swîpe æfest ond regollîcum þêodscipum êaðmôdlîce underþêoded; ond wið þæm þâ ðe in ôðre wîsan dôn woldon, hê wæs mid welme micelre ellenwôdnisse onbærned. Ond hê for ðon fægre ende his lîf betȳnde ond geendade.

Alfred's Preface to the Pastoral Care

Old English Reader

Ælfred kyning hâteð grētan Wærferð biscep his wordum luflice ond frēondlice; ond ðe cȳðan hâte ðæt mē cōm swīðe oft on gemynd, hwelce witan iu wæron giond Angelcynn, ægðer ge godcundra hāda ge woruldcundra; ond hū gesæliglica tīda ðā wæron giond Angelcynn; ond hū ðā kyningas ðe ðone onwald hæfdon ðæs folces on ðām dagum Gode ond his ærendwrecum hērsumedon; ond hū hīe ægðer ge hiora sibbe ge hiora siodo ge hiora onweald innanbordes gehioldon, ond ēac út hiora ēðel gerȳmdon; ond hū him ðā spēow ægðer ge mid wīge ge mid wīsdōme; ond ēac ða godcundan hādas hū giorne hīe wæron ægðer ge ymb lāre ge ymb liornunga, ge ymb ealle ðā ðiowotdōmas ðe hīe Gode dōn scoldon; ond hū man ūtanbordes wīsdōm ond lāre hieder on lond sōhte, ond hū wē hīe nū sceoldon ūte begietan, gif wē hīe habban sceoldon. Swā clāne hīo wæs oðfeallenu on Angelcynne ðæt swīðe fēawa wæron behionan Humbre ðe hiora ðēninga cūðen understondan on Englisc oððe furðum ān ærendgewrit of Lādene on Englisc āreccean; ond ic wēne ðætte nōht monige begiendan Humbre nāren. Swā fēawa hiora wæron ðæt ic furðum ānne ānlēpne ne mæg geðencean

be sūðan Temese, ðā ðā ic tō rīce fēng. Gode ælmihtegum sīe ðonc ðætte wē nū ænigne onstāl habbað lārēowa. Ond for ðon ic ðe bebōde ðæt ðū dō swā ic geliefe ðæt ðū wille, ðæt ðū ðe ðissa worulddīnga tō ðām geāmetige, swā ðū oftost mæge, ðæt ðū ðone wīsdōm ðe ðe God sealde ðær ðær ðū hiene befæstan mæge, befæste. Geðenc hwelc wītu ūs ðā becōmon for ðisse worulde, ðā ðā wē hit nōhwæðer nē

selfe ne lufodon, nê êac ôðrum monnum ne lêfdon: ðone naman âne wê lufodon ðætte wê Crîstne wæren, ond swîðe fêawe ðâ ðêawas.

nænne dæl noldon on hiora âgen geðîode wendan. Ac ic ðâ sôna eft mê selfum andwyrde, ond cwæð: "Hie ne wêndon þætte æfre menn sceolden swæ reccelêase weorðan, ond sîo lâr swæ oðfeallan; for ðære wilnunga hie hit forlêton, ond woldon ðæt hêr ðy mîra wîsdôm on londe wære ðy wê mâ geðêoda cûðon."

nânre ôðerre note ne mægen, oð ðone first ðe hie wel cunnen Englisc gewrit ârædan: lære mon siððan furður on Lædengeðîode ðâ ðe mon furðor læran wille, ond tô hierran hâde dôn wille. Ðâ ic ðâ gemunde hû sîo lâr Lædengeðîodes ær ðissum âfeallen wæs giond Angelcynn, ond ðeah monige cûðon Englisc gewrit ârædan, ðâ ongan ic ongemang oðrum mislîcum ond manigfealdum bisgum ðisses kynerîces ðâ bôc wendan on Englisc ðe is genemned on Læden "Pastoralis," ond on Englisc "Hierdebôc," hwîlum word be worde, hwîlum andgit of andgiete, swæ swæ ic hie geliornode æt Plegmunde mînum ærcebiscepe, ond æt Assere mînum biscepe, ond æt Grimbolde mînum mæsseprîoste, ond æt Iôhanne mînum mæsseprêoste. Siððan ic hie ðâ geliornod hæfde, swæ swæ ic hie forstôd, ond swæ ic hie andgitfullîcost âreccean meahte, ic hie on Englisc âwende; ond tô ælcum biscepstôle on mînum rîce wille âne onsendan; ond on ælcra bið ân æstel, sê bið on fîftegum mancessa. Ond ic bebîode on Godes naman ðæt nân mon ðone æstel from ðære béc ne dô, nê ðâ bôc from ðæm mynstre; uncûð hû longe ðær swæ gelærede biscepas sîen, swæ swæ nû, Gode ðonc, wel hwær siendon. For ðy ic wolde ðætte hie ealneg

æt ðære stôwe wæren, bûton sê biscep hie mid him habban wille, oððe hîo hwær tô læne sîe, oððe hwâ ôðre bî wrîte.

The Wanderer

Old English Reader

- 1 Oft him ânhaga âre gebîdeð,
Metudes miltse, þêah þe hê mōdcearig
geond lagulâde longe sceolde
hrêran mid hondum hrîmcealde sǣ,
5 wadan wræclæstas: wyrd bið ful âræd!
Swâ cwæð eardstapa earfeþa gemyndig,
wrâþra wælsleahta, winemæga hryres:
"Oft ic sceolde âna ûhtna gehwylce
mîne ceare cwîþan; nis nû cwicra nân,
10 þe ic him mōdsefan mînne durre
sweotule âsecgan. Ic tô sôþe wât
þæt biþ in eorle indryhten þêaw,
þæt hê his ferðlocan fæste binde,
healde his hordcofan, hycge swâ hê wille;
15 ne mæg wêrig mōd wyrde wiðstondan
nê sê hrêo hyge helpe gefremman:
for ðon dômgeorne drêorigne oft
in hyra brêostcofan bindað fæste.
Swâ ic mōdsefan mînne sceolde
20 oft earmcearig êðle bidæled,
frêomægum feor feterum sǣlan,
siþþan gêara iû goldwine mînne
hrûsan heolster biwrâh, and ic hêan þonan
wôd wintercearig ofer wapema gebind,
25 sôhte sele drêorig since bryttan,
hwær ic feor oþþe nêah findan meahte
þone þe in meoduhealle miltse wisse
oþþe mec frêondlêasne frêfran wolde,

- wenian mid wyнным. Wāt sê þe cunnað
 30 hū slīpen bið sorg tō gefêran
 þām þe him lýt hafað lêofra geholenā
 warað hine wræclāst, nāles wunden gold,
 ferðloca frêorig, nālæs foldan blæd;
 gemon hê selescegas and sincþege,
 35 hū hine on geoguðe his goldwine
 wenede tō wistē wyn eal gedrêas!
 For þon wāt sê þe sceal his winedryhtnes
 lêofes lārcwidum longe forþolian,
 ðonne sorg and slæp somod ætgædre
 40 earmne ānhagan oft gebindað:
 þinceð him on mōde þæt hê his mondryhten
 clyppe and cysse, and on cnêo lecge
 honda and hêafod, swā hê hwīlum ær
 in gêardagum giefstôles brêac;
 45 ðonne onwæcneð eft winelêas guma,
 gesihð him biforan fealwe wægās,
 bapian brimfuglas, brædan feþra,
 hrêosan hrīm and snāw hagle gemenged.
 Þonne bêoð þȳ hefigran heortan benne,
 50 sære æfter swæsne; sorg bið genīwad;
 þonne māga gemynd mōd geondhweorfeð,
 grêteð glīwstafum, georne geondscêawað.
 Secga geseldan swimmað eft on weg;
 flêotendra ferð nō þær fela bringeð
 55 cūðra cwidegiedda; cearo bið genīwad
 þām þe sendan sceal swīpe geneahhe
 ofer wapema gebind wêrigne sefan.
 For þon ic gebencan ne mæg geond þās woruld
 for hwan mōdsefa mīn ne gesweorce,
 60 þonne ic eorla līf eal geondþence,
 hū hī færlīce flet ofgêafon,
 mōdge maguþegnas. Swā þēs middangeard
 ealra dōgra gehwām drêoseð and fealleþ;
 for þon ne mæg weorþan wīs wer, ær hê āge
 65 wintra dæl in woruldrīce. Wita sceal geþyldig,
 ne sceal nō tō hātheort nê tō hrædwyrde,
 nê tō wac wiga nê tō wanhȳdig,

- nê tô forht nê tô fægen nê tô feohgîfre,
 nê nǣfre gielpes tô georn, ær hê geare cunne.
- 70 Beorn sceal gebídan, þonne hê bêot spriceð,
 oþ þæt collenferð cunne gearwe
 hwider hreþra gehygd hweorfan wille.
 Ongietan sceal glêaw hæle hû gǣstlíc bið,
 þonne eall þisse worulde wela wêste stondeð,
- 75 swâ nû missenlíce geond þisne middangeard
 winde biwâune weallas stondaþ,
 hrîme bihrorene, hryðge þâ ederas.
 Wôriað þâ wînsalo, waldend licgað
 drêame bidrorene; duguð eal gecrong
- 80 wlonc bi weallê sume wîg fornôm,
 ferede in forðwege; sumne fugel oþbær
 ofer hêanne holm; sumne sê hâra wulf
 dêaðe gedælde; sumne drêorighlêor
 in eorðscræfe eorl gehýddê
- 85 yþde swâ þisne eardgeard ælda Scyppend,
 oþ þæt burgwara breahmta lêase
 eald enta geweorc îdlu stôdon.
 Sê þonne þisne wealsteal wîse gepôhte,
 and þis deorce lîf dêope geondþenceð,
- 90 frôd in ferðe feor oft gemon
 wælsleahta worn, and þâs word âcwið:
 'Hwær cwôm mearg? hwær cwôm mago? hwær cwôm
 mâþpumgyfa?
 hwær cwôm symbla gesetu? hwær sindon seledrêamas?
 Êalâ beorht bune! êalâ byrnwiga!
- 95 êalâ þêodnes þrym! hû sêo þrâg gewât,
 genâp under nihthelm, swâ hêo nô wære!
 Stondeð nû on lâste lêofre duguþe
 weal wundrum hêah, wyrmlícum fâh:
 eorlas fornômon asca þryþe,
- 100 wæpen wælgîfru, wyrd sêo mære;
 and þâs stânhleoþu stormas cnyssað;
 hrîð hrêosende hrûsan bindeð,
 wintres wôma, þonne won cymeð,
 nîpeð nihtscûa, norþan onsendeð
- 105 hrêo hæglfare hæleþum on andan.

- Eall is earfoðlíc eorþan ríce,
 onwendeð wyrda gesceaft weoruld under heofonum:
 hēr bið feoh læne, hēr bið frēond læne,
 hēr bið mon læne, hēr bið mæg læne;
 110 eal þis eorþan gesteal îdel weorþeð!"
- Swā cwæð snottor on môde, gesæt him sundor æt rune.
 Til biþ sê þe his trēowe gehealdeð;
 ne sceal næfre his torn tō rycene
 beorn of his brēostum âcýþan, nemþe hê ær þā bôte cunne;
 115 eorl mid elne gefremman. Wel bið þām þe him âre sêceð,
 frôfre tō Fæder on heofonum,
 þær ûs eal sêo fæstnung stondeð.

SERMO DE INITIO CREATURÆ, AD POPULUM, QUANDO VOLUERIS

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

An angin is ealra þinga, þæt is God Ælmihtig. He is ordfruma and ende: he is ordfruma, forði þe he wæs æfre; he is ende butan ælcere geendunge, forðan þe he bið æfre ungeendod. He is ealra cyninga Cyning, and ealra hlaforða Hlaford. He hylt mid his mihte heofonas and eorðan, and ealle gesceafta butan geswince, and he besceawað þa niwelnyssa þe under þyssere eorðan sind. He awecð ealle duna mid anre handa, and ne mæg nan þing his willan wiðstandan. Ne mæg nan gesceaft fulfremedlice smeagan ne understandan ymbe god. Maran cyððe habbað englas to Gode þonne men, and þeah-hweðere hí ne magon fulfremedlice understandan ymbe God. Hé gesceop gesceafta þaða he wolde; þurh his wisdom he geworhte ealle þing, and þurh his willan hé hí ealle geliffæste. Deos þrynnys is án God; þæt is se Fæder and his wisdom of him sylfum æfre acenned; and heora begra willa, þæt is se Halga Gast: he nis na acenned, ac he gæð of þam Fæder and of þam Suna gelice. Ðas þry hadas sindon án Ælmihtig God, se geworhte heofenas, and eorðan, and ealle gesceafta. He gesceop tyn engla werod, þæt sind englas and heah-englas, thrони, dominationes, principatus, potestates, uirtutes, cherubim, seraphim. Her sindon nigon engla werod: hí nabbað nænne lichaman, ac hí sindon ealle gastas swiðe strange and mihtige and wlitige, on micelre fægernysse gesceapene, to lofe and to wurðmynte

heora Scyppende. Ðæt teoðe werod abreað and awende on yfel. God hí gesceop ealle góde, and let hí habban agenne cyre, swa hí heora Scyppend lufedon and filigdon, swa hí hine forleton. Ða wæs þæs teoðan werodes ealdor swiðe fæger and wlitig gesceapen, swa þæt hé wæs geháten Leohtberend. Ða began he to modigenne for þære fægernysse þe he hæfde, and cwæð on his heortan þæt hé wolde and eaðe mihte beon his Scyppende gelic, and sittan on þam norð-dæle heofenan rices, and habban andweald and rice ongearon God Ælmihtigne. Ða gefæstnode he þisne ræd wið þæt werod þe hé bewiste, and hí ealle to ðam ræde gebugon. Ðaða hí ealle hæfdon þysne ræd betwux him gefæstnod, þa becom Godes grama ofer hí ealle, and hí ealle wurdon awende of þam fægeran híwe, þe hí on gesceapene wæron, to laðlicum deoflum. And swiðe rihtlice him swa getimode, þaða he wolde mid modignysse beon betera þonne he gesceapen wæs, and cwæð, þæt he mihte beon þam Ælmihtigum Gode gelic. Ða wearð he and ealle his geferan forcupran and wýrsan þonne ænig oðer gesceaft; and þa hwile þe he smeade hu he mihte dælan rice wið God, þa hwile gearcode se Ælmihtiga Scyppend him and his geferum helle wite, and hí ealle adræfde of heofenan rices myrhðe, and let befeallan on þæt ece fyr, þe him gegearcod wæs for heora ofermetum. Ða sona þa nigon werod, þe ðær to lafe wæron, bugon to heora Scyppende mid ealre eaðmodnesse, and betæhton heora ræd to his willan. Ða getrymde se Ælmihtiga God þa nigon engla werod, and gestapelfæste swa þæt hí næfre ne mihton ne noldon syððan fram his willan gebugan; ne hí ne magon nu, ne hí nellað nane synne gewyr-can, ac hi æfre beoð ymbe þæt án, hu hi magon Gode gehyrsumian, and him gecweman. Swa mihton eac þa oðre þe ðær feollon dón, gif hi woldon; forþi ðe God hí geworhte to wlitigum engla gecynde, and let hí habban agenne cyre, and hí næfre ne gebigde ne ne nydde mid nanum þingum to þam yfelan ræde; ne næfre se yfela ræd ne com of Godes gepance, ac com of þæs deofles, swa swa we ær cwædon.

Nu þencð menig man and smeað hwanon deofol come; þonne wite he þæt God gesceop to mæran engle þone þe nu is deofol: ac God ne gesceop hine na to deofle; ac þaða he wæs mid ealle fordón and forscyldgod þurh þa miclan up-ahæfednysse and wiðerweardnysse, þa wearð he to deofle awend, seðe ær wæs mære engel geworht. Ða wolde God gefyllan and geinnian þone lyre þe forloren wæs of þam heofenlicum werode, and cwæð þæt hé wolde wyr-can mannan of eorðan, þæt se eorðlica man sceolde geþeon and geearnian

mid eadmodnysse þa wununga on heofenan rice, þe se deofol forwyrhte mid modignysse. And God þa geworhte ænne mannan of láme, and him on ableow gast, and hine gelíffæste, and he wearð þa mann gesceapen on sawle and on lichaman; and God him sette naman Adám, and he wæs þa sume hwile ástandende. God þa hine gebrohte on neorxna-wange, and hine þær gelogode, and him to cwæð, "Ealra þæra þinga þe on neorxna-wange sindon þu most brucan, and hí ealle beoð þe betæhte, buton anum treowe þe stent on middan neorxna-wange: ne hrepa þu þæs treowes wæstm, forþan ðe þu bist deadlic, gif ðu þæs treowes wæstm geetst." Hwí wolde God swa lytles þinges him forwyrnan, þe him swa miccle oðre þing betæhte? Gyse hu mihte Adám tocnawan hwæt hé wære, buton hé wære gehyrsum on sumum þince his Hlaforde. Swylce God ewáde to him, "Nast þu na þæt ic eom þin Hlaford and þæt þu eart min þeowa, buton þu do þæt ic þe háte, and forgáng þæt ic þe forbeode. Hwæt mæg hit þonne beon þæt þu forgán sceole: ic ðe secge, forgang ðu anes treowes wæstm, and mid þære eaðelican gehyrsumnysse þu geearnast heofenan rices myrhðu and þone stede þe se deofol of-afeoll þurh ungehyrsumnesse. Gif ðu þonne ðis lytle bebód tobrecst, þu scealt deaðe sweltan." And þa wæs Adam swa wís þæt God gelædde to him nytenu, and deorcynn, and fugelcynn, ðaða he hí gesceapene hæfde; and Adam him eallum naman gesceop; and swa swa hé hí þa genamode swa hí sindon gyt gehatene. Þa cwæð God, "Nis na gedafenlic þæt þes man ana beo, and næbbe nænne fultum; ac uton gewyrcean him gemacan, him to fultume and to frofre." And God þa geswefode þone Adam, and þaþa he slep ða genam he an rib of his sidan, and geworhte of ðam ribbe ænne wifman, and axode Adam hu heo hatan sceolde. Þa cwæð Adam, "Heo is ban of minum banum, and flæsc of minum flæsce; beo hire nama Uirago, þæt is fæmne; forðan ðe heo is of hire were genumen." Ða sette Adam eft hire oðerne naman, Aeuia, þæt is lif; forðan ðe heo is ealra lybbendra modor.

Ealle gesceafta, heofonas and englas, sunnan and monan, steorran and eorðan, ealle nytenu and fugelas, sáe and ealle fixas, and ealle gesceafta God gesceop and geworhte on six dagum; and on ðam sefoðan dæge hé geendode his weorc, and geswac ða and gehalgode þone sefoðan dæg, forðan ðe hé on ðam dæge his weorc geendode. And he beheold þa ealle his weorc ðe he geworhte, and hí wæron ealle swiðe gode. Ealle ðing he geworhte buton ælcum antimbre. He

cwæð, "Geweorðe leoht," and ðærrihte wæs leoht geworden. He cwæð eft, "Geweorðe heofen," and þærrihte wæs heofen geworht, swa swa he mid his wisdom and mid his willan hit gedihte. He cwæð eft, and het ða eorðan þæt heo sceolde forðlædan cuce nytenu; and hé ða gesceop of ðære eorðan eall nytencynn, and deorcynn, ealle ða ðe on feower fotum gað; ealswa eft of wætere he gesceop fixas and fugelas, and sealde ðam fixum sund, and ðam fugelum fliht; ac he ne sealde nanum nytene ne nanum fisce nane sawle; ac heora blod is heora lif, and swa hraðe swa hi beoð deade, swa beoð hí mid ealle geendode. Þaða he worhte ðone mann Adám, he ne cwæð ná, "Geweorðe man geworht," ac he cwæð, "Uton gewyrcean mannan to ure anlicnyse," and hé worhte ða þone man mid his handum, and him on ableow sawle; forði is se man betera, gif hé góde geðihð, þonne ealle ða nytenu sindon; forðan ðe hí ealle gewurðað to nahte, and se man is ece on anum dæle, þæt is on ðære sawle; heo ne geendað næfre. Se lichama is deadlic þurh Adames gylt, ac ðeah-hwæðere God arærð eft ðone lichaman to ecum ðingum on domes dæg. Nu cwædon gedwolmen þæt deofol gesceope sume gesceafta, ac hí leogað; ne mæg hé nane gesceafta gescyppan, forðan ðe he nis na Scyppend, ac is atelic sceocca, and mid leasunge he wile beswican and fordón þone unwaran; ac he ne mæg nænne man to nanum leahltre geneadian, buton se mon his agenes willes to his lare gebuge. Swa hwæt swa is on gesceaftum wiðerweardlic gepuht and mannum derige, þæt is eall for urum synnum and yfelum gearnungum.

Þa ongeat se deofol þæt Adam and Eua wæron to ðy gesceapene þæt hi sceolon mid eadmodnyse and mid gehyrsumnyse gearnian ða wununge on heofenan rice ðe hé of-afeoll for his up-ahefednyse, þa nam hé micelne graman and ándan to þam mannum, and smeade hú hé hí fordón mihte. He com ða on næddran hiwe to þam twam mannum, ærest to ðam wife, and hire to cwæð, "Hwí forbead God eow þæs treowes wæstm, ðe stent on middan neorxna-wange?" Þa cwæð þæt wíf, "God us forbead þæs treowes wæstm, and cwæð þæt we sceoldon deaðe sweltan, gif we his on byrigdon." Ða cwæð se deofol, "Nis hit na swa ðu segst, ac God wát genoh geare, gif ge of ðam treowe geetað, þonne beoð eowere eagan geopenode, and ge magon geseon and tocnáwan ægðer ge gód ge yfel, and ge beoð englum gelice." Næron hí blinde gesceapene, ac God hí gesceop swa bilewite þæt hí ne cuðon nan ðing yfeles, naðor ne on gesihðe, ne on spræce, ne on weorce. Wearð þeah þæt wíf ða forspanen þurh ðæs de-

ofles l re, and genam of   es treowes w estme, and ge t, and sealde hire were, and h  ge t.   a w eron h  butu deadlice, and cu  on  eg  er ge g d ge yfel; and h  w eron   a nacode, and him   es sceamode.   a com God and axode hwi he his bebod tobr  e? and adr efde h  butu of neorxna-wange, and cw   , "For  an   e   u w ere gehyrsum   ines wifes wordum, and min bebod forsawe,   u scealt mid earfo nyssum   e metes tilian, and seo eor  e   e is awyriged on   inum weorce, syl    e   ornas and bremblas.   u eart of eor  an genumen, and   u awenst to eor  an.   u eart dust, and   u awentst to duste." God him worhte   a reaf of fellum, and h  w eron mid   am fellum gescrydde.

  a deadan fell getacnodon    t h  w eron   a deadlice   e mihton beon undeadlice, gif hi heoldon    t ead elice Godes bebod. Ne   orfte Adam ne eal mancynn   e him si   an ofacom n fre dea  es onbyrian, gif    t treow moste standan ungehrepod, and his nan man ne onbyrigde; ac sceolde Adam and his ofspring tyman on asettum tyman, swa swa nu do  cl ene nytenu, and si   an ealle buton dea  e faran to   an ecan life. N s him gesceapen fram Gode, ne h  n s genedd    t h  sceolde Godes bebod tobrecan; ac God hine l t frigne, and sealde him agenne cyre, swa h  w ere gehyrsum, swa h  w ere ungehyrsum. H  wear    a deofle gehyrsum, and Gode ungehyrsum, and wear  bet  t, h  and eal mancynn,   fter   isum l fe, into hellew te, mid   am deofle   e hine forl erde.   a wiste God hw   ere    t h  w es forl ered, and smeade hu he mihte his and ealles mancynnes eft gemiltsian.

On twam   ingum h fde God    s mannes sawle gegodod;    t is mid undeadlicnysse, and mid ges   e.   a   urh deofles swicdom and Adames gylt we forluron   a ges   e ure sawle, ac we ne forluron n    a undeadlicnysse ; heo is   ce, and n fre ne geenda ,   eah se lichama geendige,   e sceal eft   urh Godes mihte arisan to ecere wununge. Adam   a w es wunigende on   isum life mid geswince, and h  and his w f   a bearn gestryndon,   g  er ge suna ge dohtra; and he leofode nigon hund geara and   rittig geara, and si   an swealt, swa swa him   er behaten w es, for   an gylte; and his sawul gewende to helle.

Nu smeagia  sume men hwanon him come sawul? hw   er   e of   am f eder,   e of    ere meder? We cwe  a  of heora na rum; ac se ylca God   e gesceop Adam mid his handum, he gescyp    lces mannes lichaman on his modor inno e; and se ylca se  e able w on Ad mes lichaman, and him forgeaf sawle, se ylca forgyf  cildum

sawle and líf on heora modor innoðe, þonne hí gesceapene beoð; and he lætt hí habban agenne cyre, þonne hí geweaxene beoð, swa swa Adám hæfde.

Þa wearð þa hrædlice micel mennisc geweaxen, and wæron swiðe manega on yfel awende, and gegremodon God mid mislicum leahtrum, and swiðost mid forligere. Ða wearð God to þan swiðe gegremod þurh manna mándæda þæt he cwæð þæt him ofþuhte þæt hé æfre mancynn gesceop. Ða wæs hwæpere án man rihtwis ætforan Gode, se wæs Nôe geháten. Þa cwæð God to him, "Ic wylle fordón eal mancynn mid wætere, for heora synnum, ac ic wylle gehealdan þe ænne, and þin wíf, and þine þry suna, Sem, and Cham, and Iafeth, and heora þreo wíf; forðan þe ðu eart rihtwis, and me gecweme. Wyrsc þe nú ænne arc, þreo hund fæðma lang, and fiftig fæðma wíd, and þritig fæðma heah: gehref hit eall, and geclæm ealle þa seamas mid tyrwan, and gá inn syððan mid þinum híwum. Ic gegaderige in to þe of deorcynne, and of fugelcynne symble gemacan, þæt hí eft to fostre beon. Ic wille sendan flod ofer ealne middangeard." He dyde þa swa him God bebed, and God beleac hí bynnan þam arce, and asende rén of heofonum feowertig daga togædere, and geopenode þær togeanes ealle wyll-springas and wæter-þeotan of þære micclan niwelnyssse. Ðæt flod weox ða and abær up þone arc, and hit oferstah ealle dúna. Wearð þa ælc þing cuces adrenct, buton þam ðe binnon þam arce wæron; of þam wearð eft ge-edstaðelod eall middangeard. Ða behét God þæt hé nolde næfre eft eal mancynn mid wætere acwellan, and cwæð to Noe and to his sunum, "Ic wylle settan mín wedd betwux me and eow to þisum beháte; þæt is, þonne ic oferteo heofenas mid wólcnun, þonne bið æteowod mín rénboga betwux þam wolcnun, þonne beo ic gemyndig mines weddes, þæt ic nelle heonon-forð mancynn mid wætere adrencan." Noe leofode on eallum his life, ær þam flode and æfter þam flode, nigon hund geara and fiftig geara, and he þa forðferde.

Ða wæs þa sume hwíle Godes ege on mancynne æfter þam flode, and wæs án gereord on him eallum. Ða cwædon hi betwux him þæt hi woldon wyrscan ane burh, and ænne stypel binnon þære byrig, swa heahne þæt his hrof astige up to heofenum: and begunnon þa to wyrscenne. Ða com God þærto, þaða hí swiðost worhton, and sealde ælcum men þe ðær wæs synderlice spræce. Þa wæron þær swa fela gereord swa ðær manna wæron; and heora nán nyste hwæt

oðer cwæð. And hí ða geswicon þære getimbrunge, and toferdon geond ealne middangeard.

Ða siððan wearð mancynn þurh deofol beswicen, and gebiged fram Godes geleafan, swa þæt hí worhton him anlicnyssa, sume of golde, sume of seolfre, sume eac of stanum, sume of treowe, and sceopon him naman; þæra manna naman þe wæron entas and yfel-dæde. Eft ðonne hí deade wæron, þonne cwædon þa cucan þæt hí wæron godas, and wurðodon hí, and him lác offrodon; and comon þa deoflu to heora anlicnyssum, and þæron wunodon, and to mannum spræcon swilce hí godas wæron; and þæt beswicene mennisc feoll on cneowum to þam anlicnyssum, and cwædon, "Ge sind ure godas and we besettað urne geleafan and urne hiht on eow." Ða asprang þis gedwyld geond ealne middangeard, and wæs se soða Scyppend, seðe ána is God, forsewen, and geunwurþod. Ða wæs hwæðere an mægð þe næfre ne abeah to nanum deofolgylde, ac æfre wurðode þone soðan God. Seo mægð aspráng of Nóes eltstan suna, se wæs gehaten Sem: he leofode six hund geara, and his sunu hatte Arfafað, se leofode þreo hund geara and þreo and þrittig, and his sunu hatte Salé, se leofode feower hund geara and XXXIII.; þa gestrynde he sunu se wæs geháten Ebér, of þam aspráng þæt Ebreisce folc, þe God leofode: and of þam cynne comon ealle heahfæderas and witegan, þa ðe cyðdon Cristes to-cyme to þisum life; þæt hé wolde man beon, fornean on ende þyssere worulde, for ure alysednesse, seðe æfre wæs God mid þam healican Fæder. And þyssere mægðe God sealde and gesette á, and hé hí lædde ofer sá mid drium fotum, and hé hí afedde feowertig wintra mid heofenlicum hlafe, and fela wundra on þam folce geworhte; forþan ðe he wolde of þyssere mægðe him modor geceosan.

Ða æt nextan, þa se tíma com þe God foresceawode, þa asende he his engel Gabrihel to anum mædene of þam cynne, seo wæs María gehaten. Þa com se engel to hire, and hí gegrette mid Godes wordum, and cydde híre, þæt Godes Sunu sceolde beon acenned of hire, buton weres gemanan. And heo þa gelyfde his wordum, and wearð mid cilde. Ðaða hire tíma com heo acende, and þurhwunode mæden. Ðæt cild is tuwa acenned: he is acenned of þam Fæder on heofonum, buton ælcere meder, and eft þaða hé man gewearð, þa wæs hé acenned of þam clænan mædene Marían, buton ælcum eorðlicum fæder. God Fæder geworhte mancynn and ealle gesceafta þurh ðone Sunu, and eft, ðaða we forwyrhte wæron, þa asende hé ðone ylcan

Sunu to úre alysednesse. Seo halige moder María þa afedde þæt cild mid micelre arwurðnesse, and hit weox swa swa oðre cild doð, buton synne anum.

He wæs buton synnum acenned, and his líf wæs eal buton synnum. Ne worhte he þeah náne wundra openlice árdan ðe hé wæs þritig wintre on þære menniscnysse: þa siðþan geceas he him leorning-cnihtas; ærest twelf, þa we hátað apostolas, þæt sind ærendracan. Siþþan hé geceas twá and hund-seofontig, þa sind genemnede discipuli, þæt sind leorning-cnihtas. Ða worhte hé fela wundra, þæt men mihton gelyfan þæt he wæs Godes Bearn. Hé awende wæter to wine, and eode ofer sæ mid drium fotum, and he gestilde windas mid his hæse, and hé forgeaf blindum mannum gesihðe, and heal-tum and lamum rihtne gáng, and hreoflium smeðnysse, and hælu heora lichaman; dumbum hé forgeaf getingnysse, and deafum heorc-nunge; deofolseocum and wodum hé sealde gewitt, and þa deoflu todræfde, and ælce untrumnysse he gehælde; deade men hé arærde of heora byrgenum to life; and lærde þæt folc þe hé to com mid micclum wisdom; and cwæð þæt nán man ne mæg beon gehealden, buton he rihtlice on God gelyfe, and he beo gefullod, and his geleafan mid godum weorcum geglenge; he onscunode ælc unriht and ealle leasunga, and tæhte rihtwisnysse and soðfæstnysse.

Þa nam þæt Iudeisce folc micelne ándan ongear his láre, and smeodon hú hí mihton hine to deaðe gedón. Þa wearð án ðæra twelfa Cristes geferena, se wæs Iudas gehaten, þurh deofles tihtinge beswicen, and hé eode to þam Iudeiscum folce, and smeade wið hí, hu he Crist him beláewan mihte. Þeah ðe eal mennisc wære gegaderod, ne mihton hí ealle hine acwellan, gif he sylf nolde; forði he cóm to us þæt hé wolde for ús deað þrowian, and swa eal mancynn þa ðe gelyfað mid his agenum deaðe alysan fram helle-wite. Hé nolde geniman ús neadunge of deofles anwealde, buton he hit forwyrhte; þa hé hit forwyrhte genóh swiðe, þaða hé gehwette and tihte ðæra Iudeiscra manna heortan to Cristes slege. Crist ða geðafode þæt ða wælhreowan hine genámon and gebundon, and on róde hengen acwealdon. Hwæt ða twegen gelyfede men hine arwurðlice bebyrigdon, and Crist on ðære hwile to helle gewende, and þone deofol gewylde, and him of-anám Adám and Euan, and heora ofspring, þone dæl ðe him ár gecwemde, and gelædde hí to heora lichaman, and arás of deaðe mid þam micclum werede on þam þridan dæge his þrowunge. Cóm þa to his apostolum, and hí gefrefrode, and

geond feowertigra daga fyrst him mid wunode; and ða ylcan lare þe hé him ár tæhte eft ge-edlæhte, and het hí faran geond ealne mid-dangearð, bodigende fulluht and soðne geleafan. Drihten ða on ðam feowerteogoðan dæge his æristes astah to heofenum, ætforan heora ealra gesihðe, mid þam ylcan lichaman þe hé on þrowode, and sitt on ða swiðran his Fæder, and ealra gesceafta gewylt. Hé hæfð gerymed rihtwisum mannum infær to his rice, and ða ðe his beboda eallunga forseoð beoð on helle besencte. Witodlice hé cymð on ende þyssere worulde mid micclum mægenþrymme on wolcnum, and ealle ða ðe æfre sawle underfengon arisað of deaðe him togeanes; and hé ðonne ða mánfullan deofle betæcð into ðam ecan fyre helle susle; þa rihtwisan he læt mid him into heofonan rice, on þam hí rixiað á on ecnysse.

Men ða leofestan, smeagað þysne cwyde, and mid micelre gymene forbugað unrihtwysnysse, and geearniað mid godum weorcum þæt éce líf mid Gode seðe ána on ecnysse rixað. Amen.

SERMO DE NATALE DOMINI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

We wyllað to trymminge eowres geleafan eow gereccan þæs Hælendes acennednysse be ðære godspellican endebyrdnysse: hû he on ðysum dægðerlicum dæge on soðre menniscnysse acenned wæs on godcundnysse.

Lucas se Godspellere awrát on Cristes béc, þæt on ðam timan se Romanisca casere Octauianus sette gebánn, þæt wære on gewritum asett eall ymbhwyrft. Þeos towritennys wearð aræred fram ðam ealdormen Cyrino, of Sirian lande, þæt ælc man ofer-heafod sceolde cennan his gebyrde, and his áre on ðære byrig þe hé to gehyrde. Þa ferde Ioseph, Cristes foster-fæder, fram Galileiscum earde, of ðære byrig Nazareð, to Iudeiscre byrig, seo wæs Dauides, and wæs geciged Bethleém, forðan ðe hé wæs of Dauides mægðe, and wolde andettan mid Márian hire gebyrde, þe wæs þa gýt bearn-eaca. Ða gelámp hit, þaða hí on þære byrig Bethleém wícodon, þæt hire tima wæs gefylled þæt heo cennan sceolde, and acende ða hyre frumcennedan sunu, and mid cild-claðum bewánd, and aléde þæt cild on heora assena binne, forþan þe ðær næs nán rymet on þam gesthuse. Þa wæron hyrdas on þam earde waciende ofer heora eowede; and efne ða Godes engel stód on emn hí, and Godes beorhtnys hí bescean, and hí wurdon micclum afyrhte. Ða cwæð se Godes engel to ðam hyrdum, "Ne ondredað eow; efne ic eow bodige micelne gefean, þe becymð eallum folce; forðan þe nu to-dæg is eow acenned Hælend Crist on Dauides ceastre. Ge geseoð þis tácen, ge gemétað þæt cild mid cild-claðum bewunden, and on binne geléd." Þa færlice, æfter þæs engles spræce, wearð gesewen micel menigu heofenlices werodes God

herigendra and singendra, "Gloria in excelsis Deo, et in terra pax hominibus bone uoluntatis," þæt is on urum gereorde, "Sy wuldor Gode on heannyssum, and on eorðan sibb mannum, þam ðe beoð godes willan." And ða englas ða gewiton of heora gesihðe to heofonum. Hwæt ða hyrdas þa him betweenan spræcon, "Uton faran to Bethleem, and geseon þæt word þe us God æteowde." Hí comon ða hrædllice, and gemetton Marían, and Ioseph, and þæt cild geled on anre binne, swa swa him se engel cydde. Þa hyrdas soðlice on-neowon be þam worde þe him gesæd wæs be ðam cilde, and ealle wundrodon þe þæt gehyrdon, and eac be ðam ðe þa hyrdas him sædon. María soðlice heold ealle þas wórd aráfniende on hire heortan. Ða gecyrdon þa hyrdas ongean wuldrigende and herigende God on eallum ðam ðingum þe hí gehyrdon and gesawon, swa swa him fram þam engle gesæd wæs.

Mine gebroðra þa leofostan, ure Hælend, Godes Sunu, euen-ece and gelic his Fæder, seðe mid him wæs æfre buton anginne, gemedemode hine sylfne þæt he wolde on ðisum dægðerlicum dæge, for middangeardes alysednysse beon lichamlice acenned of þam mædene Marían. He is Ealdor and Scyppend ealra gódnysa and sibbe, and he foresende his acennednysse ungewunelice sibbe, forðan ðe næfre næs swilc sibb ær þam fyrste on middangearde, swilc swa wæs on his gebyrde-tide, swa þæt eall middangeard wæs anes mannes rice underðeod, and eal mennisc him anum cynelic gafol ageaf. Witodlice on swa micelre sibbe wæs Crist acenned, seðe is ure sib, forþan ðe hé geþeodde englas and men to ánum hirede, þurh his menniscnysse. Hé wæs acenned on þæs caseres dagum þe wæs Octauianus geháten, se gerymde Romana rice to ðan swiðe þæt him eal middangeard to beah, and he wæs forði Augustus geciged, þæt is geýcende his rice. Se nama gedafenað þam heofonlican Cyninge Criste, þe on his timan acenned wæs, seðe his heofonlice rice geyhte, and ðone hryre, þe se feallenda deofol on engla werode gewanode, mid menniscum gecynde eft gefylde. Na þæt án þæt he ðone lyre anfealdlice gefylde, ac eac swylce micclum geihte. Soðlice swa micel getel mancynnes becymð þurh Cristes menniscnysse to engla werodum, swa micel swa on heofonum beláf haligra engla æfter ðæs deofles hryre. Þæs caseres gebann, þe het ealne middangeard awritan, getacnode swutellice þæs heofonlican Cyninges dæde, þe to ði com on middangeard þæt he of eallum ðeodum his gecorenan gegaderode, and heora naman on ecere eadignysse awrite. Þeos

towritennys asprang fram ðam ealdormen Cyrino: Cyrinus is gereht Yrfenuma, and he getacnode Crist, se ðe is soð yrfenuma þæs ecan Fæder; and he us forgifð þæt we mid him beon yrfenuman and efenhlyttan his wuldres. Ealle ðeoda þa ferdon þæt ælc synderlice be him sylfum cennan sceolde, on ðære byrig þe he to hyrde. Swa swa on ðam timan be ðæs caseres gebanne gehwilce ænlipige on heora burgum be him sylfum cendon, swa eac nu us cyðað lāreowas Cristes gebann, þæt we ús gegadrian to his halgan gelaðunge, and on ðære ures geleafan gafol mid estfullum mode him agifan, þæt ure naman beon awritene on lifes bec mid his gecorenum.

Drihten wæs acenned on þære byrig ðe is gehaten Bethleem; forðan ðe hit wæs swa ár gewitegod þisum wordum, "Þu Bethleem, Iudeisc land, ne eart ðu wacost burga on Iudeiscum ealdrum: soðlice of ðe cymð se latteow þe gewylt Israhela ðeoda." Crist wolde on ytinge beon acenned, to ði þæt he wurde his ehterum bedigelod. Bethleem is gereht 'Hlaf-hús,' and on hire wæs Crist, se soða hlaf, acenned, þe be him sylfum cwæð, "Ic eom se liflica hláf, þe of heofenum astáh, and se ðe of ðam hlafe geett ne swylt hé on ecnyse." Þæs hlafe we onbyriað þonne we mid geleafan to husle gað; forðan þe þæt halige husel is gastlice Cristes lichama; and þurh ðone we beoð alysede fram ðam ecan deaðe. María acende ða hire frumcennedan sunu on ðisum andweardan dæge, and hine mid cild-claðum bewánd, and for rymetleaste on anre binne geléde. Næs þæt cild forði gecweden hire frumcennede cild swilce heo oðer siððan acende, ac forði þe Crist is frumcenned of manegum gastlicum gebroðrum. Ealle cristene men sind his gastlican gebroðra, and hé is se frumcenneda, on gife and on godcundnyse ancenned of ðam Ælmihtigan Fæder. Hé wæs mid wacum cild-claðum bewæfed, þæt he ús forgeafe ða undeadlican tunecan, þe we forluron on ðæs frumsceapenan mannes forgægednyse. Se Ælmihtiga Godes Sunu, ðe heofenas befon ne mihton, wæs geled on nearuwre binne, to ði þæt he ús fram hellicum nyrwette alyse. María wæs ða cuma ðær, swa swa þæt godspel ús segð; and for ðæs folces geðryle wæs þæt gesthus ðearle genyrwed.

Se Godes Sunu wæs on his gesthuse genyrwed, þæt he us rume wununge on heofonan rice forgife, gif we his willan gehyrsumiað. Ne bitt hé us nānes ðinges to edleane his geswinces, buton ure sawle hælo, þæt we ús sylfe clāne and ungewemmede him gegearcian, to blisse and to ecere myrhðe. Þa hyrdas ðe wacodon ofer heora eowode

on Cristes acennednysse, getacnodon ða halgan lareowas on Godes gelaðunge, þe sind gastlice hyrdas geleaffulra sawla: and se engel cydde Cristes acennednysse hyrdemannum, forðam ðe ðan gastlicum hyrdum, þæt sind lareowas, is swiðost geopenod embe Cristes meniscnysse, þurh boclice lare; and hī sceolon gecneordlice heora underþeoddum bodian, þæt þæt him geswutelod is, swa swa ða hyrdas þa heofenlican gesihðe gewiðmærsodan. Þam lareowe gedafenað þæt hé symle wacol sy ofer Godes eowode, þæt se ungesewenlica wulf Godes scep ne tostence.

Gelóme wurdon englas mannum æteowode on ðære ealdan æ, ac hit nis awriten þæt hī mid leohte comon, ac se wurðmynt wæs þises dæges mærdæ gehealden, þæt hī mid heofenlicum leohte hī geswutelodon, ðaða þæt soðe leoht aspráng on ðeostum riht geþancodum, se mildheorta and se rihtwisa Drihten. Se engel cwæð to þam hyrdum, "Ne beo ge afyrhte; efne ic bodige eow micelne gefean, ðe eallum folce becymð, forðan þe nu to-dæg is acenned Hælend Crist on Dauides ceastre." Soðlice hé bodade micelne gefean, seðe næfre ne geendað; forðan þe Cristes acennednys gegladode heofenwara, and eorðwara, and helwara. Se engel cwæð, "Nu to-dæg is eow acenned Hælend Crist on Dauides ceastre:" Rihtlice hé cwæð on dæge, and ná on nihte, forðan ðe Crist is se soða dæg, seðe todraefde mid his to-cyme ealle nytennysse þære ealdan nihte, and ealne mid-dangeard mid his gife onlihte. Þæt tácen þe se engel ðam hyrdum sæde we sceolon symle on urum gemynde healdan, and þancian ðam Hælende þæt he gemedemode hine sylfne to ðan þæt hé dælnimend wære ure deadlicnysse, mid menniscum flæsce befangen, and mid wáclicum cild-claðum bewunden. Þa færlice, æfter þæs engles spræce, wearð gesewen micel menigu heofenlices werodes God herigendra and singendra, "Sy wuldor Gode on heannyssum, and on eorðan sibb þam mannum þe beoð godes willan." An engel bodade þam hyrdum þæs heofonlican Cyniges acennednysse, and ða færlice wurdon æteowode fela ðusend engla, þy læs ðe wære gepuht anes engles ealdordom to hwonlic to swa micelre bodunge: and hī ealle samod mid gedremum sange Godes wuldor hleoðrodon, and godum mannum sibbe bodedon, swutellice æteowiende þæt þurh his acennednysse men beoð gebigede to anes geleafan sibbe, and to wuldre godcundlicere herunge. Hī sungon, "Sy wuldor Gode on heannyssum, and on eorðan sibb mannum, ðam ðe beoð godes willan." Ðas word geswutelíað þæt ðær wunað Godes sibb þær se

goda willa bið. Eornostlice mancynn hæfde ungeþwærnyse to englum ær Drihtnes acennednyse; forðan ðe we wæron þurh synna ælfremede fram Gode; þa wurde we eac ælfremede fram his englum getealde: ac siððan se heofenlica Cyning urne eorðlican lichaman underfeng, siððan gecyrdon his englas to ure sibbe; and ða ðe hī ærðan untrume forsawon, þa hi wurðiað nu him to geferum. Witodlice on ðære ealdan æ, Loð, and Iosue, and gehwilce oðre þe englas gesawon, hī lutan wið heora, and to him gebædon, and ða englas þæt geðafodon: ac Iohannes se Godspellere, on ðære Niwan Gecyðnyse, wolde hine gebiddan to þam engle þe him to spræc, þa forwyrnde se engel him ðæs, and cwæð, "Beheald þæt ðu ðas dæde ne dó; ic eom ðin efen-ðeowa, and ðinra gebroðra; gebide ðe to Gode anum." Englas gepafodon ær Drihtnes to-cyme þæt mennisce men him to feollon, and æfter his to-cyme þæs forwyrndon; forðan þe hī gesáwon þæt heora Scyppend þæt gecynd underfeng þe hī ær ðan wáclíc tealdon, and ne dorston hit forseon on ús, þonne hī hit wurðiað bufon him sylfum on ðam heofonlican Cyninge. Ne hī manna geferrædene ne forhógiað, þonne hī feallende hī to þam menniscum Gode gebiddað. Nu we sind getealde Godes ceaster-gewaran, and englum gelíce; uton forði hógian þæt leahtras us ne totwæmon fram ðisum micclum wurðmynte. Soðlice men syndon godas gecigede; heald forði, ðu mann, þinne godes wurðscipe wið leahtras; forðan þe God is geworden mann for ðe.

Þa hyrdas ða spræcon him betweonan, æfter ðæra engla framfærelde, "Uton gefaran to Bethleém, and geseon þæt word þe geworden is, and God us geswutelode." Eala hū rihtlice hī andetton þone halgan geleafan mid þisum wordum, "On frymðe wæs wórd, and þæt word wæs mid Gode, and þæt wórd wæs God"! Word bið wisdomes geswutelung, and þæt Word, þæt is se Wisdom, is acenned of ðam Ælmihtigum Fæder, butan anginne; forðan ðe hé wæs æfre God of Gode, Wisdom of ðam wisan Fæder. Nis hé na geworht, forðan ðe he is God, and na gesceaft; ac se Ælmihtiga Fæder gesceop þurh ðone Wisdom ealle gesceafta, and hi ealle ðurh þone Halgan Gast gelífæste. Ne mihte ure mennisce gecynd Crist on ðære godcundlican acennednyse geseon; ac þæt ylce Word wæs geworden flæsc, and wunode on ús, þæt we hine geseon mihton. Næs þæt Word to flæsce awend, ac hit wæs mid menniscum flæsce befangen. Swa swa anra gehwile manna wunað on sawle and on lichaman án mann, swa eac Crist wunað on godcundnyse and menniscnyse, on ánum hade án

Crist. Hí cwædon, "Uton geseon þæt word þe geworden is," forðan ðe hí ne mihton hit geseon ær ðan ðe hit geflæschamod wæs, and to menn geworden. Nis þeahhwæðre seo godcundnys gemenged to ðære menniscnysse, ne ðær nan twæming nys. We mihton eow secgan ane lytle bysne, gif hit to wáclíc nære; Sceawa nú on anum æge, hú þæt hwite ne bið gemenged to ðam geolcan, and bið hwæðere án æg. Nis eac Cristes godcundnys gerunnen to ðære menniscnysse, ac he þurhwunað þeah á on ecnysse on anum hade untotwæmed.

Hrædlice ða comon þa hyrdas and gemetton Marian and Ioseph, and þæt cild geléd on ðære binne. Maria wæs be Godes dihte þam rihtwisan Iosepe beweddod, for micclum gebeorge; forðan ðe hit wæs swa gewunelic on Iudeiscre ðeode, æfter Moyses é, þæt gif ænig wimman cild hæfde butan be rihtre æwe, þæt hí man sceolde mid stanum oftorfian. Ac God asende his engel to Iosepe, ða María eacnigende wæs, and bead þæt he hire gymene hæfde, and þæs cildes foster-fæder wære. Þa wæs geðuht ðam Iudeiscum swilce Ioseph þæs cildes fæder wære, ac hé næs; forðan þe hit næs nan neod þam Ælmihtigum Scyppende þæt hé of wífe acenned wære; ac hé genam ða menniscnysse of Marían innoðe, and forlet hí mæden na gewemmed, ac gehalgod þurh his acennednysse. Ne oncneow heo weres gemanan, and heo acende butan sare, and þurhwunað on mægðhade. Þa hyrdas gesawon, and oncneowon be ðam cilde, swa swa him gesæd wæs. Nis nan eadignys butan Godes oncnawennesse, swa swa Crist sylf cwæð ðaða he us his Fæder betæhte, "Þæt is ece líf, þæt hi ðe oncnawon soðne God, and ðone ðe þu asendest Hælend Crist." Hwæt ða ealle ða ðe þæt gehyrdon micclum ðæs wundrodon, and be ðam ðe ða hyrdas sædon. María soðlice heold ealle ðas wórd aræfnende on hire heortan. Heo nolde widmærsian Cristes digelnesse, ac anbidode oð þæt he sylf þaða he wolde hí geopenode. Heo cuðe Godes é, and on ðæra witegena gesetnysse rædde, þæt mæden sceolde God acennan. Þa blissode heo micclum þæt heo hit beon moste. Hit wæs gewitegod þæt hé on ðære byrig Bethlehem acenned wurde, and heo ðearle wundrode þæt heo æfter ðære witegunge ðær acende. Heo gemunde hwæt sum witega cwæð, "Se oxa oncneow his hlaford, and se assa his hlafordes binne." Þa geseah heo þæt cild licgan on binne, ðær se oxa and se assa gewunelice fodan secað. Godes heah-engel Gabriel bodode Marían ðæs Hælendes to-cyme on hire innoðe, and heo geseah ða þæt his bodung unleaslice gefylled wæs. Dyllice word María heold aræfnigende on hire heortan. And þa hyr-

das gecyrdon ongear wuldrigende and herigende God, on eallum ðam ðingum ðe hí gehyrdon and gesáwon, swa swa him gesæd wæs.

Pyssera ðreora hyrda gemynd is gehæfd be eastan Bethleem áne mile, on Godes cyrcan geswutelod, þam ðe ða stowe geneosiað. We sceolon geefenlæcan þysum hyrdum, and wuldrian and hērian urne Drihten on eallum ðam ðingum þe he for ure lufe gefremode, ús to alysednysse and to ecere blisse, ðam sy wuldor and lof mid ðam Ælmihtigum Fæder, on annysse þæs Halgan Gastes, on ealra worulda woruld. Amen.

PASSIO BEATI STEPHANI, PROTOMARTYRIS

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

We rædað on ðære béc þe is geháten Actus Apostolorum, þæt ða apostolas gehádodon seofon diaconas on ðære gelaðunge þe of Iudeiscum folce to Cristes geleafan beah, æfter his ðrowunge, and áriste of deaðe, and upstige to heofenum. Þæra diacona wæs se forma Stephanus, þe we on ðisum dæge wurðiað. He wæs swiðe geleafful, and mid þam Halgum Gaste afylled. Þa oðre six wæron gecigede ðisum namum: Stephanus wæs se fyrmesta, oðer Philippus, þrida Procorus, feorða Nicanor, fifa Timotheus, sixta Parmenen, se ofoða Nicolaus. Ðas seofon hí gecuron and gesetton on ðæra apostola gesihðe, and hi ða mid gebedum and bletsungum to diaconum gehadode wurdon. Weox ða dæghwonlice Godes bodung, and wæs gemenigfylld þæt getel cristenra manna þearle on Hierusalem. Þa wearð se eadiga Stephanus mid Godes gife, and mid micelre strençðe afylled, and worhte forebeacena and micle tácsa on ðam folce. Ða astodon sume ða ungeleaffullan Iudei, and woldon mid heora gedwylde þæs eadigan martyres láre oferswiðan; ac hi ne mihton his wisdomes wiðstandan, ne ðam Halgum Gaste, ðe ðurh hine spræc. Þa setton hí lease gewitan, ðe hine forlugon, and cwædon, þæt hé tállice word spræce be Moyse and be Gode. Þæt folc wearð ða micclum astyred, and þa heafod-menn, and þa Iudeiscan boceras, and gelahton Stephanum, and tugon to heora geþeahhte; and ða leasan gewitan him on besædon, "Ne geswicð ðes man to sprecenne tallice word ongean þas halgan stowe and Godes á. We gehyrdon hine secgan þæt Crist towyrpð þas stowe, and towent ða gesetnysse ðe ús Moyses tæhte." Þa beheoldon ða hine ðe on þam geðeahhte sæton,

and gesawon his nebwlite swylce sumes engles ansyne. Ða cwæð se ealdor-biscop to ðam eadigan cyðere, "Is hit swa hí secgað?" Ða wolde se halga wer Stephanus heora ungeleaffullan heortan gerihtlæcan mid heora forðfædera gebysnunge and gemynde, and to soðfæstnysse wege mid ealre lufe gebigan. Begann ða him to recenne be ðam heahfædere Abrahame, hu se heofenlica God hine geceas him to gepoftan, and him behet, þæt ealle ðeoda on his ofspringe gebletsode wurdon, for his gehyrsumnesse. Swa eac ðæra oðra heahfædera gemynd, mid langsumere race, ætforan him geniwode; and hu Moy-ses, ðurh Godes mihte, heora foregengan ofer ða Readan Sæ wundorlice gelædde, and hú hí siððan feowertig geara on westene wæron, mid heofenlicum bigleofan dæghwonlice gereordode; and hu God hí lædde to ðam Iudeiscan earde, and ða hæðenan ðeoda ætforan heora gesihðum eallunga adwæscte; and be Dauides mærdæ, þæs mæran cyninges, and Salomones wuldre, ðe Gode þæt mære tempel arærde. Cwæð þa æt nextan, "Ge wiðstandað þam Halgum Gaste mid stiðum swuran, and ungeleaffulre heortan; ge sind meldan and manslagan, and ge ðone rihtwisan Crist niðfullice acwealdon; ge underfengon æ on engla gesetnysse, and ge hit ne heoldon." Hwæt ða Iudeiscan þa wurdon þearle on heora heortan astyrode, and biton heora teð him togeanes. Se halga Stephanus wearð þa afylled mid þam Halgum Gaste, and beheold wið heofonas weard, and geseah Godes wuldor, and þone Hælend standende æt his Fæder swiðran; and he cwæð, "Efne ic geseo heofenas opene, and mannes Sunu standende æt Godes swiðran." Iudei ða, mid micelre stemne hrymende, heoldon heora earan, and anmodlice him to scuton, and hi hine gelæhton, and of ðære byrig gelæddon to stænenne. Þa leas-gewitan ða lédon heora hacelan ætforan fotum sumes geonges cnihtes, se wæs geciged Saulus. Ongunnon ða oftorfian mid heardum stanum ðone eadigan Stephanum; and hé clypode, and cwæð, "Drihten Hælend, onfóh minne gast." And gebigde his cneowu, mid micelre stemne clypigende, "Min Drihten, ne sete ðu ðas dæda him to synne." And hé mid þam worde ða gewát to ðan Ælmihtigum Hælende, þe he on heofenan healicne standende geseah.

Se wisa Augustinus spræc ymbe ðas rædinge, and smeade hwí se halga cyðere Stephanus cwæde þæt he gesawe mannes bearn standan æt Godes swyðran, and nolde cweðan Godes bearn; þonne ðe is gepuht wurðlicor be Criste to cweðenne Godes Bearn ðonne mannes Bearn. Ac hit gedafenode þæt se Hælend swa geswutelod wære on

heofenum, and swa gebodod on middangearde. Eall ðæra Iudeiscra teona aras þurh þæt, hwí Drihten Crist, se ðe æfter flæsce soðlice is mannes Sunu, eac swilce wære gecweden Godes Sunu? forði gemunde swiðe gedafenlice þæt godcunde gewrit, mannes Sunu standan æt Godes swiðran to gescyndenne þæra Iudeiscra úngeleaffulnysse. Crist wæs æteowed his eadigan cyðere Stephane on heofenum, se ðe fram ungeleaffullum on middangearde acweald wæs, and seo heofenlice soðfæstnyss be ðam cydde gecyðnysse, þone seo eorðlice arleasnyss huxlice tælde. Hwá mæg beon rihtlice gecíged mannes Bearn, buton Criste anum, þonne ælc man is twegra manna bearn, buton him anum? Se eadiga Stephanus geseah Crist standan, forðan þe he wæs his gefylsta on ðam gastlicum gefeohte his martyrdomes. Witodlice we andettað on urum credan, þæt Drihten sitt æt his Fæder swiðran. Setl gedafenað déman, and steall fylstendum oððe feohtendum. Nu andet ure geleafa Cristes setl, forðan ðe hé is se soða déma lybbendra and deadra: and se eadiga cyðere Stephanus hína geseah standende, forðan ðe he wæs his gefylsta, swa swa we ár sædon. Ealra gecorenra halgena deað is deorwurðe on Godes gesiððe; ac ðeah-hwæðere is gepuht, gif ænig todál beon mæg betwux martyrum, þæt se is healicost se ðe ðone martyrdom æfter Gode astealde. Witodlice Stephanus wæs to diacone gehádod æt ðæra apostola handum; ac hé hí forestóp on heofenan rice mid sigefæstum deaðe; and swa se ðe wæs neoðor on endebyrdnysse, wearð fyrrest on ðrowunge; and se ðe wæs leorning-cniht on háde, ongann wesan láreow on martyrdom. ðone deað soðlice þe se Hælend gemedemode for mannum þrowian, ðone ageaf Stephanus fyrrest manna þam Hælende. He is gecweden protomartyr, þæt is se forma cyðere, forðan ðe hé æfter Cristes ðrowunge ærest martyrdom geðrowode. Stephanus is Grecisc nama, þæt is on Leden, Coronatus, þæt we cweðað on Englisc, Gewuldorbeagod; forðan ðe hé hæfð þone ecan wuldorbeah, swa swa his nama him forewítegode. Þa leasan gewitan, ðe hine forsædon, hína ongunnon ærest to torfienne; forðan þe Moyses æ tæhte, þæt swa hwá swa oðerne to deaðe forsæde, sceolde wurpan ðone forman stán to ðam ðe hé ær mid his tungan acwealde. Ða reðan Iudei wedende þone halgan stándon: and hé clypode, and cwæð, "Drihten, ne sete ðu ðas dáda him to synne."

Understandað nu, mine gebroðra, þa micclan lufe þæs eadigan weres. On deaðe hé wæs gesett, and ðeah he bæd mid soðre lufe for his cwelleras; and betwux ðæra stana hryre, ðaða gehwá mihte his le-

ofostan frynd forgytan, ða betæhte hé his fynd Gode, þus cweðende, "Drihten, ne sete þu ðas dæda him to synne." Swiðor he besorgade þa heora synna þonne his agene wunda; swiðor heora arleasnysse þonne his sylfes deað; and rihtlice swiðor, forðan ðe heora arleasnysse fyligde se eca deað, and þæt ece líf fyligde his deaðe. Saulus heold ðæra leasra gewitena reaf, and heora mod to þære stæninge geornlice tihte. Stephanus soðlice gebigedum cneowum Drihten bæd þæt hé Saulum alysde. Wearð ða Stephanes Bén fram Gode gehyred, and Saulus wearð alysed. Se árfæsta wæs gehyred, and se arleasa wearð gerihtwisod.

On ðyssere dæde is geswutelod hu micclum fremige þære soðan lufe gebed. Witodlice næfde Godes gelaðung Paulum to lareowe, gif se halga martyr Stephanus swa ne bæde. Efne nú Paulus blissað mid Stephane on heofenan rice; mid Stephane hé bricð Cristes beorhtnysse, and mid him hé rixað. Þider ðe Stephanus forestóp, mid Saules stanum oftorfod, ðider folgode Paulus gefultumod þurh Stephanes gebedu. Þær nis Paulus gescynd þurh Stephanes slege, ac Stephanus gladað on Paules gefærrædene; forðan þe seo soðe lufu on heora ægðrum blissað. Seo soðe lufu oferwann ðæra Iudeiscra reðnysse on Stephane, and seo ylce lufu oferwreah synna micelnysse on Paule, and heo on heora ægðrum samod gearnode heofenan rice. Eornostlice seo soðe lufu is wylspring and ordfruma ealra godnyssa and æðele trumnys, and se weg þe lät to heofonum. Se ðe færð on soðre lufe ne mæg hé dwelian, ne forhtian: heo gewissað, and gescylt, and gelæt. Þurh þa soðan lufe wæs þes halga martyr swa gebyld þæt he bealdlice ðæra Iudeiscra ungeleaffulnysse ðreade, and he órsorh betwux ðam greatum hagolstanum þurhwunode; and he for ðam stænendum welwillende gebæd, and þær to-eacan ða heofenlican healle cucu and gewuldorbeagod inn-ferde.

Mine gebroðra, uton geefenlæcan be sumum dæle swa miccles lareowes geleafan, and swa mæres cyðeres lufe. Uton lufian ure gebroðra on Godes gelaðunge mid swilcum mode swa swa ðes cyðere þa lufode his fynd. Beoð gemyndige hwæt seo sylfe Soðfæstnys on ðam halgan godspelle behét, and hwilc wedd us gesealde. Se Hælend cwæð, "Gif ge forgyfað þam mannum þe wið eow agyltað, þonne forgyfð eow eower Fæder eowere synna: gif ge ðonne nelað forgyfan, nele eac eower Fæder eow forgifan eowere gyltas." Ge gehyrað nu, mine gebroðra, þæt hit stent þurh Godes gyfe on urum agenum dihte hu ús bið æt Gode gedémed. He cwæð, "Gif ge forgy-

fað, eow bið forgyfen." Ne bepæce nán man hine sylfne: witodlice gif hwa furðon ænne man hatað on ðisum middangearde, swa hwæt swa he to góde gedéð, eal he hit forlyst; forðan ðe se apostol Paulus ne bið geligenod, þe cwæð, "Peah ðe ic aspende ealle mine æhta on ðearfena bigleofan, and ðeah ðe ic minne agenne lichaman to cwale gelysle, swa ðæt ic forbyrne on martyrdome; gif ic næbbe ða soðan lufe, ne fremað hit me nan ðing." Be ðan ylcan cwæð se godspellere Iohannes, "Seðe his broðor ne lufað, he wunað on deaðe." Eft hé cwæð, "Ælc ðæra þe his broðor hatað is manslaga." Ealle we sind gebroðra þe on God gelyfað, and we ealle cweðað, "Pater noster qui es in celis," þæt is, "Ure Fæder þe eart on heofonum." Ne gedyrstlæce nan man be mægðhade, butan soðre lufe. Ne truwiges nan man be ælmesdædum oððe on gebedum, butan ðære foresædan lufe; forðan ðe swa lange swa hé hylt ðone sweartan nið on his heortan, ne mæg he mid nanum ðinge þone mildheortan God gegladian. Ac gif he wille þæt him God milde sý, þonne hlyste hé gódes rædes, na of minum muðe, ac of Cristes sylfes: he cwæð, "Gif ðu offrast ðine lác to Godes weofode, and þu þær gemyndig bist þæt ðin broðor hæfð sum ðing on geard ðe, forlæt ðærrihte ða lác ætforan ðam weofode, and gang ærest to þinum breðer, and þe to him gesibsuma; and ðonne ðu eft cymst to ðam weofode, geoffra ðonne ðine lác." Gif ðu ðonne þinum cristenum breðer deredest, þonne hæfð he sum ðing on geard ðe, and þu scealt be Godes tæcunge hine gegladian, ær ðu ðine lác geoffrige. Gif ðonne se cristenas mann, þe ðin broðor is, ðe ahwar geyfelode, þæt ðu scealt miltsigende forgyfan. Ure gastlican lác sind ure gebedu, and lofsang, and husel-halgung, and gehwilce oðre lác ðe we Gode offriað, þa we sceolon mid gesibsumere heortan and broðerlicere lufe Gode betæcan. Nu cwyð sum man on geard ðas rædinge, Ne mæg ic minne feond lufian, ðone ðe ic dæghwonlice wælhreowne togeanes me geseo. Eala ðu mann, þu sceawast hwæt ðin broðor þe dyde, and þu ne sceawast hwæt ðu Gode gedydest. Ponne ðu micles swærran synna wið God gefremodest, hwí nelt ðu forgyfan ða lytlan gyltas anum menn, þæt se Ælmihtiga God þe ða micclan synna forgyfe? Nu cwyst ðu eft, Micel gedeorf bið me þæt ic minne feond lufige, and for ðone gebidde þe me hearmes cepð. Ne wiðcweðe we þæt hit micel gedeorf ne sy; ac gif hit is hefigtyme on ðyssere worulde, hit becymð to micelre mede on ðære toweardan. Witodlice þurh ðines feondes lufe þu bist Godes freond; and na þæt an þæt ðu his freond sy, ac eac swilce þu bist Godes bearn, þurh ða rædene þæt þu þinne feond lu-

fige; swa swa Crist sylf cwæð, "Lufiað eowere fynd, doð þam tela þe eow hatiað, þæt ge beon eoweres Fæder cild, seðe on heofenum is." Menigfealde earfoðnyssa and hospas wolde gehwá eaðelice forberan wið þan þæt he moste sumum rican men to bearne geteald beon, and his yrfenuma to gewitendlicum æhtum: forberað nu geðyldelice for ðam ecan wurðmynte, þæt ge Godes bearn getealde beon, and his yrfenuman on heofenlicum spedum, þæt þæt se oðer forðyldigan wolde for ateorigendlicere edwiste.

We secgað eow Godes riht; healdað gif ge willon. Gif we hit forsuwiað, ne bið us geborgen. Cristes lufu us neadað þæt we simle þa góðan tihton, þæt hí on gódnysse þurhwunion; and ða yfelan we mynegiað, þæt hí fram heora yfelnessum hrædlice gecyrron. Ne beo se rihtwisa gymeleas on his anginne, ne se yfela ortruwige ðurh his unrihtwisnysse. Ondræde se goda þæt hé fealle; hogige se yfela þæt hé astande. Se ðe yfel sy geefenlæce hé Paules gecyrrednysse; se ðe gód sy þurhwunige hé on gódnysse mid Stephane; forðan ðe ne bið nán anginn herigendlic butan godre geendunge. Ælc lof bið on ende gesungen.

Mine gebroðra, gyrstan-dæg gemedemode ure Drihten hine sylfne, þæt hé ðysne middangeard þurh soðe menniscnysse ge-neosode: nu to-dæg se æðela cempa Stephanus, fram lichamlicere wununge gewitende, sigefæst to heofenum ferde. Crist niðer-astáh, mid flæsce bewæfed; Stephanus up-astáh, þurh his blod gewuldor-beagod. Gyrstan-dæg sungon englas "Gode wuldor on heannys-sum;" nu to-dæg hí underfengon Stephanum blissigende on heora geferrædene, mid þam hé wuldrað and blissað á on ecnysse. Amen.

ASSUMPTIO SANCTI IOHANNIS APOSTOLI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Iohannes se Godspellere, Cristes dyrling, wearð on ðysum dæge to heofenan rices myrhðe, þurh Godes neosunge, genumen. He wæs Cristes moddrian sunu, and he hine lufode synderlice; na swa micclum for ðære mæglican sibbe swa for ðære clænnysse his ansundan mægðhades. He wæs on mægðháde Gode gecoren, and hé on ecnysse on ungewemmedum mægðhade þurhwunode. Hit is geræd on gewyrdelicum racum þæt hé wolde wífian, and Críst wearð to his gyftum gelaðod. Þa gelámp hit þæt æt ðam gyftum wín wearð ateorod. Se Hælend ða het þa ðenig-men afyllan six stænene fatu mid hluttrum wætere, and he mid his bletsunge þæt wæter to æðelum wine awende. Þis is þæt forme tácn ðe hé on his menniscnysse openlice geworhte. Þa wearð Iohannes swa onbryrd þurh þæt tácn, þæt hé ðærrihte his bryde on mægðhade forlét, and symle syððan Drihtne folgode, and wearð ða him inweardlice gelufod, forðan ðe he hine ætbræd þam flæsclicum lustum. Witodlice ðisum leofan leorningcnihte befæste se Hælend his modor, þaþa hé on rode hengene mancynn alysde; þæt his clæne líf ðæs clænan mædenes Marian gymde, and heo ða on hyre swyster suna ðenungum wunode.

Eft on fyrste, æfter Cristes upstige to heofonum, rixode sum wælhreow casere on Romana ríce, æfter Nerone, se wæs Domicianus gehaten, cristenra manna ehtere: se het afyllan ane cyfe mid wealendum ele, and þone mæran godspellere þæron het bescufan; ac he, ðurh Godes gescyldnysse, ungewemmed of ðam hatum bæðe eode. Eft ðaða se wæltreowa ne mihte ðæs eadigan apostoles bodunge alecgan, þa asende he hine on wræcsið to anum igeoðe þe is

Paðmas gecíged, þæt he ðær þurh hungres scearpnyssse acwæle. Ac se Ælmihtiga Hælend ne forlét to gymeleaste his gelufedan apostol, ac geswutelode him on ðam wræcsiðe þa toweardan onwrigenyssse, be ðære hé awrat ða bók ðe is gehaten Apocalipsis : and se wælhreowa Domicianus on ðam ylcan geare wearð acweald æt his witenahandum; and hí ealle anmodlice ræddon þæt ealle his gesetnyssa aydlode wæron. Þa wearð Nerua, swiðe arfæst man, to casere gecoren. Be his geðafunge gecyrde se apostol ongean mid micclum wurðmynte, seðe mid hospe to wræcsiðe asend wæs. Him urnon ongean weras and wif fægnigende, and cweðende, "Gebletsod is se ðe com on Godes naman."

Mid þam ðe se apostol Iohannes stop into ðære byrig Ephesum, þa bær man him togeanes anre wydewan líc to byrigenne; hire nama wæs Drusiana. Heo wæs swiðe gelyfed and ælmesgeorn, and þa ðearfan, ðe heo mid cystigum mode eallunga afedde, dreorige mid wópe ðam líce folgodon. Ða het se apostol ða bære settan, and cwæð, "Min Drihten, Hælend Crist! Arære ðe, Drusiana; aris, and gecyrr ham, and gearca ús gereordunge on þinum huse." Drusiana þa arás swilce of slæpe awreht, and, carfull be ðæs apostoles hæse, ham gewende.

On ðam oðrum dæge eode se apostol be ðære stræt, þa of-seah he hwær sum uðwita lædde twegen gebroðru, þe hæfdon behwyrfed eall heora yldrena gestreon on deorwurðum gymstanum, and woldon ða tocwysan on ealles þæs folces gesihðe, to wæfersyne, swylce to forsewennysse woruldlicra æhta. Hit wæs gewunelic on ðam timan þæt ða ðe woldon woruld-wisdom gecneordlice leornian, þæt hí behwyrfdon heora are on gymstanum, and ða tobræcon; oððe on sumum gyldenum wecge, and ðone on sáe awurpan; þilæs ðe seo smeaug þæra æhta hí æt þære lare hremde. Þa clypode se apostol ðone uðwitan Graton him to, and cwæð, "Dyslic bið þæt hwa woruldlice speda forhogige for manna hérunge, and beo on Godes dome geniðerod. Ydel bið se læcedom þe ne mæg ðone untruman gehælan; swa bið eac ydel seo lár ðe ne gehæld ðære sawle leahtras and unðeawas. Soðlice min lareow Crist sumne cniht ðe gewilnode þæs ecan lifes þysum wordum lærde, þæt he sceolde ealle his welan beceapian, and þæt wurð ðearfum dælan, gif hé wolde fulfremed beon, and he syððan hæfde his goldhord on heofenum, and ðær to-eacan þæt ece líf." Graton ða se uðwita him andwyrde, "Þas gymstanas synd tocwysede for ydelum gylpe, ac gif ðin lareow is soð

God, gefeg ðas bricas to ansundnysse, þæt heora wurð mæge þearfum fremian." Iohannes þa gegaderode ðæra gymstana bricas, and beseah to heofonum, þus cweðende, "Drihten Hælend, nis ðe nan ðing earfoðe; þu ge-edstaðelodest ðisne tobrocenan middangeard on þinum geleaffullum, þurh tácen þære halgan rode; ge-edstaðela nu þas deorwurðan gymstanas, ðurh ðinra engla handa, þæt ðas nytenan menn þine mihta oncnáwon, and on þe gelyfon." Hwæt, ða færlice wurdon ða gymstanas swa ansunde, þæt furðon nan tácen þære ærran tocwysednysse næs gesewen. Þa se uðwita Graton samod mid þam cnihtum feoll to Iohannes fotum, gelyfende on God. Se apostol hine fullode mid eallum his hirede, and hé ongann Godes geleafan openlice bodian. Þa twegen gebroðra, Atticus and Eugenius, sealdon heora gymstanas, and ealle heora æhta dældon wædlum, and filigdon þam apostole, and micel menigu geleaffulra him eac to geðeodde.

Þa becom se apostol æt sumum sæle to þære byrig Pergamum, þær ða foresædan cnihtas iú ær eardodon, and gesawon heora ðeowan mid godewebbe gefreatewode, and on woruldlícum wuldre scinende. Ða wurdon hí mid deofles flan þurhscotene, and dreorige on mode, þæt hí wædligende on ánum waclicum wæfelse ferdon, and heora ðeowan on woruldlícum wuldre scinende wæron. Þa undergeat se apostol ðas deoflican facn, and cwæð, "Ic geseo þæt eower mót is awend, and eower andwlita, forðan ðe ge eowre speda þearfum dældon, and mines Drihtnes lare fyligdon: gað nu forði to wuda, and heawað incre byrðene gyrda, and gebringað to me." Hí dydon be his hæse, and hé on Godes naman ða grenan gyrda gebletsode, and hí wurdon to readum golde awende. Eft cwæð se apostol Iohannes, "Gað to ðære sá-strande, and feccað me papolstanas." Hí dydon swa; and Iohannes þa on Godes mægenðrymme hí gebletsode, and hí wurdon gehwyrfede to deorwurðum gymmum. Þa cwæð se apostol, "Gað to smiððan, and fandiað þises goldes and ðissera gymstana." Hí ða eodon, and eft comon, þus cweðende, "Ealle ðas goldsmiðas secgað þæt hí næfre ær swa clæne gold, ne swa read ne gesawon: eac ðas gym-wyrhtan secgað þæt hi næfre swa deorwurðe gymstanas ne gemetton." Þa cwæð se apostol him to, "Nimað þis gold, and ðas gymstanas, and farað, and bicgað eow land-ære; forðan þe ge forluron ða heofenlican speda. Bicgað eow pællene cyrtlas, þæt ge to lytelre hwile scinon swa swa róse, þæt ge hrædlice forweornion. Beoð blowende and welige hwilwendlice, þæt ge ecelice wædlion.

Hwæt la, ne mæg se Ælmihtiga Wealdend þurhteon þæt hé do his ðeowan rice for worulde, genihtsume on welan, and unwiðmetenlice scinan? Ac he sette gecámp geleaffullum sawlum, þæt hi gelyfon to geagenne þa ecan welan, ða ðe for his naman þa hwilwendan speda forhógiað. Ge gehældon untruman on þæs Hælendes naman, ge aflugdon deoflu, ge forgeafon blindum gesihðe, and gehwilce uncoðe gehældon: efne nu is ðeos gifu eow ætbroden, and ge sind earmingas gewordene, ge ðe wæron mære and strange. Swa micel ege stod deoflum fram eow, þæt hí be eowere hæse þa ofsettan deofolseocan forleton; nu ge ondrædað eow deoflu. Þa heofenlican æhta sind us eallum gemæne. Nacode we wæron acennede, and nacode we gewitað. Pære sunnan beorhtnys, and þæs monan leoht, and ealra tungla sind gemæne þam rican and ðam heanan. Rénscuras, and cyrcan duru, fulluht, and synna forgyfenys, huselgang, and Godes neosung, sind eallum gemæne, earmum and eadigum: ac se ungesæliga gytsere wile mare habban þonne him genihtsumað, þonne he furðon orsorh ne bricð his genihtsumnysse. Se gytsere hæfð ænne lichaman, and menigfealde scrúd; he hæfð ane wambe, and þusend manna bigleofan: witodlice þæt he for gytsunge úncyste nanum oðrum syllan ne mæg, þæt he hordað, and nat hwam; swa swa se witega cwæð, 'On ídel bið ælc man gedrefed, seðe hordað, and nat hwam he hit gegaderað.' Witodlice ne bið he þæra æhta hlaford, þonne he hi dælan ne mæg; ac he bið þæra æhta ðeowa, þonne he him eallunga þeowað; and þær to-eacan him weaxað untrumnyssa on his lichaman, þæt hé ne mæg átes oððe wátes brucan. Hé carað dæges and nihtes þæt his feoh gehealden sy; hé gymð grædelice his teolunge, his gafoles, his gebytlú; he berypð þa wánnspedigan, he fulgæð his lustum and his plegan; þonne færlice gewitt he of ðisere worulde, nacod and forscyldigod, synna ana mid him ferigende; forðan þe he sceal éce wíte ðrowian."

Efne ðaða se apostol þas lare sprecende wæs, ða bær sum wuduwe hire suna lic to bebyrgenne, se hæfde gewifod þritigum nihtum ár. Seo dreorige modor þa samod mid þam licmannum rarigende hí astrehte æt þæs halgan apostoles fotum, biddende þæt he hire sunu on Godes naman arærde, swa swa he dyde þa wydewan Drusianam. Iohannes ða ofhreow þære meder and ðæra licmanna dreorignysse, and astrehte his lichaman to eorðan on langsumum gebede, and ða æt nextan arás, and eft up-ahafenum handum langlice bæd. Þaða he ðus ðriwa gedón hæfde, ða het he unwindan þæs cnihtes líc,

and cwæð, "Eala ðu cniht, ðe þurh ðines flæsces lust hrædlice ðine sawle forlure; eala þu cniht, þu ne cuðest ðinne Scyppend; þu ne cuðest manna Hælend; þu ne cuðest ðone soðan freond; and forði þu beurne on þone wyrstan feond. Nu ic ageat mine tearas, and for ðinre nytennysse geornlice bæd, þæt þu of deaðe arise, and þisum twam gebroðrum, Attico and Eugenio, cyðe hū micel wuldor hī forluron, and hwilc wite hī geearnodon." Mid ðam þa arás se cniht Stacteus, and feoll to Iohannes fotum, and begann to ðreagenne þa gebroðru þe miswende wáron, þus cweðende, "Ic geseah þa englas, þe eower gymdon, dreorige wepan, and ða awyrigedan sceoccan blissigende on eowerum forwyrde. Eow wæs heofenan rice gearo, and scinende gebytlu mid wistum afyllede, and mid ecum leohte: þa ge forluron þurh unwærscipe, and ge begeaton eow ðeosterfulle wununga mid dracum afyllede, and mid brastligendum ligum, mid unasecgendlicum witum afyllede, and mid anðræcum stencum; on ðam ne ablinð granung and þoterung dæges oppe nihtes: biddað forði mid inweardre heortan ðysne Godes apostol, eowerne lareow, þæt he eow fram ðam ecum forwyrde arære, swa swa he me fram deaðe arærde; and he eowre saula, þe nu synd adylegode of þære liflican béc, gelæde eft to Godes gife and miltsunge."

Se cniht þa Stacteus, ðe of deaðe arás, samod mid þam gebroðrum, astrehte hine to Iohannes fótswaðum, and þæt folc forð mid ealle, anmodlice biddende þæt he him to Gode geþingode. Se apostol þa bebead ðam twam gebroðrum þæt hi ðritig daga be hreowsunge dædbetende Gode geoffrodon, and on fæce geornlice bædon, þæt ða gylden an gyrda eft to þan ærran gecynde awendon, and þa gymstanas to heora wacnysse. Æfter ðritigra daga fæce, þa þa hī ne mih-ton mid heora benum þæt gold and þa gymstanas to heora gecynde awendan, ða comon hi mid wope to þam apostole, þus cweðende, "Symle ðu tæhtest mildheortnysse, and þæt man oðrum miltsode; and gif man oðrum miltsað, hu micle swiðor wile God miltsian and arian mannum his hand-geweorce! Þæt þæt we mid gitsigendum eagum agylton, þæt we nu mid wependum eagum bereowsiað." Ða andwyrde se apostol, "Berað ða gyrda to wuda, and þa stanas to sæstrande: hi synd gecyrrde to heora gecynde." Ðaða hi þis gedon hæfdon, ða underfengon hi eft Godes gife, swa þæt hi adræfdon deoflu, and blinde, and untrume gehældon, and fela tacna on Drihtnes naman gefremedon, swa swa hi ær dydon.

Se apostol þa gebigde to Gode ealne þone eard Asiam, se is geteald to healfan dæle middan-eardes; and awrat ða feorðan Cristes bók, seo hrepað swyðost ymbe Cristes godcundnysse. Ða oðre þry godspelleras, Matheus, Marcus, Lucas, awriton æror be Cristes menniscnysse. Þa asprungon gedwolmenn on Godes gelaðunge, and cwædon þæt Crist nære ær he acenned wæs of Marian. Þa bædon ealle þa leod-bisceopas ðone halgan apostol þæt he þa feorðan bók gesette, and þæra gedwolmanna dyrstignesse adwæscte. Iohannes þa beað ðreora daga fæsten gemænelic; and he æfter ðam fæstene wearð swa miclum mid Godes gaste afylled, þæt he ealle Godes englas, and ealle gesceafta, mid heahlicum mode oferstáh, and mid ðysum wordum þa godspellican gesetnysse ongan, "In principio erat uerbum, et uerbum erat apud Deum, et Deus erat uerbum, et reliqua:" þæt is on Englisc, "On frymðe wæs word, and þæt word wæs mid Gode, and þæt word wæs God; þis wæs on frymðe mid Gode; ealle ðing sind þurh hine geworhte, and nis nan þing buton him gesceapen." And swa forð on ealre þære godspellican gesetnysse, he cydde fela be Cristes godcundnysse, hu he ecelice butan angynne of his Fæder acenned is, and mid him rixað on annysse þæs Halgan Gastes, á butan ende. Feawa he awrat be his menniscnysse, forðan þe þa ðry oðre godspelleras genihtsumlice be þam heora bec setton.

Hit gelamp æt sumum sæle þæt þa deofolgyldan þe þa gýt ungeleaffulle wæron, gecwædon þæt hi woldon þone apostol to heora hæðenscipe geneadian. Þa cwæð se apostol to ðam hæðengyldum, "Gað ealle endemes to Godes cyrcan, and clypiað ealle to eowerum godum, þæt seo cyrce afealle ðurh heora mihte; ðonne buge ic to eowerum hæðenscipe. Gif ðonne eower godes miht þa halgan cyrcan towurpan ne mæg, ic towurpe eower tempel þurh ðæs Ælmihtigan Godes mihte, and ic tocwyse eower deofolgyld; and bið þonne rihtlic geðuht þæt ge geswycon eoweres gedwyldes, and gelyfon on ðone soðan God, se ðe ana is Ælmihtig." Þa hæðengyldan ðisum cwyde geðwærlæhton, and Iohannes mid geswæsum wordum þæt folc tihte, þæt hí ufor eodon fram þam deofles temple; and mid beorhtre stemne ætforan him eallum clypode, "On Godes naman ahreose þis tempel, mid eallum þam deofolgyldum þe him on eardiað, þæt þeos menigu tocnawe þæt ðis hæðengyld deofles biggeng is." Hwæt ða færlice ahreas þæt tempel grundlunga, mid eallum his anlicnyssum to duste awende. On ðam ylcan dæge wurdon gebigede twelf ðusend hæðenra manna to Cristes geleafan, and mid fulluhte gehalgode.

Ða sceorede ða gyt se yldesta hæðengylða mid mycelre þwyrnysse, and cwæð þæt he nolde gelyfan buton Iohannes attor drunce, and þurh Godes mihte ðone cwelmbæran drenc oferswiðde. Ða cwæð se apostol, "Peah þu me attor sylle, þurh Godes naman hit me ne derað." Ða cwæð se hæðengylða Aristodemus, "Ðu scealt ærest oðerne geseon drincan, and ðærrihte cwelan, þæt huru ðin heorte swa forhtige for ðam deadbærum drence." Iohannes him andwyrde, "Gif ðu on God gelyfan wylt, ic unforhtmod ðæs drences onfó." Ða getengde se Aristodemus to ðam heahgerefan, and genám on his cwearterne twegen ðeofas, and sealde him ðone unlybban ætforan eallum ðam folce, on Iohannes gesihðe; and hi ðærrihte æfter þam drence gewiton. Syððan se hæðengylða eac sealde ðone attorbæran drenc þam apostole, and hé mid rodetaene his muð, and ealne his lichaman gewæpnode, and ðone unlybban on Godes naman halsode, and siððan mid gebildum mode hine ealne gedranc. Aristodemus ða and þæt folc beheoldon þone apostol ðreo tíða dæges, and gesawon hine habban glædne andwlitan, buton blácinge and forhtunge; and hi ealle clypodon, "An soð God is, seðe Iohannes wurðað." Ða cwæð se hæðengylða to ðam apostole, "Gyt me tweonað; ac gif ðu ðas deadan sceaðan, on ðines Godes naman aræst, þonne bið min heorte geclænsod fram ælcere twynunge." Ða cwæð Iohannes, "Aristodeme, nim mine tunecan, and lege bufon ðæra deadra manna lic, and cweð, 'Pæs Hælendes Cristes apostol me asende to eow, þæt ge on his naman of deaðe arison, and ælc man oncnáwe þæt deað and líf ðeowiað minum Hælende.'" He ða be ðæs apostoles hæse bær his tunecan, and alede uppon ðam twám deadum; and hí ðærrihte ansunde arison. Ðaða se hæðengylða þæt geseah, ða astrehte he hine to Iohannes fotum, and syððan ferde to ðam heahgerefan, and him ða wundra mid hluddre stemne cydde. Hí ða begen þone apostol gesohton, his miltsunge biddende. Ða bead se apostol him seofon nihta fæsten, and hi siððan gefullode; and hi æfter ðam fulluhte towurpon eall heora deofolgyld, and mid heora maga fultume, and mid eallum cræfte arærdon Gode mære cyrcan on ðæs apostoles wurðmynte.

Ðaða se apostol wæs nigon and hund-nigontig geara, þa æteowode him Drihten Crist mid þam oðrum apostolum, þe hé of ðisum life genumen hæfde, and cwæð, "Iohannes, cum to me; tima is þæt þu mid ðinum gebroðrum wistfullige on minum gebeorscipe." Iohannes þa arás, and eode wið pæs Hælendes; ac he him to cwæð, "Nu on sunnan-dæg, mines æristes dæge, þu cymst to me:" and æfter ðam

worde Drihten gewende to heofenum. Se apostol micclum blissode on ðam beháte, and on þam sunnan-uhtan ærwacol to ðære cyrcan com, and þam folce, fram hancrede oð undern, Godes gerihta lærde, and him mæssan gesang, and cwæð þæt se Hælend hine on ðam dæge to heofonum gelaðod hæfde. Het ða delfan his byrgene wið þæt weofod, and þæt greot ut-awegan. And hé eode cucu and gesund into his byrgene, and astrehtum handum to Gode clypode, "Drihten Crist, ic þancige ðe þæt þu me gelaðodest to þinum wistum: þu wást þæt ic mid ealre heortan þe gewilnode. Oft ic ðe bæd þæt ic moste to ðe faran, ac ðu cwæde þæt ic anbidode, þæt ic ðe mare folc gestrynde. Þu heolde minne lichaman wið ælce besmittennysse, and þu simle mine sawle onlihtest, and me nahwar ne forlete. Þu settest on minum muðe þinre soðfæstnysse word, and ic awrat ða lare ðe ic of ðinum muðe gehyrde, and ða wundra ðe ic ðe wyrcan geseah. Nu ic ðe betæce, Drihten! þine bearn, ða ðe þin gelaðung, mæden and moder, þurh wæter and þone Halgan Gast, ðe gestrynde. Onfoh me to minum gebroðrum mid ðam ðe ðu come, and me gelaðodest. Geopena ongean me lifes geat, þæt ðæra ðeostra ealdras me ne gemeton. Þu eart Crist, ðæs lifigendan Godes Sunu, þu þe be ðines Fæder hæse middangeard gehældest, and us ðone Halgan Gast asendest. Þe we heriað, and þanciað þinra menigfealdra goda geond ungeendode worulde. Amen."

Æfter ðysum gebede æteowode heofenlic leoht bufon ðam apostole, binnon ðære byrgene, ane tid swa beorhte scinende, þæt nanes mannes gesihð þæs leohtes leoman sceawian ne mihte; and he mid þam leohte his gast ageaf þam Drihtne þe hine to his rice gelaðode. He gewát swa freoh fram deaðes sarnysse, of ðisum andweardan life, swa swa he wæs ælfremed fram lichamlicere gewemmednysse. Soðlice syððan wæs his byrgen gemet mid mannan afylled. Manna wæs gehaten se heofenlica mete, þe feowertig geara afedde Israhela folc on westene. Nu wæs se bigleofa gemett on Iohannes byrgene, and nan ðing elles; and se mete is weaxende on hire oð ðisne andweardan dæg. Þær beoð fela tacna æteowode, and untrume gehælde, and fram eallum frecednyssum alysed, þurh ðæs apostoles ðingunge. Þæs him getiðað Drihten Crist, þam is wuldor and wurðmynt mid Fæder and Halgum Gaste, á butan ende. Amen.

NATALE INNOCENTIIUM INFANTUM

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Nu to-dæg Godes gelaðung geond ealne ymbhwyrft mærsað þæra eadigra cildra freols-tide, þe se wælhreowa Herodes for Cristes acennednysse mid arleasre ehtnysse acwealde, swa swa us seo god-spellice racu swutellice cyð.

Matheus awrat, on þære forman Cristes bec, ðysum wordum be ðæs Hælendes gebyrd-tide, and cwæð, "Þaða se Hælend acenned wæs on þære Iudeiscan Bethleem, on Herodes dagum cyninges, efne ða comon fram east-dæle middangeardes þry tungel-witegan to ðære byrig Hierusalem, þus befrinende, Hwær is Iudeiscra leoda Cyning, seðe acenned is? We gesawon soðlice his steorran on east-dæle, and we comon to ði þæt we ús to him gebiddon. Hwæt ða Herodes cyn-ing þis gehyrende wearð micclum astyred, and eal seo burhwaru samod mid him. He ða gesamnode ealle þa ealdor-biscopas, and ðæs folces boceras, and befran hwær Cristes cennungstów wære. Hí sædon, on ðære Iudeiscan Bethleem. Þus soðlice is awriten þurh ðone witegan Micheam, Eala þu Bethleem, Iudeisc land, ne eart ðu natesh-wón wacost burga on Iudeiscum ealdrum: of ðe cymð se Heretoga seðe gewylt and gewissað Israhela folc. Ða clypode Herodes þa ðry tungel-witegan on sunder-spræce, and geornlice hí befrán to hwilces timan se steorra him ærst æteowode, and asende hí to Bethleem, ðus cweðende, Farað ardlice, and befrinað be ðam cilde, and þonne ge hit gemetað, cyðað me, þæt ic máge me to him gebiddan. Þa tungel-witegan ferdon æfter þæs cyninges spræce, and efne ða se steorra, þe hí on east-dæle gesawon, glad him beforan, oð þæt he gestód bu-fon ðam gesthúse, þær þæt cild on wunode. Hi gesáwon ðone steor-

ran, and þearle blissodon. Eodon ða inn, and þæt cild gemetton mid Marian his meder, and niðerfeallende hí to him gebádon. Hi geopenodon heora hórdfatu, and him lác geoffrodon, gold, and recels, and myrram. Hwæt ða God on swefne hí gewarnode and bebead þæt hi eft ne cyrdon to ðan reðan cyninge Herode, ac þurh oðerne weg hine forcyrdon, and swa to heora eðele becomon. Efne ða Godes engel æteowode Iosepe, ðæs cildes foster-fæder, on swefnum, cweðende, 'Arís, and nim þis cild mid þære meder, and fleoh to Egypta lánðe, and beo þær oð þæt ic þe eft secge: soðlice toward is þæt Herodes smeað hú hé þæt cild fordó.' Ioseph ða arás nihtes, and þæt cild mid þære meder samod to Egypta lánðe ferede, and þær wunode oð þæt Herodes gewát; þæt seo witegung wære gefylled, þe be ðære fare ær ðus cwæð, Of Egypta lánðe ic geclypode minne sunu."

Nu secgað wyrd-writeras þæt Herodes betwux ðisum wearð gewréged to þam Romaniscan casere, þe ealne middangeard on þam timan geweold. Þa gewende he to Rome, be ðæs caseres hæse, þæt he hine betealde, gif he mihte. Þa betealde he hine swiðe geaplice, swa swa he wæs snotorwyrde to ðan swiðe, þæt se casere hine mid maran wurðmynte ongean to Iudeiscum rice asende. Þa þa he ham com, þa gemunde he hwæt he ær be ðan cilde gemynte, and geseah þæt he wæs bepæht fram ðam tungel-witegum, and wearð þa ðearle gegremod. Sende ða his cwelleras, and ofsloh ealle ða hyse-cild, þe wæron on þære byrig Bethleem, and on eallum hyre gemærum, fram twywintrum cilde to anre nihte, be ðære tide þe hé geaxode æt ðam tungel-witegum. Þa wæs gefylled Hieremias witegung, þe ðus witegode, "Stemn is gehyred on heannysse, micel wóp and ðoterung: Rachel beweop hire cildru, and nolde beon gefrefrod, forðan ðe hi ne sind."

On ðam twelftan dæge Cristes acennednysse comon ða ðry tungel-witegan to Herode, and hine axodon be ðam acennedan cilde; and þa þa hí his cennung-stowe geaxodon, þa gewendon hí wið þæs cildes, and noldon ðone reðan cwellere eft gecyrran, swa swa he het. Þa ne mihte he forbugan þæs caseres hæse, and wæs ða, þurh his langsume fær, þæra cildra slege geuferod swiðor þonne he gemynt hæfde; and hí wurdon ða on ðysum dægþerlicum dæge wuldorfullice gemartyrode; na swa-þeah þæs gearas þe Crist acenned wæs, ac æfter twegra geara ymbryne æfter ðæs wælhreowan hamcyme.

Næs hé æðelboren, ne him naht to þam cynecynne ne gebyrode; ac mid syrewungum and swicdome he becom to ðære cynelican

geðincðe; swa swa Moyses be ðam awrát, þæt ne sceolde ateorian þæt Iudeisce cynecynn, oþþæt Crist sylf come. Ða com Crist on ðam timan þe seo cynelice mæigð ateorode, and se ælfremeda Herodes þæs rices geweold. Ða wearð he micclum afyrht and anðracode þæt his rice feallan sceolde, þurh to-cyme þæs soðan cyninges. Ða clypode hé ða tungel-witegan on sunder-spræce, and geornlice hí be-frán, on hwilcne timan hí ærest þone steorran gesawon; forðan ðe he ondred, swa swa hit gelamp, þæt hí eft hine ne gecyrdon. Ða het he forðy acwellan ealle ða hyse-cild þære burhscire, fram twywintrum cilde oð anre nihte: ðohte gif he hí ealle ofsloge, þæt se án ne ætburste þe he sohte. Ac he wæs ungemyndig þæs halgan gewrites, ðe cwyð, "Nis nán wisdom, ne nán ræd naht ongean God."

Se swicola Herodes cwæð to ðam tungel-witegum, "Farað, and geornlice befrinað be ðam cilde, and cyðað me, þæt ic eac mage me to him gebiddan." Ac he cydde syððan his facenfullan syrewunge, hu he ymbe wolde, gif he hine gemette, ðaða he ealle his efenealdan adylegode for his anes ehtnysse. Þearflæs he syrwe ymbe Crist: ne com he forðy þæt he wolde his eorðlice rice, oþþe æniges oðres cyninges mid riccetere him to geteon; ac to ði hé com þæt he wolde his heofenlice rice geleaffullum mannum forgyfan. Ne com he to ðy þæt he wære on mærlicum cynesetle ahafen, ac þæt he wære mid hospe on rode hengene genæglod. He wolde ðeah þæs wælhreowan syrewunge mid fleame forbugan, na forði þæt he deað forfluge, seðe sylfwilles to ðrowienne middangearde genealæhte; ac hit wære to hrædlic, gif he ða on cild-cradole acweald wurde, swilce ðonne his to-cyme mancynne bedíglod wære; þi forhradode Godes engel þæs arleasan geþeaht, and beþead þæt se foster-fæder þone heofenlican æþeling of ðam earde ardlice ferede.

Ne forseah Crist his geongan ceman, ðeah ðe he lichamlice on heora slege andwerd nære; ac hé asende hí fram þisum wræcfullum life to his ecan rice. Gesælige hí wurdon geborene þæt hi moston for his intingan deað þrowian. Eadig is heora yld, seoðe þa gyt ne mihte Crist andettan, and moste for Criste þrowian. Hí wæron þæs Hælendes gewitan, ðeah ðe hí hine ða gyt ne cuðon. Næron hí gerípode to slege, ac hi gesæliglice þeah swulton to life. Gesælig wæs heora acennednys, forðan ðe hí gemetton þæt ece lif on instæpe þæs andweardan lifes. Hí wurdon gegripene fram moderlicum breostum, ac hi wurdon betæhte þærrihte engellicum bosmum. Ne mihte se mánfulla ehtere mid nanre ðenunge þam lytlingum

swa micclum fremian, swa micclum swa hé him fremode mid ðære reðan ehthnysse hatunge. Hí sind gehátene martyra blostman, forðan ðe hí wæron swá swá up-aspringende blostman on middeweardan cyle ungeleaffulnysse, swilce mid sumere ehthnysse forste forsodene. Eadige sind þa innoðas þe hí gebæron, and ða breost þe swylce gesihton. Witodlice ða modдру on heora cildra martyrdome þrowodon; þæt swurd ðe þæra cildra lima þurh-árn becóm to ðæra moddra heortan; and neod is þæt hí beon efenhlyttan þæs ecan edleanes, þonne hí wæron geferan ðære ðrowunge. Hí wæron gehwæde and ungewitige acwealde, ac hí arisað on þam gemænelicum dome mid fullum wæstmē, and heofenlicere snoternysse. Ealle we cumað to anre ylde on þam gemænelicum æriste, þeah ðe we nu on myslicere ylde of þyssere worulde gewiton.

Þæt godspel cweð þæt Rachel beweóp hire cildra, and nolde beon gefrefrod, forðan þe hí ne sind. Rachel hatte Iacobes wif, ðæs heahfæderes, and heo getacnode Godes gelaðunge, þe bewypð hire gastlican cild; ac heo nele swa beon gefrefrod, þæt hí eft to woruldlicum gecampe gehwyrfon, þa þe æne mid sygefæstum deaðe middangeard oferswiðdon, and his yrmða ætwundon to wuldorbeagienne mid Criste.

Eornostlice ne breac se arleasa Herodes his cynerices mid langsumere gesundfulnysse, ac buton yldinge him becom seo godcundlice wracu, þe hine mid menigfealdre yrmðe fordyde, and eac geswutelode on hwilcum suslum he moste æfter forðsiðe ecelice cwymlian. Hine gelæhte unasecgendlic adl; his lichama barn wiðutan mid langsumere hætān, and he eal innan samod forswæled wæs, and toborsten. Him wæs metes micel lust, ac ðeah mid nanum ætum his gyferynysse gefyllan ne mihte. He hriðode, and egeslice hweos, and angsumlice siccetunga teah, swa þæt hé earfoðlice orðian mihte. Wæter-seocnyss hine ofereode, beneoðan þam gyrdle, to ðan swiðe, þæt his gesceapu maðan weollon, and stincende attor singallice of ðam toswollenum fotum fleow. Unaberendlic gyhða ofereode ealne ðone lichaman, and ungelyfendlic toblawennys his innoð geswencte. Him stód stincende steam of ðam muðe, swa þæt earfoðlice ænig læce him mihte genealæcan. Fela ðæra læca hé acwealde; cwæð þæt hí hine gehælan mihton and noldon. Hine gedrehte singal slæpleast, swa þæt he þurhwacole niht buton slæpe adreah; and gif hé hwon hnáppode, ðærrihte hine drehton nihtlice gedwímor, swa þæt him ðæs slæpes ofþuhte. Paða hé mid swiðlicum luste his lifes gewilnode,

þa hét hé hine ferigan ofer ða eá Iordanen, ðærþær wæron gehæfde háte baðu, þe wæron halwende gecwedene adligendum lichaman. Wearð þa eac his læcum geðuht þæt hí on wlacum ele hine gebeðedon. Ac ðaða hé wæs on ðissere beðunge geléd, þa wearð se lichama eal toslopen, swa þæt his eagan wendon on gelicnysse sweltendra manna, and hé læg cwydeleas butan andgite. Eft ðaða he com, þa het he hine ferigan to ðære byrig Hiericho.

Þaþa he wearð his lifes orwene, þa gelaðode he him to ealle ða Iudeiscan ealdras of gehwilcum burgum, and het hí on cwearterne beclysan, and gelangode him to his swustur Salome and hire wer Alexandrum, and cwæð, "Ic wát þæt ðis Iudeisce folc micclum blisigan wile mines deaðes; ac ic mæg habban arwurðfulle líc-ðenunge of heofigendre menigu, gif ge willað minum bebodum gehyrsumian. Swa ricene swa ic gewíte, ofsleað ealle ðas Iudeiscan ealdras, ðe ic on cwearterne beclysde, þonne beoð heora siblingas to heofunge geneadode, þa ðe wyllað mines forðsiðes fagnian." He ða his cempa to ðam slege genamode, and het heora ælcum fiftig scyllinga to sceatte syllan, þæt hi heora handa fram ðam blodes gyte ne wiðbrudon. Þaða hé mid ormætre angsumnysse wæs gecwylmed, þa het he his agenne sunu Antípatrem arleaslice acwellan, to-eacan þam twam þe hé ær acwealde. Æt nextan, ðaða hé gefredde his deaðes nealæcunge, þa het he him his seax aræcan to screadigenne ænne æppel, and hine sylfne hetelice ðyde, þæt him on acwehte. Pyllic wæs Herodes forðsið, þe mánfullice ymbe þæs heofenlican æpelinges to-cyme syrwe, and his efen-ealdan lytlingas unscaððige arleaslice acwealde.

Efne ða Godes engel, æfter Herodes deaðe, æteowode Iosepe on swefnum, on Egypta lande, þus cweðende, "Arís, and nim þæt cild and his moder samod, and gewend ongear to Israhela lande; soðlice hí sind forðfarene, ðaðe ymbe þæs cildes feorh syrwdon." Hé ða arás, swa swa se engel him bebead, and feroðe þæt cild mid þære meder to Israhela lande. Þa gefrán Ioseph þæt Archelaus rixode on Iudea lande, æfter his fæder Herode, and ne dorste his neawiste genealæcan. Þa wearð he eft on swefne gemynegod þæt he to Galilea gewende, forðan ðe se eard næs ealles swa gehende þam cyninge, þeah ðe hit his rice wære. Þæt cild ða eardode on þære byrig þe is gehaten Nazareth, þæt seo wítegung wære gefylled, þe cwæð, þæt he sceolde beon Nazarenisc geciged. Se engel cwæð to Iosepe, "Þa sind forðfarene, þe embe ðæs cildes feorh syrwdon." Mid þam worde he geswutelode þæt má ðæra Iudeiscra ealdra embe Cristes cwale

smeadon; ac him getimode swiðe rihtlice þæt hī mid heora arleasan hlaforde ealle forwurdon.

Nelle we ðas race na leng teon, þylæs ðe hit eow æðryt þince; ac biddað eow þingunge æt þysum unscæððigum martyrum. Hi sind ða ðe Criste folgiað on hwitum gyrlum, swa hwider swa hé gæð; and hī standað ætforan his ðrymsetle, butan ælcere gewemmednysse, hæbbende heora palmtwigu on handa, and singað þone niwan lof-sang, þam Ælmihtigan to wurðmynte, seþe leofað and rixað á butan ende. Amen.

OCTABAS ET CIRCUMCISIO DOMINI NOSTRI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Se Godspellere Lucas beleac þis dægþerlice godspel mid feawum wordum, ac hit is mid menigfealdre mihte þære heofenlican gerynu afylled. He cwæð, "Postquam consummati sunt dies octo ut circumcideretur puer, uocatum est nomen ejus Iesus, quod uocatum est ab angelo, priusquam in utero conciperetur." Þæt is on ure geðeode, "Æfter þan ðe wæron gefyllede ehta dagas Drihtnes acennednyse þæt he ymbsniden wære, þa wæs his nama geciged Iesus, þæt is Hælend, ðam naman he wæs geháten fram ðam engle, ærðam þe hé on innoðe geeacnod wære."

Abraham se heahfæder wæs ærest manna ymbsniden, be Godes hæse. Abraham wæs Godes gespreca, and God to him genam gepoftrædene æfter Noes flóde swiðost, and him to cwæð, "Ic eom Ælmihtig Drihten, gang beforan me, and beo fulfremed. And ic sette min wed betwux me and ðe; and ic ðe þearle gemenigfylde, and þu bist manegra þeoda fæder. Cyningas aspringað of ðe, and ic sette min wed betwux me and ðe, and þinum ofspringe æfter ðe, þæt ic beo ðin God and ðines ofspringes." Abraham hine astrehte eallum limum to eorðan, and God him to cwæð, "Heald þu min wed, and þin ofspring æfter ðe on heora mægðum. Ðis is min wed, þæt ge healðan sceolon betwux me and eow; þæt ælc hyse-cild on eowrum cynrene beo ymbsniden: þæt tácn sy betwux me and eow. Ælc hyse-cild, þonne hit eahta nihta eald bið, sy ymbsniden, ægðer ge æpelboren ge þeowetling; and seðe þis forgæið his sawul losað, forðan þe hé

min wed aýdlode. Ne beo ðu geciged heonon-forð Abram, ac Abraham, forðan þe ic gesette ðe manegra þeoda fæder. Ne ðin wif ne beo gehaten Saraí, ac beo gehaten Sarra; and ic hí gebletsige, and of hire ic ðe sylle sunu, þone ðu gecigest Isaac; and ic sette min wed to him and to his ofsprunge on ecere fæstnunge. And æfter ðære spræce se Ælmihtiga up gewende." On þam ylcan dæge wæs Abraham ymbsniden, and eal his hyred, and syððan his sunu Isaac, on ðam eahtoðan dæge his acennednysse.

Abrahames nama wæs æt fruman mid fif stafum gecweden, Abram, þæt is, 'Healic fæder'; ac God geyhte his naman mid twam stafum, and gehet hine Abraham, þæt is, 'Manegra ðeoda fæder'; forðan þe God cwæð, þæt he hine gesette manegum ðeodum to fæder. Saraí wæs his wif gehaten, þæt is gereht, 'Min ealdor,' ac God hi het syððan Sarra, þæt is, 'Ealdor,' þæt heo nære synderlice hire hiredes ealdor geciged, ac forðrihte 'Ealdor'; þæt is to understandenne ealra gelyfedra wifa moder. Hund-teontig geara wæs Abraham, and his gebedda hund-nigontig, ærðan ðe him cild gemæne wære. Þaða him cild com, þa com hit mid Godes foresceawunge and bletsunge to þan swiðe, þæt God behet eallum mancynne bletsunge þurh his cynn. Ða heold Abrahames cynn symle syððan Godes wed; and se heretoga Moyses, and eal Israhela mægð ealle hi ymbsnidon heora cild on þam eahtoðan dæge, and him naman gesceopon, oð þæt Crist on menniscnysse acenned wearð, seðe fulluht astealde, and ðære ealdan æ getacnunge to gastlicere soðfæstnysse awende.

Wén is þæt eower sum nyte hwæt sy ymbsnidennys. God bebead Abrahame, þæt he sceolde and his ofspring his wed healdan; þæt sum tacn wære on heora lichaman to geswutelunge þæt hi on God belýfdon, and het þæt he náme scarepcedne flint, and forcurfe sumne dæl þæs felles æt foreweardan his gesceape. And þæt tacn wæs ða swa micel on geleaffullum mannum, swa micel swa nu is þæt halige fulluht, buton ðam anum þæt nan man ne mihte Godes rice gefaran, ærðan þe se come þe ða ealdan æ sette, and eft on his andwerdnysse hí to gastlicum þingum awende: ac gehwylce halgan andbidodon on Abrahames wununge buton tintregum, þeah on helle-wite, oðþæt se Alysend com, þe ðone ealdan deofol gewylde, and his gecorenan to heofenan rice gelædde.

Se ylca Hælend, þe nu egefullice and halwendlice clypað on his godspelle, "Buton gehwa beo ge-edcenned of wætere and of þam

Halgum Gaste, ne mæg he faran into heofenan rice," se ylca clypode gefyrn þurh ða ealdan æ, "Swa hwylc hyse-cild swa ne bið ymb-sniden on þam fylmene his flæscs his sawul losað, forðan þe he ayd-lode min wed." Þis tacen stód on Godes folce oð þæt Crist sylf com, and he sylf wæs þære halgan æ underpeod þe he gesette, þæt he ða alysde þe neadwislice ðære æ underpeodde wæron. He cwæð þæt he ne côme to ðy þæt he wolde þa ealdan æ towurpan, ac gefyllan. Þa wearð he on þam eahtoðan dæge his gebyrd-tide lichamlice ymb-sniden, swa swa he sylf ær tæhte; and mid þam geswutelode þæt seo ealde æ wæs halig and gód on hire timan, þam ðe hire gehyrsume wæron. Hit wæs gewunelic þæt þa magas sceoldon þam cilde naman gescyppan on ðam eahtoðan dæge mid þære ymb-snidennysse, ac hí ne dorston nænne oðerne naman Criste gescyppan þonne se heah-engel him gesette, ærðan þe hé on his modor innoðe geeacnod wære, þæt is, Iesus, and on urum gereorde, Hælend, forðan ðe he gehæld his folc fram heora synnum.

Nis nu alyfed cristenum mannum þæt hi þas ymb-snidennysse lichamlice healdan, ac þeah-hwæðere nan man ne bið soðlice cristen, buton he ða ymb-snidennysse on gastlicum ðeawum gehealde. Hwæt getacnað þæs fylmenes of-cyrf on ðam gesceape, buton galnysse wanunge? Eaðe mihte þes cwyde beon læwedum mannum be-diglod, nære seo gastlice getacning. Hit ðincð ungelæredum man-num dyselig to gehyrenne; ac gif hit him dyslic þince, þonne cide he wið God, þe hit gesette, na wið us, þe hit secgað. Ac wite gehwa to gewissan, buton he his flæsclican lustas and galnysse gewanige, þæt he ne hylt his cristendóm mid rihtum biggenge. Be ðysum ðinge ge habbað oft gehyred, ac us is acumendlicere eower gebelþ, þonne þæs Ælmihtigan Godes grama, gif we his bebodu forsuwiað. Gif ge willað æfter menniscum gesceade lybban, þonne sind ge gastlice ymb-snidene; gif ge þonne eowere galnysse underpeodde beoð, þonne beo ge swa se witega cwæð, "Se mann ðaða he on wurðmynte wæs he hit ne understod; he is forðy wiðmeten stuntum nytenum, and is him gelíc geworden."

Forðy sealde God mannum gesceád, þæt hi sceoldon oncnawan heora Scyppend, and mid biggenge his beboda þæt ece lif geearnian. Witodlice se fyrenfulla bið earmra ðonne ænig nyten, forðan þe þæt nyten næfð nane sawle, ne næfre ne ge-educað, ne þa toweardan wita ne ðrowað. Ac we ðe sind to Godes anlicnysse gesceapene, and habbað únateorigendlice saule, we sceolon of deaðe arísan, and agyl-

dan Gode gescead ealra ura geðohta, and worda, and weorca. Ne sceole we forðy sinderlice on anum lime beon ymbsnidene, ac we sceolon ða fulan galnysse symle wanian, and ure eagan fram yfelre gesihðe awendan, and earan from yfelre heorcununge; urne múð fram leasum spræcum, handa fram mándædum; ure fotwylmas fram deadbærum siðfæte, ure heortan fram facne. Gif we swa fram leahtrum ymbsnidene beoð, þonne bið ús geset níwe nama; swa swa se wítega Isaías cwæð, "God gecígð his ðeowan oðrum naman." Eft se ylca wítega cwæð, "Þu bist gecígged niwum naman, þone ðe Godes múð genemnode." Se níwa nama is 'Cristianus,' þæt is, Cristen. Ealle we sind of Criste cristene gehátene, ac we sceolon ðone arwurðfullan naman mid æðelum þeawum geglengan, þæt we ne beon lease cristene. Gif we ðas gastlican ymbsnidennysse on urum ðeawum healdað, þonne sind we Abrahames cynnes, æfter soðum geleafan; swa swa se þeoda lareow Paulus cwæð to geleaffullum, "Gif ge sind Cristes, þonne sind ge Abrahames sáed, and æfter behate yrfenuman." Petrus eac se apostol tihte geleaffulle wíf to eadmodnysse and gemetfæstnysse, ðus cweðende, "Swa swa Sarra gehyrsumode Abrahame, and hine hlaford het, ðære dohtra ge sind, wel donde and na ondrædende ænige gedrefednysse."

Se eahtoða dæg, þe þæt cild on ymbsniden wæs, getacnode ða eahtoðan ylde ðyssere worulde, on þære we arisað of deaðe ascyrede fram ælcere brosnunge and gewemmednysse ures lichaman. Þæt stænene sex, þe þæt cild ymbsnað, getacnode ðone stán ðe se apostol cwæð, "Se stán soðlice wæs Crist." He cwæð wæs for ðære getacnunge, na for edwiste. Þurh Cristes geleafan, and hiht, and soðe lufe, beoð singallice estfulle heortan mid dæghwonlicere ymbsnidenysse afeormode fram leahtrum, and ðurh his gife onlihte.

We habbað oft gehyred þæt men hatað þysne dæg geares dæg, swylce þes dæg fyrrest sy on geares ymbryne; ac we ne gemetað nane geswutelunge on cristenum bocum, hwi þes dæg to geares anginne geteald sy. Þa ealdan Romani, on hæðenum dagum, ongunnon þæs geares ymbryne on ðysum dæge; and ða Ebreiscan leoda on lenctenlicere emnihte; ða Greciscan on sumerlicum sunstede; and þa Egyptiscan ðeoda ongunnon heora geares getel on hærfeste. Nu onginð ure gerím, æfter Romaniscre gesetnysse, on ðysum dæge, for nanum godcundlicum gesceade, ac for ðam ealdan gewunan. Sume ure ðening-béc onginnað on Aduentum Domini; nis ðeah þær forðy ðæs geares ord, ne eac on ðisum dæge nis mid nánum gesceade; þeah

ðe ure gerím-béc on þissere stówe ge-edlæcon. Rihtlicost bið geðuht þæt þæs geares anginn on ðam dæge sy gehæfd, þe se Ælmihtiga Scyppend sunnan, and mónan, and steorran, and ealra tida anginn gesette; þæt is on þam dæge þe þæt Ebreisce folc heora geares getel onginnað; swa swa se heretoga Moyses on ðam ælicum bocum awrát. Witodlice God cwæð to Moysen be ðam monðe, "Þes monað is monða anginn, and he bið fyrrest on geares monðum." Nu heold þæt Ebreisce folc ðone forman geares dæg on lenctenlicere emnihte, forðan ðe on ðam dæge wurdon gearlice tida gesette.

Se eahteteoða dæg þæs monðes þe we hatað Martius, ðone ge hatað Hlyda, wæs se forma dæg ðyssere worulde. On ðam dæge worhte God leoht, and merigen, and æfen. Ða eódon þry dagas forð buton tida gemetum; forðan þe tunglan næron gesceapene, ær on þam feorðan dæge. On ðam feorðan dæge gesette se Ælmihtiga ealle tungla and gearlice tida, and hét þæt hí wæron to tícne dagum and gearum. Nu ongynnað þa Ebreiscan heora geares anginn on þam dæge þe ealle tida gesette wæron, þæt is on ðam feorðan dæge woruldlicere gesceapenyse; and se lareow Beda telð mid micclum gesceade þæt se dæg is XII. K L, ðone dæg we freolsiað þam halgum were Benedick to wurðmynte, for his micclum geðincðum. Hwæt eac seo eorðe cyð mid hire ciðum, þe ðonne ge-edcuciað, þæt se tima is þæt rihtlicoste geares anginn, ðe hí on gesceapene wæron.

Nu wígliað stunte men menigfealde wígelunga on ðisum dæge, mid micclum gedwylde, æfter hæðenum gewunan, ongear heora cristendom, swylce hí magon heora líf gelengan, oþþe heora gesundfulnyse, mid þam ðe hí gremiað þone Ælmihtigan Scyppend. Sind eac manega mid swa micclum gedwylde befangene, þæt hí cepað be ðam monan heora fær, and heora dæda be dagum, and nellað heora ðing wanian on monan-dæg, for anginne ðære wucan; ac se monan-dæg nis na fyrrest daga on þære wucan, ac is se oðer. Se sunnan-dæg is fyrrest on gesceapenyse and on endebyrdnyse, and on wurðmynte. Secgað eac sume gedwæsmenn þæt sum orfcyn sy þe man bletsigan ne sceole, and cweðað þæt hí þurh bletsunge misfarað, and ðurh wyrigunge geðeoð, and brucað þonne Godes gife him on teonan, buton bletsunge, mid deofles awyrigednyse. Ælc bletsung is of Gode, and wyrigung of deofle. God gesceop ealle gesceafta, and deofol nane gesceafta scyppan ne mæg, ac he is yfel tihtend, and leas wyrcend, synna ordfruma, and sawla bepæcend.

Þa gesceafta ðe sind þwyrlice geðuhte, hī sind to wrace gesceapene yfel-dædum. Oft halige men wunedon on westene betwux reðum wulfum and leonum, betwux eallum deorcynne and wurmcynne, and him nan ðing derian ne mihte; ac hī totæron þa hyrnegan næddran mid heora nacedum handum, and þa micclan dracan eaðelice acwealdon, buton ælcere dare, þurh Godes mihte.

Wa ðam men þe brícð Godes gesceafta, buton his bletsunge, mid deofellicum wíglungum, þonne se ðeoda lareow cwæð, Paulus, "Swa hwæt swa ge doð on worde, oððe on weorce, doð symle on Drihtnes naman, þancigende þam Ælmihtigan Fæder þurh his Bearn." Nis þæs mannes cristendom naht, þe mid deoflicum wíglungum his líf adrihð; he is gehíwod to cristenum men, and is earm hæðengylða; swa swa se ylca apostol be swylcum cwæð, "Ic wene þæt ic swunce on ydel, ðaða ic eow to Gode gebigde: nu ge cepað dagas and monðas mid ydelum wíglungum."

Is hwæðere æfter gecynde on gesceapennysse ælc lichamlice gesceaft ðe eorðe acenð fulre and mægenfæstre on fullum monan þonne on gewanedum. Swa eac treowa, gif hī beoð on fullum monan geheawene, hī beoð heardran and langfærran to getimbrunge, and swiðost, gif hī beoð unsæpige geworhte. Nis ðis nan wíglung, ac is gecyndelic ðincg þurh gesceapennysse. Hwæt eac seo sá wunderlice geþwærlæcð þæs monan ymbrene; symle hī beoð geferan on wæstmæ and on wanunge. And swa swa se mona dæghwonlice feower pricon lator arist, swa eac seo sá symle feower pricum lator fleowð.

Uton besettan urne hiht and ure gesælða on þæs Ælmihtigan Scyppendes foresceawunge, seðe ealle gesceafta on ðrim ðingum gesette, þæt is on gemete, and on getele, and on hefe. Sy him wuldor and lof á on ecnysse. Amen.

EPIPHANIA DOMINI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Men ða leofostan, nu for feawum dagum we oferræddon þis godspel ætforan eow, þe belimpð to ðysses dæges ðenunge, for gereccednysse ðære godspellican endebyrdnysse; ac we ne hrepodon þone traht na swiðor þonne to ðæs dæges wurðmynte belámp: nu wille we eft oferyrnan þa ylcan godspellican endebyrdnysse, and be ðyssere andweardan freolstíde trahtnian.

Matheus se Godspellere cwæð, "Cum natus esset Iesus in Bethleem Iudæ, in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente uenerunt Hierosolimam, dicentes, Ubi est qui natus est Rex Iudeorum?" et reliqua. "Þaða se Hælend acenned wæs on þære Iudeiscan Bethleem, on Herodes dagum cyninges, efne ða comon fram east-dæle middangeardes ðry tungel-witegan to ðære byrig Hierusalem, þus befrínende, Hwær is Iudeiscra leoda Cyning, seðe acenned is?" etc.

Ðes dæg is gehaten Epiphania Domini, þæt is Godes geswutelungdæg. On þysum dæge Crist wæs geswutelod þam ðrym cyningum, ðe fram east-dæle middangeardes hine mid þrimfealdum lacum gesohton. Eft embe geara ymbrynum hé wearð on his fulluhte on þysum dæge middangearde geswutelod, ðaða se Halga Gást, on culfran híwe, uppon him gereste, and þæs Fæder stemn of heofenum hlúde swegde, þus cweðende, "Þes is min leofa Sunu, þe me wél licað; gehyrað him." Eac on ðisum dæge he awende wæter to æðelum wine, and mid þam geswutelode þæt he is se soða Scyppend, þe ða gesceafta awendan mihte. For ðisum þrym ðingum is ðes freolsdæg Godes swutelung gecweden. On ðam forman dæge his gebyrd-tide he wearð æteowed þrym hyrdum on Iudeiscum earde, þurh ðæs engles bodunge. On ðam ylcum dæge he wearð gecydd þam ðrym tungel-witegum on east-dæle, þurh ðone beorhtan steorran; ac on þysum dæge hí comon mid heora lacum. Hit wæs gedafenlic þæt

se gesceadwisa engel hine cydde þam gesceadwisum Iudeiscum, ðe Godes æ cuðon, and ðam haðenum, þe ðæs godcundan gesceades nyston na ðurh stemne, ac ðurh tacn wære geswutelod.

Þa Iudeiscan hyrdas getácnodon ða gastlican hyrdas, þæt sind ða apostolas, þe Crist geceas of Iudeiscum folce, ús to hyrdum and to lareowum. Ða tungel-witegan, ðe wæron on hæðenscipe wunigende, hæfdon getacnunge ealles hæðenes folces, ðe wurdon to Gode gebígede þurh ðæra apostola láre, þe wæron Iudeiscre ðeode. Soðlice se sealm-sceop awrát be Criste, þæt hé is se hyrnstan þe gefegð þa twegen weallas togædere, forðan ðe he geþeodde his gecorenan of Iudeiscum folce and þa geleaffullan of hæðenum, swilce twegen wagas to anre gelaðunge; be ðam cwæð Paulus se apostol, "Se Hælend bodade on his to-cyme sibbe us ðe feorran wæron, and sibbe þam ðe gehende wæron. He is ure sibb, seðe dyde ægðer to anum, towurpende ða ærran feondscipas on him sylfum." Þa Iudeiscan ðe on Crist gelyfdon wæron him gehéndor stówlíce, and eac ðurh cyððe þære ealdan æ: we wæron swiðe fyrlyne, ægðer ge stówlíce ge ðurh uncýððe; ac he us gegaderode mid anum geleafan to ðam healicum hyrn-stane, þæt is to annysse his gelaðunge.

Ða easternan tungel-witegan gesáwon níwne steorran beorhtne, na on heofenum betwux oðrum tunglum, ac wæs ángenga betwux heofenum and eorðan. Ða undergeaton hí þæt se seldcuða tungel gebicnode þæs soðan Cyninges acennednysse, on ðam earde ðe he oferglád; and forði comon to Iudea rice, and þone arleasan cyning Herodem mid heora bodunge ðearle afærdon; forðan ðe buton tweon seo eorðlice arleasnys wearð gescynd, þaða seo heofenlice healicnyss wearð geopenod.

Swutol is þæt ða tungel-witegan tocneowon Crist soðne mann, ðaða hí befrunon, "Hwær is se ðe acenned is?" Hí oncneowon hine soðne Cyning, þaða hí cwædon, "Iudea Cyning." Hí hine wurðodon soðne God, þaða hí cwædon, "We comon to ðy þæt we us to him gebiddan." Eaðe mihte God hí gewissian þurh ðone steorran to ðære byrig þe þæt cild on wæs, swa swa he his acennednysse þurh ðæs steorran up-spring geswutelode; ac he wolde þæt ða Iudeiscan boceras ða witegunge be ðam ræddon, and swa his cennig-stowe geswutelodon, þæt hí gehealdene wæron, gif hí woldon mid þan tungel-witegum hí to Criste gebiddan: gif hí þonne noldon, þæt hí wurdon mid þære geswutelunge geniðerode. Þa tungel-witegan fer-

don and hí gebædon, and ða Iudeiscan boceras bæftan belifon, þe þa cennung-stowe þurh bōclīc gescead gebīcnodon.

Ealle gesceafta oncneowon heora Scyppendes to-cyme, buton ðam arleasum Iudeiscum anum. Heofonas oncneowon heora Scyppend, ðaða hí on his acennednyssse níwne steorran æteowdon. Sá oncneow ðaða Crist mid drium fot-wylmum ofer hyre yða mihtelice eode. Sunne oncneow, þaþa heo on his ðrowunge hire leoman fram mid-dæge oð nōn behydde. Stanas oncneowon, ðaða hí on his forðsiðe sticmælum toburston. Seo eorðe oncneow, ðaða heo on his æriste eall byfode. Hell oncneow, ðaða heo hire hæftlingas unðances forlet. And ðeah þa heard-heortan Iudei noldon for eallum ðam tacnum þone soðan Scyppend tocnáwan, þe þa dumban gesceafta undergeaton, and mid gebicnungum geswutolodon. Næron hí swa ðeah ealle endemes ungeleaffulle, ac of heora cynne wæron ægðer ge witegan ge apostolas, and fela ðusenda gelyfedra manna.

Þaþa ða tungel-witegan þone cyning gecyrdon, þa wearð se steorra him ungesewen; and eft, ðaða hí to ðam cilde gecyrdon, þa gesawon hí eft ðone steorran, and he ða hí gelædde to þam huse, þær hé inne wunode. Ne glad hé ealne weig him ætforan, ac syððan hí comon to Iudeiscum earde, syððan he wæs heora latteow, oð þæt he bufan Cristes gesthuse ætstod.

Herodes hæfde deofles getacnunge; and se ðe fram Gode bichð to deofle he forlyst Godes gife, þæt is his modes onlihtinge, swa swa ða tungel-witegan ðone steorran forluron, ðaða hí ðone reðan cynning gecyrdon. Gif he ðonne eft þone deofol anrædlice forlæt, ðonne gemét hé eft þæs halgan Gastes gife, þe his heortan onliht, and to Criste gelæt.

Us is eac to witenne, þæt wæron sume gedwolmen ðe cwædon, þæt ælc man beo acenned be steorrena gesetnyssum, and þurh heora ymbryna him wyrd gelimpe, and námon to fultume heora gedwylde þæt níwe steorra asprang þaþa Drihten lichamlice acenned wearð, and cwædon þæt se steorra his gewyrd wære. Gewíte ðis gedwyld fram geleaffullum heortum, þæt ænig gewyrd sy, buton se Ælmihtiga Scyppend, seðe ælcum men foresceawað lif be his gearnungum. Nis se man for steorrum gesceapen, ac ða steorran sint mannum to nihtlicere lihtinge gesceapene. Þaða se steorra glád, and þa tungel-witegan gelædde, and him ðæs cildes inn gebícnode, ða geswutelode he þæt he wæs Cristes gesceaft, and rihtlice his Scyppende þenode: ac hé næs his gewyrd. Eft we biddað þæt nán ge-

leafful man his geleafan mid þisum gedwylde ne befyle. Witodlice Rebecca, Isaáces wíf, acende twegen getwysan, Iacob and Esau, on ánre tide, swa þæt Iacob heold þone ylðran broðer Esau be ðam fét on ðære cenninge, and hi næron ðeah gelice on ðeawum, ne on lifes geearnungum. Witodlice þæt halige gewrit cwyð þæt God lufode Iacob, and hatode Esau; na for gewyrde, ac for mislicum geearnungum. Hit gelimpð forwel oft þæt on anre tíde acenð seo cwén and seo wyln, and ðeah geðicð se æðeling be his gebyrdum to healicum cynesetle, and ðære wylne sunu wunað eal his líf on ðeowte.

Nu cweðað oft stunte men þæt hi be gewyrde lybban sceolon, swylce God hí neadige to yfel-dædum! Ac we wyllað þyssera stuntra manna ydele leasunge adwæscan mid deopnysse godcundra gewrita. Se Ælmihtiga Scyppend gesceop englas þurh his godcundan mihte, and for his micclan rihtwisnysse forgeaf him agenne cyre, þæt hí moston ðurhwunian on ecere gesælðe ðurh gehyrsumnysse, and mihton eac ða gesælða forleosan, na for gewyrde, ac for ungehyrsumnysse. His deope rihtwisnys nolde hí neadian to naðrum, ac forgeaf him agenne cyre; forðan ðe þæt is rihtwisnys þæt gehwylcum sy his agen cyre geðafod. Þonne wære seo rihtwisnys awæged, gif he hí neadunge to his ðeowte gebigde, oððe gif he hí to yfelnysse bescufe. Ða miswendon sume þa englas heora agenne cyre, and þurh modignysse hy sylfe to awyrigedum deoflum geworhton.

Eft ðaða se ðrimwealdenda Scyppend mancyn geworhte, þa forgeaf hé Adame and Euan agenne cyre, swa hi, ðurh gehyrsumnysse, á on ecnysse, butan deaðe, on gesælðe wunodon, mid eallum heora ofspringe, swa hi, ðurh ungehyrsumnysse, deadlice wurdon. Ac ðaþa hí Godes bebod forgægdon, and þæs awyrigedan deofles lare gehyrsumodon, þa wurdon hi deadlice, and forscyldegode þurh agenne cyre, hí and eall heora ofspring; and ðeah ðe næfre ne wurde syððan mancynne gemiltsod, ðe má ðe ðam deoflum is, ðeah wære Godes rihtwisnys eallunga untæle. Ac eft seo miccle mildheortnys ures Drihtnes us alysdre þurh his menniscnysse, gif we his bebodum mid ealre heortan gehyrsumiað. Witodlice ða ðe nu þurh agenne cyre and deofles tihtinge God forlætað, God forlæt hí eac to ðam ecan forwyrde.

Georne wiste se Ælmihtiga Scyppend, ærðan þe he þa gesceafta gesceope, hwæt toward wæs. He cuðe gewislice getel ægðer ge gecorenra engla ge gecorenra manna, and eac ðæra modigra gasta and arleasra manna, þe ðurh heora arleasnysse forwurðað; ac he ne

forestihte nænne to yfelnyssse, forðan þe he sylf is eall gódnysse; ne hé nænne to forwyrde ne gestihtre, forðan ðe he is soð líf. He forestihtre ða gecorenan to ðam ecan life, forðan ðe he wiste hí swilce towearde, þurh his gife and agene gehyrsumnyssse. He nolde forestihtan þa arleasan to his rice, forðan ðe he wiste hí swilce towearde, þurh heora agene forgægednyssse and ðwyrnyssse. Healdað þis fæste on eowerum heortum, þæt se Ælmihtiga and se Rihtwisa God nænne mann ne neadað to syngigenne, ac he wát swa-ðeah on ær hwilce þurh agenne willan syngian willað. Hwí ne sceal he ðonne rihtlice wrecan þæt yfel þæt he onscunað? He lufað ælc gód and rihtwisnyssse, forðan ðe he is gecyndelice gód and rihtwis; and he hatað ealle ða ðe unrihtwisnyssse wyrcað, and þa fordeð þe leasunge sprecað. Witodlice þa þe on God belyfað, hi sind þurh ðone Halgan Gást gewissode. Nis seo gecyrrednys to Gode of us sylfum, ac of Godes gife, swa swa se apostol cwyð, "Þurh Godes gife ge sind gehealdene on geleafan."

Þa ðe ne gelyfað ðurh agenne cyre hí scoriað, na ðurh gewyrd, forðan ðe gewyrd nis nan ðing buton leas wena; ne nan ðing soðlice be gewyrde ne gewyrð, ac ealle ðing þurh Godes dom beoð geen-debyrde, seðe cwæð þurh his witegan, "Ic afandige manna heortan, and heora lendena, and ælcum sylle æfter his færelde, and æfter his agenre afundennysse." Ne talige nan man his yfelan dæda to Gode, ac talige ærest to þam deofle, þe mancyn beswác, and to Adámes forgægednyssse; ac ðeah swiðost to him sylfum, þæt him yfel gelicað, and ne licað gód.

Bið þeah gelome ofspring forscyldegod þurh forðfædera mándæda, gif he mid yfele him geefenlæhð. Gif ðonne se ofspring rihtwis bið, þonne leofað he on his rihtwisnyssse, and nateshwon his yldrena synna ne aberð. Ne sy nán man to ðan arleas þæt hé Adam wyrige oððe Euan, ðe nu on heofenum mid Gode rixiað, ac geearnige swiðor Godes mildheortnyssse, swa þæt hé wende his agenne cyre to his Scyppendes gehyrsumnyssse and bebodum; forðan þe nan man ne bið gehealden buton þurh gife Hælendes Cristes: þa gife he gearcode and forestihtre on ecum ræde ær middangeardes gesetnyssse.

Mine gebroðra, ge habbað nu gehyred be ðan leasan wenan, þe ydele men gewyrd hatað: uton nu fón on þæs godspelles trahtnunge, þær we hit ær forleton. Þa tungel-witegan eodon into ðæs cildes gesthuse, and hine gemetton mid þære meder. Hí ða mid astrehtum

lichaman hi to Criste gebædon, and geopenodon heora hordfatu, and him geoffrodon þryfealde lác, gold, and recels, and myrran. Gold gedafenað cyninge; stór gebyrað to Godes ðenunge; mid myrran man behwyrfð deadra manna líc, þæt hí late rotian. Ðas ðrý tungel-wítegan hí to Criste gebædon, and him getacnigendlice lac offrodon. Þæt gold getacnode þæt he is soð Cyning. Se stór þæt he is soð God. Seo myrre þæt he wæs ða deadlic; ac he þurhwunað nu undeadlic on ecnysse.

Sume gedwolmen wæron þe gelyfdon þæt hé God wære, ac hi nateshwón ne gelyfdon þæt hé æghwær rixode: hi offrodon Criste gastlice recels, and noldon him gold offrian. Eft wæron oðre gedwolmen ðe gelyfdon þæt he soð Cyning wære, ac hi wiðsocon þæt he God wære: ðas, buton twyn, him offrodon gold, and noldon offrian recels. Sume gedwolan andetton þæt he soð God wære and soð Cyn- ing, and wiðsocon þæt hé deadlic flæsc underfenge: þas witodlice him brohton gold and stór, and noldon bringan myrran þære onfan- genre deadlicnysse.

Mine gebroðra, uton we geoffrian urum Drihtne gold, þæt we an- dettan þæt hé soð Cyning sy, and æghwær rixige. Uton him offrian stór, þæt we gelyfon þæt hé æfre God wæs, seðe on þære tide man æteowde. Uton him bringan myrran, þæt we gelyfan þæt he wæs deadlic on urum flæsce, seðe is unðrowigendlic on his godcundnysse. He wæs deadlic on menniscnysse ær his ðrowunge, ac he bið heonon- forð undeadlic, swa swa we ealle beoð æfter ðam gemænelicum æriste.

We habbað gesæd embe ðas þryfealdan lac, hú hí to Criste be- limpað: we willað eac secgan hú hí to ús belimpað æfter ðeawlicum andgite. Mid golde witodlice bið wisdom getácnod, swa swa Sa- lomon cwæð, "Gewilnigendlic gold-hord lið on ðæs witan muðe." Mid store bið geswutelod halig gebed, be ðam sang se sealm-scop, "Drihten, sy min gebed asend swa swa byrnende stór on ðinre gesi- hðe." Þurh myrran is gehíwod cwelmbærnys ures flæsces; be ðam cweð seo halige gelaðung, "Mine handa drypton myrran." Þam acennedan Cyninge we bringað gold, gif we on his gesihðe mid beorhtnysse þæs upplican wisdomes scinende beoð. Stór we him bringað, gif we ure geðohtas ðurh gecnyrdnysse haligra gebeda on weofode ure heortan onálað, þæt we magon hwæthwega wynsum- lice ðurh heofenlice gewilnunge stincan. Myrran we him offriað, gif we ða flæsclican lustas þurh forhæfednysse cwymliað. Myrra deð,

swa we ær cwædon, þæt þæt deade flæsc eaðelice ne rotað. Witodlice þæt deade flæsc rotað leahtorlice, þonne se deadlica lichama ðeowað þære flowendan galnysse, swa swa se witega be sumum cwæð, "Ða nytenu forrotedon on heora meoxe." Þonne forrotiað þa nytenu on heora meoxe, þonne flæschlice men on stence heora galnysse geendiað heora dagas. Ac gif we ða myrran Gode gastlice geoffriað, þonne bið ure deadlica lichama fram galnysse stencum ðurh forhæfednysse gehealden.

Sum ðing miccles gebícnodon þa tungel-witegan us mid þam þæt hi ðurh oðerne weg to heora earde gecyrdon. Ure eard soðlice is neorxna-wang, to ðam we ne magon gecyrran þæs wegæs ðe we comon. Se frumsceapena man and eall his ofspring wearð adraefed of neorxena-wanges myrhðe, þurh ungehyrsumnysse, and for ðigene þæs forbodenan bigleofan, and ðurh modignysse, ðaða he wolde beon betera ðonne hine se Ælmihtiga Scyppend gesceop. Ac us is micel neod þæt we ðurh oðerne weg þone swicolan deofol forbugan, þæt we moton gesæliglice to urum eðele becuman, þe we to gesceapene wæron.

We sceolon þurh gehyrsumnysse, and forhæfednysse, and eadmodnysse, ánmodlice to urum eðele stæppan, and mid halgum mægnum ðone eard ofgan, þe we ðurh leahtras forluron. Rihtlice wæs se swicola Herodes fram þam tungel-witegum bepæht, and he to Criste ne becom, forðan ðe hé mid facenfullum mode hine sohte. He getacnode þa leasan licceteras, ðe mid híwunge God secað, and næfre ne gemetað. He is to secenne mid soðfæstre heortan, and anrædum mode, seðe leofað and rixað mid Fæder and Halgum Gaste, on ealra worulda woruld. Amen.

DOM. III. POST EPIPHANIA DOMINI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Cum descendisset Iesus de monte secute sunt eum turbe multe: et reliqua.

Matheus, se eadiga Godspellere awrát on þissere godspellican rædinge, þæt "se Hælend niðer-eode of anre dune, and him filigde micel menigu. Efne ða com sum hreoflig mann, and aleat wið þæs Hælendes, þus cweðende, Drihten, gif þu wilt, þu miht me geclænsian. Se Hælend astrehte his hand, and hine hrepode, and cwæð, Ic wylle; and sy ðu geclænsod. Þa sona wearð his hreofla eal geclænsod, and he wæs gehæled. Ða cwæð se Hælend him to, Warnu þæt þu hit nanum menn ne secge; ac far to Godes temple, and geswutela ðe sylfne ðam sacerde, and geoffra ðine lác, swá swá Moyses bebead him on gewitnysse."

Se láreow Hægmon cweð on ðissere trahtnunge þæt seo dún þe se Hælend of-astah getacnode heofenan rice, of ðam niðer-astah se Ælmihtiga Godes Sunu, ðaða he underfeng ure gecynde, and to meniscum men geflæschamod wearð, to ðy þæt he mancynn fram deofles anwealde alydde. He wæs ungesewenlic and unðrowigendlic on his gecynde; þa wearð he gesewenlic on urum gecynde, and þrowigendlic. Seo micle menigu ðe him filigde getacnode ða geleafullan cristenan, þe mid heora þeawa stæpum Drihtne filiað. Witodlice we folgiað Cristes fotswaðum, gif we his gebisnungum mid godum weorcum geefenlæcað. "Efne ða com sum hreoflig man, and aleat wið þæs Hælendes, þus cweðende, Drihten, gif þu wilt, ðu miht me geclænsian. Se Hælend astrehte his hand, and hine hrepode,

and cwæð, Ic wille; and sy ðu geclænsod. Ða sona wearð his hreofla eal geclænsod, and he wæs gehæled."

On ðissere dæde is geswutelod Godes miht, and his eadmodnys. Moyses æ forbead to hrepenne ænigne hreoflan, ac se eadmoda Crist nolde hine forseon, þeah ðe he atelic wære, and eac geswutelode þæt hé wæs Hlaford þære ealdan æ, and na ðeow. Mihtiglice he mihte mid his worde hine gehælan, buton hrepunge; ac he geswutelode þæt his hrepung is swiðe halwende geleaffullum. Geleafful wæs se hreoflia, ðaða he cwæð, "Drihten, gif þu wilt, ðu miht me geclænsian." Se Hælend andwyrde, "Ic wylle; and þu beo geclænsod." Godes hæs soðlice is weorc, swa swa se sealm-wyrhta cwæð, "He hit gecwæð, and þa gesceafta wæron geworhte. He bebead, and hí wæron gesceapene."

On gastlicum andgite getacnode þes hreoflia man eal mancyn, þe wæs atelice hreoflig, mid mislicum Leahtrum on þam inran menn; ac hit gebeah to Cristes geleafan, and gleawlice undergeat þæt hit ne mihte þære sawle clænsunge onfon, buton þurh Drihten, þe nane synne ne worhte, ne nan facn næs on his muðe gemet. Laðlic bið þæs hreoflian lic mid menigfealdum springum and geswelle, and mid mislicum fagnyssum; ac se inra mann, þæt is seo sawul, bið micle atelicor, gif heo mid mislicum Leahtrum begripen bið. We sceolon rihtlice gelyfan on Crist, þæt he ure sawle fram synna fagnyssum gehælan mæge; and we sceolon anrædlice his willan to ðære fremminge biddan. His hand getacnað his mihte and his flæsclicnyse. Swa swa Crist mid his handa hrepunge þone hreoflian gehælde, swa eac he alysde us fram ure sawla synnum ðurh anfenge ures flæsc; swa swa se witega Isaias cwæð, "Soðlice he sylf ætbræd ure adlunga, and ure sarnyssa he sylf abær."

Mid þam ðe he forbead þam gehæledum hreoflian þæt he hit nanum men ne cydde, mid þam he sealde us bysne þæt we ne sceolon na wídmærsian ure wel-dæda, ac we sceolon onscunian, mid inweardre heortan, þone ydelan gylp, gif we hwæt lytles to góde gedoð. Witodlice ne bið us mid nanum oðrum edleane forgolden, gif we goód for gylpe doð, buton mid helle susle; forðan ðe gylp is an heofod-leahter.

Seo ealde æ bebead þæt gehwíl hreoflig man gecome to þam sacerde, and se sacerd sceolde hine fram mannum ascirian, gif hé soðlice hreoflig wære. Gif he nære swutelice hreoflig, wære ðonne be his dome clæne geteald. Gif se sacerd hine hreofligne tealde, and Godes

miht hine syððan gehælde, þonne sceolde he mid lace his clænsunge Gode ðancian. Swa sceal eac se ðe mid heafod-leahtrum wiðinnan hreoflig bið cuman to Godes sacerde, and geopenian his digelnysses ðam gastlican læce, and be his ræde and fultume his sawle wunda dædbetende gelacnian. Sume men wenað þæt him genihtsumige to fulfremedum læcedome, gif hí heora synna mid onbryrdre heortan Gode ánum andettað, and ne ðurfon nanum sacerde geandettan, gif hí yfeles geswicað: ac gif heora wena soð wære, ðonne nolde Drihten asendan þone ðe he sylf gehælde to þam sacerde mid ænigre lace. For ðære ylcan gebisnunge eac hé asende Paulum, þone ðe he sylf of heofenum gespræc, to ðam sacerde Annanian, þus cweðende, "Ga inn to ðære ceastre, and ðær þe bið gesæd hwæt þe gedafenað to dónne."

Ne gedyde se sacerd þone man hreofligne oððe unhreofligne, ac hé dēmdre þæt he sceolde beon ascyred fram manna neawiste, gif his hreofla wyrsgigende wære; oððe betwux mannum wunian, gif his hreofla godigigende wære. Swa sceal don se gastlica sacerd: he sceal gerihtlæcan Godes folc, and ðone ascyrian, and amánsunian fram cristenum mannum, þe swa hreoflig bið on mánfullum ðeawum þæt he oðre mid his yfelnysses besmit; be ðam cwæð se apostol Paulus, "Afyrsiað þone yfelan fram eow, ðylæs ðe an wannhal scep ealle ða eowde besmite." Gif his hreofla bið godigigende, þæt is gif he yfeles geswicð, and his ðeawas ðurh Godes ege gerihtlæcð, he hæbbe wununge betwux cristenum mannum, oð þæt he full hal sy on his drohtnungum.

Se godspellere cwæð, þæt "Drihten ferde æfter ðisum to anre byrig þe is geháten Capharnaum; þa genealæhte him to sum hundredes ealdor, biddende and cweðende, Drihten, min cniht lið æt hám bedreda, and is yfele geðreatod. Drihten him andwyrde, Ic cume and hine gehæle. Þa andwyrde se hundredes ealdor, and cwæð, Drihten, ne eom ic wyrðe þæt þu innfare under minum hrofe; ac cweð þin word, and min cniht bið gehæled. Ic eom án man geset under anwealde, hæbbende under me ceman; and ic cweðe to ðisum, Far ðu, and he færð; to oðrum, Cum ðu, and he cymð; to minum ðeowan, Do ðis, and he deð. Þa wundrode se Hælend, ðaða hé ðis gehyrde, and cwæð to ðære fyligendan menigu, Soð ic eow secge, ne gemette ic swa micelne geleafan on Israhela ðeode. Ic secge eow to soðum, þæt manega cumað fram east-dæle and west-dæle, and gerestað hí mid Abrahame ðam heahfædere, and Isaáce, and Iacobe, on heofe-

nan rice. Ða rícan bearn beoð aworpene into ðam yttrum þeostrum, þær bið wóp and toða gebitt. Ða cwæð eft se Hælend to þam hundredes ealdre, Far ðe hám, and getimige ðe swa swa ðu gelyfdest. And se cniht wearð gehæled of ðære tide."

Þes hundredes ealdor genealæhte ðam Hælende na healfunga, ac fulfremedlice. He genealæhte mid micclum geleafan, and mid soðre eadmodnysse, and snotornysse, and soðre lufe. Micelne geleafan he hæfde, þaþa he cwæð, "Drihten, cweð þin word, and min cniht bið hal." Soðlice he geswutelode micle eadmodnysse, mid þam ðe he cwæð, "Drihten, ne eom ic wyrðe þæt þu innfare under mine ðecene." He hæfde micle snotornysse, þaþa hé understód þæt Crist is æghwær andweard þurh godcundnysse, seðe lichamlice betwux mannum gesewenlic eode. Næs he bedæled þære soðan lufe, ðaða he bæd Drihten for his ðeowan hæle. Manega oðre men bædon Drihten, sume for heora agenre hæle, sume for heora bearna, sume for leofra freonda; ac ðes ðegen bæd for his þeowan hælðe mid soðre lufe; forðan ðe heo ne toscæt nænne be mæglicere sibbe. Drihten geseah ðises ðegenes menigfealdan godnysse, and cwæð, "Ic cume, and ðinne cniht gehæle."

Iohannes se Godspellere awrát, þæt "Sum under-cyning com to Criste, and hine bæd þæt he hám mid him siðode, and his sunu gehælde; forðan þe hé læig æt forðsiðe. Ða cwæð se Hælend to ðam under-cyninge, Gewénd þe hám, þin sunu leofað. He gelyfde þæs Hælendes spræce, and hám siðode. Ða comon his ðegnas him togeanes, and cyddon þæt his sunu gesund wære. He ða befrán on hwilcere tide he gewyrpte. Hí sædon, Gyrstan-dæg ofer midne dæg hine forlét se fefor. Ða oncneow se fæder þæt hit wæs seo tíð on ðære ðe se Hælend him to cwæð, Far ðe hám, þin sunu leofað. Se cyning gelyfde ða on God, and eal his hired."

Drihten nolde gelaðod lichamlice siðian to þæs cyninges untruman bearne, ac únandweard mid his worde hine gehælde; and he wæs gearo ungelaðod to siðigenne lichamlice mid þam hundredes ealdre. Wel wát gehwá þæt cyning hæfð maran mihte þonne ænig hundredes ealdor, ac se Ælmihtiga Godes Sunu geswutelode mid þære dæde þæt we ne sceolon ða rícan, for heora riccetere wurðian, ac for menniscum gecynde; ne we ne sceolon ða wánnspedigan for heora hafenleaste forseon; ac we sceolon Godes anlicnysse on him wurðian. Se eadmoda Godes Sunu wæs gearo to geneosigenne þone ðeowan mid his andwerdnysse, and he gehælde þone æðeling mid

hæse; be ðam cwæð se witega, "Se healica Drihten sceawað þa eadmodan, and þa modigan feorran oncnæwð."

Drihten wundrode þæs hundredes ealdres geleafan, na swilce he hine ær ne cuðe, seðe ealle ðing wát, ac he geswutelode mannum his geleafan mid herunge þam þe he wundorlic wæs. Hwanon com se geleafa þam þegene buton of Cristes gife, seðe hine syððan þisum wordum herede? "Soð ic eow secge, na gemette ic swa micelne geleafan on Israhela ðeode." Næs ðis gecweden be ðam heahfæderum oððe wítegum, ac be ðam andwerdan folce, ðe ða-gyt næron swa miccles geleafan.

Maria and Martha wæron twa geswystru swiðe on God belyfede: hí cwædon to Criste, "Drihten, gif ðu her andwerd wære, nære ure broðer forðfaren." Þes ðegen cwæð to Criste, "Cweð þin word, and min cniht bið hal. Ic eom man under anwealde gesett, hæbbende under me ceman; and ic secge ðisum, Far ðú, and he færð; to oðrum, Cum ðu, and he cymð; to minum þeowan, Do þis, and he deð. Hu miccle swiðor miht ðu, þe Ælmihtig God eart, þurh ðine hæse gefremman swa hwæt swa ðu wilt!" Drihten cwæð, "Ic secge eow to soðan, þæt manega cumað fram east-dæle and west-dæle, and gerestað hí mid Abrahame þam heahfædere, and Isaáce, and Iacobe, on heofenan rice." Þas word sind lustbære to gehyrenne, and hí micclum ure mod gladiað, þæt manega cumað fram east-dæle middangeardes, and fram west-dæle, to heofenan rice, and mid þam heahfæderum on ecere myrðe rixiað.

Þurh ða twegen dælas, east-dæl and west-dæl, sind getacnode ða feower hwemmas ealles middangeardes, of þam beoð gegaderode Godes gecorenan of ælcere mægðe to þæra heahfædera wununge, and ealra halgena. Þurh east-dæl magon beon getacnode þa ðe on geogoðe to Gode bugað; forðan ðe on east-dæle is þæs dæges angin. Þurh west-dæl sind getacnode þa ðe on ylde to Godes ðeowdome gecyrrað; forðan ðe on west-dæle geendað se dæg.

Ðes æfterfiligenda cwyde is swiðe egefull, "Þa rícan bearn beoð awórpene into ðam yttrum ðeostrum, þær bið wóp and toða gebitt." Ða rícan bearn sind þa Iudeiscan, on ðam rixode God ðurh ða ealdan á; ac hí awurpon Crist, and his lare forsawon; and hé awyrypð hí on ða yttran þeostu, ðær bið wóp and toða gebitt. Fela ricra manna geðeoð Gode, swa-þeah, gif hí rihtwise beoð, and mildheorte. Rice man wæs se heahfæder Abraham, and Dáuid se mæra cyning, and Zacheus, seðe healfe his æhta pearfum dælde, and mid healfum dæle

forgeald be feowerfealdum swa hwæt swa he ær on unriht be anfealdum reafode. Þas rican and heora gelican becumað þurh gode gecyrrednyssse to ðam ecan rice, ðe him næfre ne ateorað.

Ða sind Godes bearn gecigede, þe hine lufiað swiðor þonne þisne middangeard; and ða sind ða rican bearn gecwedene, ðe heora heortan wyrtruman on ðisum andwerdum life plantiað swiðor þonne on Criste: swylce beoð on þeostru aworpene. Þæt godspel cwyð, "On þa yttran þeostru." Ða yttran þeostru sind þæs lichaman blindnyssa wiðutan. Ða inran þeostru sind þæs modes blindnyssa wiðinnan. Se ðe on ðisum andweardum life is wiðinnan ablend, swa þæt he næfð nan andgit ne hóga embe Godes beboda, he bið þonne eft wiðutan ablend, and ælces leohtes bedæled; forðan ðe he ær his lif aspende butan Godes gemynde. Þa earman forscyldegodan cwylmiað on ecum fyre, and swa-ðeah þæt swearte fyr him nane lihtinge ne deð. Wurmas toslitað heora lichaman mid fyrenum toðum, swa swa Crist on his godspelle cwæð, "Þær næfre heora wurm ne swylt, ne heora fyr ne bið adwæsced." Þær beoð þonne geferlæhte on anre susle, þa þe on life on mándædum geðeodde wæron, swa þæt þa manslagan togædere ecelice on tintregum cwylmiað; and forlígras mid forligrum, gitseras mid gytserum, sceaðan mid sceaðum, ða forsworenan mid forsworennum, on ðam bradan fire, butan ælcere geen-dunge forwurðað. Þær bið wóp and toða gebitt, forðan ðe ða eagan tyrað on ðam micclum bryne, and ða teð cwaciað eft on swiðlicum cyle. Gif hwam twynige be ðam gemænelicum æriste, þonne under-stande he þisne drihtenlican cwyde, Þæt þær bið soð ærist, ðær ðær beoð wepende eagan and cearcigende teð.

Drihten cwæð to þam hundredes ealdre, "Far ðe hám, and getimige ðe swa swa ðu gelyfdest; and his cniht wearð gehæled of ðære tide." Be ðisum is to understandenne hu micclum þam cristennum men his agen geleafa fremige, þonne oðres mannes swa micclum fremode. Witodlice, for ðæs hundredes ealdres geleafan wearð se bedreda gehæled. Geleafa is ealra mægena fyrrest; buton þam ne mæg nán man Gode lician; and se rihtwisa leofað be his geleafan. Uton gelyfan on þa Halgan Ðrynnysse, and on soðe Annysse, þæt se Ælmihtiga Fæder, and his Sunu, þæt is his wisdom, and se Halga Gast, seðe is heora begra lufu and willa, þæt hí sind þry on hadum and on namum, and án God, on ánre godcundnyssse æfre wunigende, butan angynne and ende. Amen.